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British PM Andy Burnham asks Royal Air Force to deploy Typhoon fighter jets to protect Saudi cities and infra from aerial attacks by Houthis, **P 14**

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INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF EQUITY SHARES OF JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF THE BSE LIMITED ("BSE") AND THE NATIONAL STOCK EXCHANGE OF INDIA LIMITED ("NSE" AND TOGETHER WITH BSE, THE "STOCK EXCHANGES") IN COMPLIANCE WITH CHAPTER II OF THE SECURITIES AND EXCHANGE BOARD OF INDIA (ISSUE OF CAPITAL AND DISCLOSURE REQUIREMENTS) REGULATIONS, 2018, AS AMENDED ("SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS").

(Please scan this QR code to view the Red Herring Prospectus, and the Abridged Prospectus)

JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED

(TO BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF BSE AND NSE)

Jio Platforms Limited was incorporated on November 15, 2019, at Ahmedabad, Gujarat, as a public company limited by shares under the Companies Act, 2013, pursuant to a certificate of incorporation issued by the Registrar of Companies, Central Registration Centre. For further details, see "History and Certain Corporate Matters" on page 249 of the red herring prospectus dated October 14, 2026 (**"RHP"**).

Corporate Identity Number: U72900GJ2019PLC110816
Registered Office: Office-101, Saffron, Nr. Centre Point, Panchwati 5 Rasta, Ambawadi, Ahmedabad 380 006, Gujarat, India
Corporate Office: TC-22, 5th Floor, A Wing, Reliance Corporate Park, Thane Belapur Road, Ghansoli, Navi Mumbai 400 701, Maharashtra, India
Contact Person(s): Ms. Savithri Parekh, Company Secretary and Mr. Venkataraman Ramachandran, Compliance Officer
E-mail: jpl.investorrelations@jio.com; **Tel:** +91 22 7967 0000; **Website:** www.jio.com

OUR PROMOTER: RELIANCE INDUSTRIES LIMITED

INITIAL PUBLIC OFFER OF UP TO 270,000,000 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹10 EACH ("EQUITY SHARES") OF JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED ("THE COMPANY" OR "ISSUER") FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE (INCLUDING A SECURITIES PREMIUM OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE) ("ISSUE PRICE") AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ [●] MILLION (THE "ISSUE"). THE ISSUE INCLUDES A RESERVATION OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 5,000 MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE ISSUE), FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES ("EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION") AND A RESERVATION OF UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH FOR CASH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] EACH, AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 25,000 MILLION (CONSTITUTING UP TO [●]% OF THE ISSUE), FOR SUBSCRIPTION BY ELIGIBLE RIL SHAREHOLDERS ("RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION"). THE ISSUE LESS THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION AND THE RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION IS HEREINAFTER REFERRED TO AS THE "NET ISSUE". THE ISSUE AND THE NET ISSUE SHALL CONSTITUTE [●]% AND [●]% OF THE POST-ISSUE PAID-UP EQUITY SHARE CAPITAL OF THE COMPANY, RESPECTIVELY. THE COMPANY, IN CONSULTATION WITH THE BRLMs, IS OFFERING A DISCOUNT OF ₹ 54 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION ("EMPLOYEE DISCOUNT")

PRICE BAND: ₹ 1,065 TO ₹ 1,119 PER EQUITY SHARE OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH.

THE FLOOR PRICE IS 106.50 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES AND THE CAP PRICE IS 111.90 TIMES THE FACE VALUE OF THE EQUITY SHARES.

BIDS CAN BE MADE FOR A MINIMUM OF 12 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AND IN MULTIPLES OF 12 EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH THEREAFTER

THE PRICE TO EARNING RATIO ("P/E") BASED ON DILUTED EARNINGS PER SHARE ("EPS") FOR FISCAL 2026 FOR THE COMPANY AT THE LOWER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 31.71 TIMES, AND AT THE UPPER END OF THE PRICE BAND IS 33.31 TIMES, AS COMPARED TO THE AVERAGE INDUSTRY PEER GROUP P/E RATIO OF 22.35 TIMES FOR FISCAL 2026.

A DISCOUNT OF ₹ 54 PER EQUITY SHARE IS BEING OFFERED TO ELIGIBLE EMPLOYEES BIDDING IN THE EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION

BID/ISSUE PERIOD

BID/ISSUE OPENS TODAY

BID/ISSUE CLOSES ON(1): FRIDAY, OCTOBER 23, 2026

(1) UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 7:00 p.m. IST on the Bid/ Issue Closing Date.

Jio Platforms Limited, is a technology platform, built on proprietary digital technology and pan-India digital connectivity as its foundational layer, driving digital transformation in India. Our Material Subsidiary, Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited, served 533.3 million customers in India as of June 30, 2026.

THE ISSUE IS BEING MADE THROUGH THE BOOK BUILDING PROCESS IN ACCORDANCE WITH REGULATION 6(1) OF THE SEBI ICDR REGULATIONS.

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD OF THE STOCK EXCHANGES. NSE IS THE DESIGNATED STOCK EXCHANGE.

QIB PORTION: NOT MORE THAN 50% OF THE NET ISSUE | NON-INSTITUTIONAL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 15% OF THE NET ISSUE | RETAIL PORTION: NOT LESS THAN 35% OF THE NET ISSUE

EMPLOYEE RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 5,000 MILLION
RIL SHAREHOLDERS RESERVATION PORTION: UP TO [●] EQUITY SHARES OF FACE VALUE OF ₹ 10 EACH AT A PRICE OF ₹ [●] PER EQUITY SHARE AGGREGATING UP TO ₹ 25,000 MILLION

The details of the Fresh Issue and the post Issue market capitalization of the Company, each at the Floor Price and the Cap Price, are given below:

ISSUE SIZE AND MARKET CAPITALIZATION

Particulars	At Floor Price of ₹ 1,065 per Equity Share		At Cap Price of ₹ 1,119 per Equity Share	
	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each	Up to Amount (In ₹ Million)	Up to no. of Equity Shares of face value of ₹ 10 each	Up to Amount (In ₹ Million)
Fresh Issue	270,000,000	287,282.94^	270,000,000	301,876.48^
Post Issue Market Capitalisation	**9,209,030,830**	**9,807,617.83**	**9,209,030,830**	**10,304,905.50**

^ Considers the impact of Employee Discount of ₹ 54 per Equity Share

IN MAKING AN INVESTMENT DECISION, POTENTIAL INVESTORS MUST RELY ONLY ON THE INFORMATION INCLUDED IN THE RED HERRING PROSPECTUS AND THE TERMS OF THE ISSUE, INCLUDING THE RISKS INVOLVED AND NOT RELY ON ANY OTHER EXTERNAL SOURCES OF INFORMATION ABOUT THE ISSUE AVAILABLE IN ANY MANNER. IN RELATION TO PRICE BAND, POTENTIAL INVESTORS SHOULD ONLY REFER TO THE PRE-ISSUE AND PRICE BAND ADVERTISEMENT DATED OCTOBER 14, 2026, AND SHOULD NOT RELY ON ANY MEDIA ARTICLES / REPORTS IN RELATION TO THE COMPANY AS THESE ARE NOT ENDORSED, PUBLISHED OR CONFIRMED EITHER BY THE COMPANY OR THE BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS TO THE ISSUE ("BRLMs").

In accordance with the recommendations of the Committee of Independent Directors of our Company, pursuant to their resolution dated October 14, 2026, the above Price Band is justified based on quantitative factors /KPIs disclosed in the 'Basis for Issue Price' section on page 126 of the RHP vis-à-vis the weighted average cost of acquisition ("WACA") of primary issuances / secondary transactions as disclosed in 'Basis for Issue Price' section on page 126 of the RHP and provided below in the advertisement and other relevant factors.

RISK TO INVESTORS

For details refer to the section titled "Risk Factors" section on page 30 of the RHP.

1. **Risk relating to telecommunication license and spectrum:** The unified licence for providing telecom services held by Reliance Jio Infocomm Limited ("RJIL") across circles in India is due for renewal in October 2033. Further, the spectrum held by RJIL is valid for a period of 20 years with the majority of the spectrum expiring between 2041 and 2042. Any inability to maintain or renew such licences or to successfully bid for any spectrum required for our operations, could have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.

Continued on next page...

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2. **Dependence on Reliance Industries Limited, Reliance Retail Limited and other Reliance Group entities:** The Company and its subsidiaries have entered into various non-exclusive agreements with the Promoter, Reliance Retail Limited, a subsidiary of the Promoter and other Reliance Group entities for certain key aspects of the business. Disruption of these arrangements could significantly impact our business, financial condition and results of operations. The following table provides an overview of our significant transactions with the Promoter, Reliance Retail Limited and Sanmina-SCI India Private Limited, for the periods/Fiscals indicated.

Particulars	Parent[1]/ fellow subsidiary / joint venture of the Parent	Three months ended June 30,		Fiscal		
		2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
		(in ₹ million, unless otherwise indicated)				
Purchase of Property, Plant and Equipment and Other Intangible Assets	Parent[1] (A)	19,440	14,237	39,040	37,099	62,246
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (B = A/U)	46.46%	11.82%	11.42%	8.38%	11.63%
	Reliance Retail Limited (C)	750	2,352	5,867	14,720	9,458
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (D = C/ U)	1.79%	1.95%	1.72%	3.33%	1.77%
	Sanmina-SCI India Private Limited (E)	414	192	5,339	5,190	1,107
	As a percentage of Cash Capex (F = E/ U)	0.99%	0.16%	1.56%	1.17%	0.21%
Revenue from Operations	Parent[1] (G)	9,322	7,972	36,442	35,997	35,449
	As a percentage of Revenue from Operations (H = G/ V)	2.38%	2.28%	2.48%	2.81%	3.24%
	Reliance Retail Limited (I)	3,001	4,279	16,374	10,416	7,244
	As a percentage of Revenue from Operations (J = I/ V)	0.77%	1.22%	1.11%	0.81%	0.66%
Revenue Received in Advance[2]	Reliance Retail Limited	292,480	271,663	1,129,351	1,023,958	890,587
Professional Fees	Parent[1] (K)	5,797	7,520	26,254	29,614	23,364
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (L = K/ W)	1.95%	2.88%	2.40%	3.14%	2.87%
	Reliance Retail Limited (M)	1,082	3,232	7,671	6,730	4,601
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (N = M/ W)	0.36%	1.24%	0.70%	0.71%	0.57%
Network Operating Expenses	Parent[1] (O)	3,131	4,312	18,761	15,807	15,388
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (P = O/ W)	1.05%	1.65%	1.71%	1.68%	1.89%
Selling and Distribution Expenses	Parent[1] (Q)	-	-	-	6,299	9,449
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (R = Q/ W)	-	-	-	0.67%	1.16%
	Reliance Retail Limited (S)	10,527	11,858	43,551	35,158	30,008
	As a percentage of Total Expenses (T = S/ W)	3.54%	4.54%	3.98%	3.73%	3.69%
Cash Capex[3] (U)		41,838	120,481	341,843	442,680	535,096
Revenue from Operations (V)		391,729	350,323	1,468,853	1,282,184	1,095,581
Total Expenses (W)		297,708	261,350	1,094,060	942,057	813,674

Notes:

(1) *Parent, in this table, means the Promoter.*

(2) *Recharge vouchers sold to Reliance Retail Limited are accounted as 'Advance against services' which is disclosed as a related party transaction under the head 'Revenue received in advance'. When Reliance Retail Limited or its distributor/ sub-distributor further sells the vouchers to our customers by way of recharge to the digital connectivity services, RJIL recognises such transfer as 'Deferred revenue' and thereafter, based on the type of tariff plan, it is accounted as operating revenues in the profit & loss account. In light of the above, revenue received in advance has not been presented as a percentage of revenue from operations.*

(3) *Cash Capex refers to the cash outflow towards expenditure for property, plant and equipment, spectrum and other intangible assets less proceeds from disposal of property, plant and equipment and other intangible assets.*

3. **Dependency on Reliance Retail Limited for distribution of prepaid connectivity services:** RJIL has a master distribution agreement and a master collection agreement with RRL. RRL is the sole distributor of our pre-paid connectivity services. Our revenue from pre-paid connectivity services constituted 76.37%, 77.88%, 77.08%, 78.57% and 79.35% of our consolidated Revenue from Operations for the three months period ended June 30, 2026, June 30, 2025 and Fiscals 2026, 2025 and 2024, respectively. Any disruption in this relationship or distribution channel could adversely impact our business, financial condition and results of operations. The following table provides the details of the Revenue Received in Advance attributed to the above arrangement with RRL:

Particulars	Three months ended / As of June 30		Fiscal / As of March 31		
	2026	2025	2026	2025	2024
	(in ₹ millions)				
Revenue Received in Advance	292,480	271,663	1,129,351	1,023,958	890,587

4. **Dependency on RJIL that contributes significantly to our Revenue from Operations, EBITDA and PAT and KPIs relating to digital connectivity services:** RJIL contributed significantly to our Revenue from Operations, EBITDA and PAT in periods / Fiscals as indicated below:

Fiscals / period	RJIL's revenue from operations (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated Revenue from Operations	RJIL's EBITDA (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated EBITDA	RJIL's profit after tax (in ₹ million)	% of our consolidated PAT
Three months ended June 30, 2026	342,121	87.34%	195,904	93.89%	71,669	92.31%
Three months ended June 30, 2025	308,821	88.15%	173,013	95.40%	67,110	94.39%
Fiscal 2026	1,288,714	87.74%	723,544	94.88%	281,732	93.76%
Fiscal 2025	1,141,413	89.02%	612,334	95.42%	247,948	94.97%
Fiscal 2024	1,001,194	91.38%	528,784	96.21%	204,656	95.53%

Note: The financial information of RJIL provided above is on a standalone basis.

Any material adverse impact on the business, financial conditions or results of operations of RJIL would have a corresponding material adverse impact on our consolidated business, financial condition and results of operations. Further, while we operate as a technology platform, our key operational indicators ("KPIs") are primarily pertaining to our digital connectivity services provided by RJIL and do not reflect the technology platform specific metrics. Our competitors may perform more favourably on certain operational or financial KPIs, which could affect our competitive position. For details of comparison of the KPIs of our Company with listed peers, see *"Basis for Issue Price - Comparison of KPIs with Listed Industry Peers"* on page 135 of the RHP.

5. **Network, Infrastructure and Service Disruption Risk:** The uninterrupted performance, reliability and availability of our network, passive infrastructure, technology, products and services are critical to our operations and our ability to consistently deliver our digital services. Any disruption to our network, passive infrastructure and technology could impair our ability to ensure consistent performance and deliver uninterrupted customer experience, which could have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations, and could lead to increased churn in our customer base.
6. **Risk related to Technology change:** The connectivity industry is subject to rapid and continuous technological change, and our connectivity infrastructure faces the risk of technological obsolescence. If we are unable to respond to changes in technologies, including for instance, more competitive satellite-based broadband services and the evolving demands of our customers, we may face technological obsolescence, which would have a material adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.
7. **Risk relating to negative publicity of 'Jio' Brand:** The "Jio" trademark is owned by the Promoter, and we do not control the use of this trademark by other companies in the Reliance Group. Negative publicity arising from actions outside its control, inability to protect intellectual property or infringement claims could have a material adverse impact on our reputation, business, financial condition and results of operations.
8. **Dependency on a limited group of passive infrastructure service providers:** We rely on a limited set of passive infrastructure service providers for our operations. For instance, of the 360,537 Network Towers used by us for our operations, 174,451 Network Towers are owned by Summit Digitel Infrastructure Limited, as of June 30, 2026. Additionally, as of June 30, 2026, we rely on Jio Digital Fibre Private Limited, for substantially all our optic fibre network requirements (approximately 98%), aside from the last mile fibre network which is owned by RJIL. Any disruption in the availability of these passive infrastructure assets could have an adverse impact on our business, financial condition and results of operations.
9. **Cybersecurity, Data Privacy and Information Security Risk:** Our systems, platforms, network infrastructure, and the services provided by our Promoter and third-party technology partners are exposed to cybersecurity threats, security breaches, operational disruptions, and other technology-related risks. Any such incident or disruption could impair our operations, compromise data security, increase costs, expose us to regulatory and legal liabilities, and adversely affect our business, results of operations, financial condition, and reputation.
10. **Artificial Intelligence ("AI") and Machine Learning ("ML") Technologies Related Risk:** We rely on AI and ML technologies across our operations, including for network automation through our proprietary JioBrain platform, customer engagement and service delivery. The deployment of AI and ML technologies across our operations may not yield the desired results. Further, reliance on AI/ML technologies may expose us to inherent risks pertaining to algorithmic bias and model errors leading to inaccurate or biased outputs, which may cause reputational harm and adversely impact our business, financial condition and results of operations.
11. Our Price/Earning (P/E) ratio based on diluted EPS for Financial Year 2026 at the upper end of the price band is 33.31 as compared to the average industry peer group P/E ratio of 22.35, as of October 13, 2026.
12. Weighted Average Return on Average Net Worth for Financial Year ended 2026, 2025 and 2024 is 9.04%. Return on Average Net Worth for the three months ended June 30, 2026, and June 30, 2025 is 2.30% and 2.31% respectively (unannualized).
13. Weighted average cost of acquisition of all Equity Shares transacted in one year, 18 months and three years preceding the date of the RHP:

Period	Weighted average cost of Acquisition (in ₹)	Cap Price is 'X' times the weighted average cost of acquisition#	Range of acquisition price per Equity Shares: lowest price - highest price (in ₹)
Last one year / 18 months/ 3 years	N.A.	N.A.	N.A.

#As certified by D T S & Associates LLP, Chartered Accountants (FRN 142412W/W100595), by way of their certificate dated October 14, 2026, (UDIN 26136433YFEPPE7981).

Note: No Equity Shares were transacted in the last one year, 18 months and three years preceding the date of the Red Herring Prospectus.

14. The 19 BRLMs associated with the Issue have handled 160 public issues in the past three years, out of which 46 issues have closed below the issue price on the listing date

Book Running Lead Managers	Total public issues	Issues closed below issue price listing date
Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited*	-	-
Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited*	-	-
BofA Securities India Limited*	-	-
Axis Capital Limited*	2	-
BNP Paribas*	-	-
Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited*	-	-
CLSA India Private Limited*	-	-
DAM Capital Advisors Limited*	8	2
Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited*	-	-
HDFC Bank Limited*	-	-
HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited*	-	-
ICICI Securities Limited*	5	2
IIFL Capital Services Limited *(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)* *	5	1
Jefferies India Private Limited*	-	-
JM Financial Limited*	3	-
J.P. Morgan India Private Limited*	-	-
SBI Capital Markets Limited*	6	4
UBS Securities India Private Limited*	-	-
360 ONE WAM Limited*	-	-
Common issues handled by the BRLMs	131	37
TOTAL	**160**	**46**

** Issues handled where there were no common BRLMs*

Continued on next page...

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ADDITIONAL INFORMATION FOR INVESTORS

1. The Company has not undertaken any pre-IPO placement from the date of filing the DRHP till date.
2. The Promoter and the Promoter Group have not undertaken any transaction of Equity Shares aggregating up to 1% or more of the paid-up equity share capital of the Company from the date of filing the DRHP till date.
3. For the pre-Issue and post-Issue equity shareholding of the Promoter, Promoter Group and top 10 public Shareholders, refer to the section titled 'Capital Structure' on page 99 of the RHP.

BASIS FOR ISSUE PRICE

(You may scan the QR code for accessing the website of Kotak Mahindra Capital Company)

*(The **"Basis for Issue Price"** section on page no. 126 of the RHP has been updated with the above price band. Please refer to the websites of the BRLMs: https://investmentbank.kotak.com, https://www.morganstanley.com/india, https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia, www.axiscapital.co.in, www.bnpparibas.co.in, www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking, www.india.clsa.com, www.damcapital.in, www.goldmansachs.com, www.hdfc.bank.in, www.business.hsbc.co.in, www.icicisecurities.com, www.iiflcapital.com, www.jefferies.com, www.jmfl.com, www.jpmipl.com, www.sbicaps.com, www.ubs.com/indiaoffers and www.360.one for the "Basis for Issue Price" section updated with the above price band)*

AN INDICATIVE TIMETABLE IN RESPECT OF THE ISSUE IS SET OUT BELOW:

Submission of Bids (other than Bids from Anchor Investors)

Particulars	Time
Bid/ Issue Period (except the Bid/ Issue Closing Date)	
Submission and revision in Bids	Only between 9:00 a.m. and 7:00 p.m. (Indian Standard Time ("IST"))
Bid/ Issue Closing Date*^	
Submission of electronic applications (Online ASBA through 3-in-1 accounts) – For RIIs, other than QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors, Eligible Employees Bidding in Employee Reservation Portion and Eligible RIL Shareholders Bidding in RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (Bank ASBA through online channels like internet banking, mobile banking and Syndicate UPI ASBA applications where Bid Amount is up to ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of electronic applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual applications for bids beyond ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (Bank ASBA)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 1:00 p.m. IST
Submission of physical applications (Syndicate Non-Retail, Non-Individual applications of QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors where Bid Amount is more than ₹ 500,000)	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 1:00 p.m. IST
Modification/ Revision/ cancellation of Bids	
Upward revision of Bids by QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors categories#	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST on Bid/ Issue Closing Date
Upward or downward revision of Bids or cancellation of Bids by RIIs, Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion and Eligible RIL Shareholders Bidding in RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion	Only between 9:00 a.m. and up to 7:00 p.m. IST on Bid/ Issue Closing Date

** UPI mandate end time and date shall be at 7:00 p.m. IST on the Bid/ Issue Closing Date.*

 # QIBs and Non-Institutional Investors can neither revise their bids downwards nor cancel/ withdraw their Bids.

BID/ISSUE PERIOD

Event	Indicative Date
Anchor Investor Bidding	Monday, October 19, 2026
Bid/Issue Opens on	Wednesday, October 21, 2026
Bid/Issue Closes on	Friday, October 23, 2026
Finalization of Basis of Allotment with the Designated Stock Exchange	On or about Monday, October 26, 2026
Initiation of refunds (if any, for Anchor Investors) / unblocking of funds from ASBA Account*	On or about Tuesday, October 27, 2026
Credit of Equity Shares to dematerialized accounts of Allottees	On or about Tuesday, October 27, 2026
Commencement of trading of the Equity Shares on the Stock Exchanges	On or about Wednesday, October 28, 2026

**In case of (i) any delay in unblocking of amounts in the ASBA Accounts (including amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism) for cancelled / withdrawn / deleted ASBA Forms, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date on which the request for cancellation/ withdrawal/ deletion is placed in the Stock Exchanges bidding platform until the date on which the amounts are unblocked; (ii) any blocking of multiple amounts for the same ASBA Form (for amounts blocked through the UPI Mechanism), the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the total cumulative blocked amount except the original application amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such multiple amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iii) any blocking of amounts more than the Bid Amount, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the difference in amount, whichever is higher from the date on which such excess amounts were blocked till the date of actual unblock; (iv) any delay in unblocking of non-allotted/ partially allotted Bids, exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Issue Closing Date, the Bidder shall be compensated at a uniform rate of ₹ 100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher for the entire duration of delay exceeding two Working Days from the Bid/ Issue Closing Date by the SCSB responsible for causing such delay in unblocking. The BRLMs shall, in their sole discretion, identify and fix the liability on such intermediary or entity responsible for such delay in unblocking. The post Issue BRLMs shall be liable for compensating the Bidder at a uniform rate of ₹100 per day or 15% per annum of the Bid Amount, whichever is higher from the date of receipt of the investor grievance until the date on which the blocked amounts are unblocked. The Bidder shall be compensated in the manner specified in the ICDR Master Circular, and the SEBI RTA Master Circular, which for the avoidance of doubt, shall be deemed to be incorporated in the deemed agreement of the Company with the SCSBs, to the extent applicable.*

THE EQUITY SHARES OF OUR COMPANY WILL BE LISTED ON THE MAIN BOARD PLATFORMS OF BSE AND NSE

In case of any revision in the Price Band, the Bid/ Issue Period will be extended by at least three additional Working Days after such revision in the Price Band, subject to the Bid/ Issue Period not exceeding 10 Working Days. In cases of force majeure, banking strike or similar unforeseen circumstances, our Company in consultation with the BRLMs, may, for reasons to be recorded in writing, extend the Bid/ Issue Period for a minimum of one Working Day, subject to the Bid/ Issue Period not exceeding 10 Working Days in compliance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations. Any revision in the Price Band and the revised Bid/ Issue Period, if applicable, shall be widely disseminated by notification to the Stock Exchanges, by issuing a public notice, and also by indicating the change on the respective websites of the BRLMs and at the terminals of the Syndicate Members and by intimation to the Self-Certified Syndicate Banks ("**SCSBs**"), other Designated Intermediaries and the Sponsor Bank(s), as applicable. However, in case of revision in the Price Band, the Bid Lot shall remain the same.

The Issue is being made through the Book Building Process, in terms of Rule 19(2)(b) of the SCRR read with Regulation 31 of the SEBI ICDR Regulations and in compliance with Regulation 6(1) of the SEBI ICDR Regulations, wherein not more than 50% of the Net Issue shall be allocated on a proportionate basis to Qualified Institutional Buyers ("**QIBs**") ("**QIB Portion**"), provided that our Company, in consultation with the Book Running Lead Managers may allocate up to 60% of the QIB Portion to Anchor Investors on a discretionary basis in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations ("**Anchor Investor Portion**"), and 40% of such Anchor Investor Portion shall be reserved as under: (i) 33.33% for domestic Mutual Funds, and (ii) 6.67% for Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds, subject to valid Bids being received from domestic Mutual Funds, Life Insurance Companies and Pension Funds at or above the Anchor Investor Allocation Price. In the event of under-subscription, or non-allocation in the Anchor Investor Portion, the balance Equity Shares shall be added to the QIB Portion ("**Net QIB Portion**"). Further, 5% of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis only to Mutual Funds, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price, and the remainder of the Net QIB Portion shall be available for allocation on a proportionate basis to all QIBs, including Mutual Funds subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. However, if the aggregate demand from Mutual Funds is less than 5% of the Net QIB Portion, the balance Equity Shares available for allocation in the Mutual Fund Portion will be added to the remaining Net QIB Portion for proportionate allocation to all QIBs. Further, not less than 15% of the Net Issue shall be available for allocation to Non- Institutional Bidders and not less than 35% of the Net Issue shall be available for allocation to Retail Individual Bidders ("**RIBs**") in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. One-third of the Non-Institutional Portion shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders with a Bid size of more than ₹ 200,000 and up to ₹ 1,000,000 and two-thirds of the Non-Institutional Portion shall be available for allocation to Non-Institutional Bidders with a Bid size of more than ₹ 1,000,000 provided that under-subscription in either of these two sub-categories of the Non-Institutional Portion may be allocated to Non-Institutional Bidders in the other sub-category of Non-Institutional Portion in accordance with the SEBI ICDR Regulations, subject to valid Bids being received at or above the Issue Price. Further, Equity Shares will be allocated on a proportionate basis to Eligible Employees Bidding in the Employee Reservation Portion, and Eligible Shareholders Bidding in the RIL Shareholders Reservation Portion subject to valid Bids received from them at or above the Issue Price. All potential Bidders (except Anchor Investors) are mandatorily required to participate in the Issue through the Application Supported by Blocked Amount ("**ASBA**") process by providing details of their respective ASBA accounts and UPI ID in case of UPI Bidders, as applicable, pursuant to which their corresponding Bid Amount will be blocked by the Self Certified Syndicate Banks ("**SCSBs**") or by the Sponsor Bank(s) under the UPI Mechanism, as the case may be, to the extent of the respective Bid Amounts. Anchor Investors are not permitted to participate in the Issue through the ASBA process. For details, see *"Issue Procedure"* beginning on page 534 of the RHP.

Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that DP ID, PAN, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) are correctly filled in the Bid cum Application Form. The DP ID, PAN and Client ID provided in the Bid cum Application Form should match with the DP ID, PAN, Client ID available in the Depository database, otherwise, the Bid cum Application Form is liable to be rejected. Bidders/ Applicants should ensure that the beneficiary account provided in the Bid cum Application Form is active. Bidders/Applicants should note that on the basis of the PAN, DP ID, Client ID and UPI ID (for UPI Bidders bidding through the UPI Mechanism) as provided in the Bid cum Application Form, the Bidder/Applicant may be deemed to have authorised the Depositories to provide to the Registrar to the Issue, any requested Demographic Details of the Bidder/Applicant as available on the records of the depositories. These Demographic Details may be used, among other things, for giving Allotment Advice or unblocking of ASBA Account or for other correspondence(s) related to the Issue. Bidders/Applicants are advised to update any changes to their Demographic Details as available in the records of the Depository Participant to ensure accuracy of records. Any delay resulting from failure to update the Demographic Details would be at the Bidders'/Applicants' sole risk. Investors must ensure that their PAN is linked with Aadhaar and are in compliance with the CBDT notification dated February 13, 2020 and press release dated June 25, 2021, read with press release dated September 17, 2021 and CBDT circular no.7 of 2022, dated March 30, 2022 read with press release dated March 28, 2023 and any subsequent press releases in this regard.

Contents of the Memorandum of Association of our Company as regards its objects: For information on the main objects of our Company, please see the section "*History and Certain Corporate Matters*" on page 249 of the RHP. The Memorandum of Association of our Company is a material document for inspection in relation to the Issue. For further details, please see the section titled "*Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection*" on page 577 of the RHP.

Liability of the members of our Company: Limited by shares.

Amount of share capital of our Company and capital structure: As on the date of the RHP, the authorised share capital of our Company is ₹1,900,000,000,000 divided into 10,000,000,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each and 180,000,000,000 preference shares of face value of ₹10 each. The issued, subscribed and paid-up Equity share capital of our Company is ₹89,390,308,300 divided into 8,939,030,830 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each. For more details of the capital structure of the Company, see "Capital Structure" beginning on page 99 of the RHP.

Names of the initial signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company and the Number of Equity Shares Subscribed by them: The initial signatories to the Memorandum of Association of the Company is Reliance Industries Limited (including one Equity Share each allotted to six individuals as nominees of RIL) (10,000 Equity Shares of face value of ₹10 each). For more details of the share capital history of our Company please see "Capital Structure" beginning on page 99 of the RHP.

Listing: The Equity Shares offered through the RHP are proposed to be listed on the Stock Exchanges. Our Company has received 'in-principle' approvals from BSE and NSE for the listing of the Equity Shares pursuant to their letters each dated July 7, 2026. For the purposes of the Issue, the Designated Stock Exchange shall be NSE. A signed copy of the RHP and the Prospectus has been and shall be delivered to the RoC as applicable, in accordance with Sections 26(4) and 32 of the Companies Act, 2013. For details of the material contracts and documents available for inspection from the date of the Red Herring Prospectus up to the Bid/ Issue Closing Date, see "Material Contracts and Documents for Inspection" beginning on page 577 of the RHP.

Disclaimer clause of the SEBI: SEBI only gives its observations on the Issue documents and this does not constitute approval of either the Issue or the specified securities stated in the Issue document. The investors are advised to refer to page 488 of the RHP for the full text of the disclaimer clause of SEBI.

Disclaimer clause of NSE (Designated Stock Exchange): It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by NSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by NSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 493 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of NSE.

Disclaimer clause of BSE: It is to be distinctly understood that the permission given by BSE should not in any way be deemed or construed that the RHP has been cleared or approved by BSE nor does it certify the correctness or completeness of any of the contents of the RHP. The investors are advised to refer to page 493 of the RHP for the full text of the Disclaimer Clause of BSE.

General risk: Investments in equity and equity-related securities involve a degree of risk and investors should not invest any funds in the Issue unless they can afford to take the risk of losing their entire investment. Investors are advised to read the risk factors carefully before taking an investment decision in the Issue. For taking an investment decision, investors must rely on their own examination of our Company and the Issue, including the risks involved. The Equity Shares in the Issue have not been recommended or approved by SEBI, nor does SEBI guarantee the accuracy or adequacy of the contents of the RHP. Specific attention of the investors is invited to "**Risk Factors**" beginning on page 30 of the RHP

BOOK RUNNING LEAD MANAGERS

Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited
1st Floor, 27 BKC, Plot No. C27, 'G' Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East) , Mumbai - 400 051
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4336 0000
E-mail: jio.ipo@kotak.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: kmccredressal@kotak.com
Website: https://investmentbank.kotak.com
Contact Person: Ganesh Rane
SEBI Registration No.: INM000008704

Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited
Altimus, Level 39 & 40
Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 018
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6118 1000
E-mail: jpl_ipo@morganstanley.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
investors_india@morganstanley.com
Website: https://www.morganstanley.com/india
Contact Person: Keyur Thakar/ Hrithik Khanna
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011203

BofA Securities India Limited
Ground Floor, "A" Wing, One BKC, "G" Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 025
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6632 8000
E-mail: dg.jpl_ipo@bofa.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
dg.india_merchantbanking@bofa.com
Website: https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia
Contact Person: Sahil H. Jain
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011625

Axis Capital Limited
1st Floor, Axis House
P.B. Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 025, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4325 2183
E-mail: jio.ipo@axiscap.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: complaints@axiscap.in
Website: www.axiscapital.co.in
Contact Person: Sanaea Sumondy/ Simran Gadh
SEBI Registration No: INM000012029

BNP Paribas
1, North Avenue Maker Maxity
Bandra-Kurla Complex, Bandra (E), Mumbai - 400 051
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 3370 4000
E-mail: LIST.CIB.JioIPO@asia.bnpparibas.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
indiainvestors.care@asia.bnpparibas.com
Website: www.bnpparibas.co.in
Contact Person: Ankur Thacker
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011534

Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited
1202, 12th Floor, First International Financial Center, G Block
Bandra Kurla Complex, Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 098
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6175 9999
E-mail: jio.ipo@citi.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investors.cgmib@citi.com
Website: www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking
Contact Person: Naman Kulshreshtha
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010718

CLSA India Private Limited
8/F Dalamal House
Nariman Point, Mumbai - 400 021, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6650 5050
E-mail: jio.ipo@clsa.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: investor.helpdesk@clsa.com
Website: www.india.clsa.com
Contact Person: Prachi Chandgothia
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010619

DAM Capital Advisors Limited
Altimus 2202, Level 22
Pandurang Budhkar Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 018
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4202 2500
E-mail: jio.ipo@damcapital.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: complaint@damcapital.in
Website: www.damcapital.in
Contact Person: Aanchal Wagle/ Jay Shah
SEBI Registration No.: MB/INM000011336

Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited
9th and 10th Floor, Ascent-Worli
Sudam Kalu Ahire Marg, Worli, Mumbai - 400 025
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6616 9000
E-mail: jioipo@gs.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: india-client-support@gs.com
Website: www.goldmansachs.com
Contact Person: Saurav S
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011054

HDFC Bank Limited
Investment Banking Group
Unit no. 701, 702 and 702-A, 7th Floor, Tower 2 and 3
One International Centre, Senapati Bapat Marg, Prabhadevi
Mumbai - 400 013, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 3395 8233
E-mail: jioplatforms.ipo@hdfc.bank.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: investor.redressal@hdfcbank.com
Website: www.hdfc.bank.in
Contact Person: Bharti Ranga/ Souradeep Ghosh
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011252

HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited
52/60, Mahatma Gandhi Road, Fort, Mumbai - 400 001
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6864 1289
E-mail: jplipo@hsbc.co.in
Investor Grievance E-mail: investorgrievance@hsbc.co.in
Website: www.business.hsbc.co.in
Contact Person: Harsh Thakkar/ Harshit Tayal
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010353

ICICI Securities Limited
Appasaheb Marathe Marg, Prabhadevi, Mumbai - 400 025
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6807 7100
E-mail: jioplatforms.ipo@icicisecurities.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: customercare@icicisecurities.com
Website: www.icicisecurities.com
Contact Person: Ramesh Vaswana / Soumavo Sarkar
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011179

IIFL Capital Services Limited
(formerly known as IIFL Securities Limited)
24th Floor, One Lodha Place
Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai - 400 013
Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4646 4728
E-mail: jio.ipo@iiflcap.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: ig.ib@iiflcap.com
Website: www.iiflcapital.com
Contact Person: Gaurav Mittal/ Pawan Kumar Jain
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010940

Jefferies India Private Limited
Level 16, Express Towers
Nariman Point, Mumbai - 400 021, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4356 6000
E-mail: Jio.Platforms.IPO@jefferies.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: jipl.grievance@jefferies.com
Website: www.jefferies.com
Contact Person: Akshat Shah/ Meghna Biju
SEBI Registration No.: INM000011443

JM Financial Limited
7th Floor, Cnergy, Appasaheb Marathe Marg
Prabhadevi, Mumbai - 400 025, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6630 3030
E-mail: jpl.ipo@jmfl.com
Investor Grievance E-mail: grievance.ibd@jmfl.com
Website: www.jmfl.com
Contact Person: Prachee Dhuri
SEBI Registration No.: INM000010361

J.P. Morgan India Private Limited
J.P. Morgan Towers
Off C.S.T Road, Kalina, Santacruz (East),
Mumbai - 400 098 Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6157 3000
E-mail: JIO_IPO@jpmorgan.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
investorsmb.jpmipl@jpmorgan.com
Website: www.jpmipl.com
Contact Person: Shivam Goel/ Rishank Chheda
SEBI Registration No.: INM000002970

SBI Capital Markets Limited
1501, 15th Floor, A & B Wing, G Block,
Parinee Crescenzo, Bandra Kurla Complex,
Bandra (East), Mumbai - 400 051 Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4006 9807
E-mail: jio.ipo@sbicaps.com
Website: www.sbicaps.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
investor.relations@sbicaps.com
Contact Person: Krithika Shetty/ Prashant Patankar
SEBI Registration No.: INM000003531

UBS Securities India Private Limited
Unit 2901, Level 29, Altimus,
Dr. GM Gokhale Marg /
Pandurang Budhkar Road,
Worli, Mumbai - 400 018, Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 6155 6000
E-mail: OL-jioipo@ubs.com
Website: www.ubs.com/indiaoffers
Investor Grievance E-mail: igbmindia@ubs.com
Contact Person: Vidhit Patni
SEBI Registration No.: INM000013101

360 ONE WAM Limited
360 ONE Centre, Kamala City
Senapati Bapat Marg, Lower Parel (West),
Mumbai - 400 013 Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 4031 7000
Email: jioplatforms.ipo@360.one
Investor Grievance E-mail:
mbinvestorcomplaints@360.one
Website: www.360.one
Contact Person: Devesh Patkar
SEBI Registration No.: INM000012801

REGISTRAR TO THE ISSUE

KFin Technologies Limited
Selenium Tower-B, Plot No. 31 & 32, Gachibowli,
Financial District, Nanakramguda, Serilingampally
Hyderabad - 500 032, Telangana, India
Tel: + 91 40 6716 2222/ 1800 309 4001
E-mail: jioplatforms.ipo@kfintech.com
Investor Grievance E-mail:
einward.ris@kfintech.com
Website: www.kfintech.com
Contact Person: Williams R
SEBI Registration No.: INR000000221

Company Secretary
Ms. Savithri Parekh

Compliance Officer
Mr. Venkataraman Ramachandran

TC-22, 5th Floor, A Wing, Reliance Corporate Park,
Thane Belapur Road, Ghansoli,
Navi Mumbai 400 701Maharashtra, India
Tel: +91 22 7967 0000
E-mail: jpl.investorrelations@jio.com

Investors may contact the Company Secretary or Compliance Officer or the Registrar to the Issue in case of any pre-Issue or post-Issue related grievances including non-receipt of letters of Allotment, non-credit of Allotted Equity Shares in the respective beneficiary account, non-receipt of refund orders or non-receipt of funds by electronic mode, etc. For all Issue related queries and for redressal of complaints, investors may also write to the BRLMs.

Continued on next page...

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AVAILABILITY OF THE RHP:

Investors are advised to refer to the RHP and the section titled **"Risk Factors"** on page 30 of the RHP, before applying in the Issue. A copy of the RHP is made available on website of SEBI at **www.sebi.gov.in**, websites of the Stock Exchanges i.e. BSE Limited and National Stock Exchange of India Limited at **www.bseindia.com** and **www.nseindia.com**, respectively, and on the website of the Company at **https://www.jio.com**; and on the websites of the BRLMs, i.e. **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited** – https://investmentbank.kotak.com; **Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited** – https://www.morganstanley.com/india; **BofA Securities India Limited** – https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia; **Axis Capital Limited** – www.axiscapital.co.in; **BNP Paribas** – www.bnpparibas.co.in; **Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited** – www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking; **CLSA India Private Limited** – www.india.clsa.com; **DAM Capital Advisors Limited** – www.damcapital.in; **Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited** – www.goldmansachs.com; **HDFC Bank Limited** – www.hdfc.bank.in; **HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited** – www.business.hsbc.co.in; **ICICI Securities Limited** – www.icicisecurities.com; **IIFL Capital Services Limited** – www.iiflcapital.com; **Jefferies India Private Limited** – www.jefferies.com; **JM Financial Limited** – www.jmfl.com; **J.P. Morgan India Private Limited** – www.jpmipl.com; **SBI Capital Markets Limited** – www.sbicaps.com; **UBS Securities India Private Limited** – www.ubs.com/indiaoffers; **360 ONE WAM Limited** – www.360.one;.

AVAILABILITY OF THE ABRIDGED PROSPECTUS:

A copy of the abridged prospectus is made available on the website of the Company, the BRLMs and the Registrar to the Issue at **https://www.jio.com/platforms/** ; **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited** – https://investmentbank.kotak.com; **Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited** – https://www.morganstanley.com/india; **BofA Securities India Limited** – https://business.bofa.com/bofasindia; **Axis Capital Limited** – www.axiscapital.co.in; **BNP Paribas** – www.bnpparibas.co.in; **Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited** – www.citigroup.com/global/about-us/global-presence/india/regulatory-disclosures-investment-banking; **CLSA India Private Limited** – www.india.clsa.com; **DAM Capital Advisors Limited** – www.damcapital.in; **Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited** – www.goldmansachs.com; **HDFC Bank Limited** – www.hdfc.bank.in; **HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited** – www.business.hsbc.co.in; **ICICI Securities Limited** – www.icicisecurities.com; **IIFL Capital Services Limited** – www.iiflcapital.com; **Jefferies India Private Limited** – www.jefferies.com; **JM Financial Limited** – www.jmfl.com; **J.P. Morgan India Private Limited** – www.jpmipl.com; **SBI Capital Markets Limited** – www.sbicaps.com; **UBS Securities India Private Limited** – www.ubs.com/indiaoffers; **360 ONE WAM Limited** – www.360.one; Registrar to the Issue, **KFin Technologies Limited** – www.kfintech.com., respectively.

AVAILABILITY OF BID CUM APPLICATION FORMS:

Bid cum Application Forms can be obtained from the Registered and Corporate Office of **JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED**, **Tel**: +91 22 7967 0000; BRLMs: **Kotak Mahindra Capital Company Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4336 0000**; Morgan Stanley India Company Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6118 1000**; BofA Securities India Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6632 8000**; Axis Capital Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4325 2183**; BNP Paribas,** Telephone: +91 22 3370 4000**; Citigroup Global Markets India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6175 9999**; CLSA India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6650 5050**; DAM Capital Advisors Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4202 2500**; Goldman Sachs (India) Securities Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6616 9000**; HDFC Bank Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 3395 8233**; HSBC Securities and Capital Markets (India) Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6864 1289**; ICICI Securities Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6807 7100**; IIFL Capital Services Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4646 4728**; Jefferies India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4356 6000**; JM Financial Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6630 3030**; J.P. Morgan India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6157 3000**; SBI Capital Markets Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4006 9807**; UBS Securities India Private Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 6155 6000**; and 360 ONE WAM Limited,** Telephone: +91 22 4031 7000**; Syndicate Members: HDFC Securities Limited** Tel: +91 2230753400**, Investec Capital Services (India) Private Limited** Tel: + 91 2268497400, **JM Financial Services Limited** Tel: +91 22 6136 3400, **Kotak Securities Limited** Tel: +91 2242858484, **SBICAP Securities Limited** Tel: +91 22 6943 2521, **Sharekhan Limited** Tel: +91 22 6750 2000, **360 ONE Capital Market Private Limited** ***(Formerly known as Batlivala & Karani Securities India Private Limited)*** Tel: + 91 022 40317000 / +91 022 40076000 **and 360 ONE Distribution Services Limited** Tel: 9321332882 and at the select locations of the Sub-syndicate Members (as given below), SCSBs, Registered Brokers, RTAs and CDPs participating in the Issue. Bid cum Application Forms will also be available on the websites of BSE and NSE and the Designated Branches of SCSBs, the list of which is available at websites of the Stock Exchanges and SEBI.

Sub-Syndicate Members:

Almondz Global Securities Ltd, Ambit Capital Limited, Ambit Private Limited, Amrapali Capital & Finance Services Limited, Anand Rathi Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Anand Share Consultancy, ANS Pvt Limited, Asit C Mehta Financial Services Limited, Asit C Mehta Investment Intermediates Limited, Axis Securities Limited, Bajaj Financial Securities Limited, Bob Capital Markets Limited, Centrum Broking Limited, Centrum Capital Advisors Limited, Centrum Finverse limited, Centrum Wealth Management Ltd, Choice Equity Broking Private Limited, Dalal & Broacha Stock Broking Pvt Limited, DB(International) Stock Brokers Ltd, Eureka Stock & Share Broking Services Ltd, G Raj & Co. (Consultants) Limited, Globe Capital Market Limited, IDBI Capital Market Services Limited, Inga Ventures Pvt Ltd, Innovate Securities Pvt Limited, Intensive Fiscal Services Private Limited, Jhaveri Securities, Jobanputra Fiscal Services Private Limited, Kalpataru Multiplier Limited, Kantilal Chhaganlal Securities Pvt.Ltd, Keynote Capitals Limited, KJMC Capital Market Services Limited, Lakshmishree Investment & Securities Pvt Limited, LKP Securities Limited, Marwadi Shares & Finance Ltd, Mehta Equities Limited, Monarch Networth Capital Limited, Motilal Oswal Financial Services Limited, Motilal Oswal Securities Limited, Nextbillion Technology Private Limited, Nirmal Bang Securities Pvt Limited, Nuvama Wealth and Investment Limited (Edelweiss Broking Limited), Nuvama Wealth Management Limited, Pantomath Financial Services Limited, Patel Wealth Advisors Pvt Limited, Paytm, Prabhudas Lilladher Pvt Limited, Pravin Ratilal Share & Stock Brokers Limited, Religare Broking Limited, Religare Securities Limited, Rikhav Securities Ltd, RR Equity Brokers Private Limited, SMC Global Securities Limited, Standard Chartered Securities, Sundae Capital, Sunidhi Securities & Finance Ltd, Sushil Financial Services Pvt. Ltd., Systematix Shares & Stocks (India) Limited, Tanna Financial Services, Tradebulls Securities Private Limited, Trust Securities Limited, Viren M Shah, YES Securities (India) Limited, Zerodha

Escrow Collection Banks: Axis Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited

Refund Banks: Axis Bank Limited and ICICI Bank Limited

Public Issue Account Banks: Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and State Bank of India

Sponsor Banks: Axis Bank Limited, ICICI Bank Limited, Kotak Mahindra Bank Limited and State Bank of India

UPI: UPI Bidders can also bid through UPI mechanism

Jio Platforms Limited has provided a toll free number to address any queries related to the Issue.

Toll free number: 1800 309 4001

You may also address your queries related to the Issue by typing **'Hi'** or **'Hello'** on

WhatsApp to 7977222222

For JIO PLATFORMS LIMITED
On behalf of the Board of Directors

Sd/-
Ms. Savithri Parekh
Company Secretary

Place : Mumbai, Maharashtra
Date : October 21, 2026

All capitalised terms used herein and not specifically defined shall have the same meaning as ascribed to them In the RHP.

Jio Platforms Limited is proposing, subject to receipt of requisite approvals, market conditions and other considerations, to make an initial public offering of its Equity Shares and has filed the RHP with RoC on October 14, 2026. The RHP is made available on the website of SEBI at www.sebi.gov.in, on the websites of the Stock Exchanges, i.e. BSE at www.bseindia.com and NSE at www.nseindia.com, on the website of the Company at www.jio.com and on the respective websites of the BRLMs. Any potential investors should note that investment in equity shares involves a high degree of risk, and for details relating to such risk, please see the section titled **"Risk Factors"** on page 30 of the RHP. Potential investors should not rely on the DRHP filed with SEBI and the Stock Exchanges for making any investment decision and should instead rely on the RHP, as filed with the RoC, for making investment decisions.

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INDIA DIGEST

IAF chief makes final sortie with 1st instructor

Outgoing IAF chief Air Chief Marshal Amar Preet Singh completed his final flying sortie Tuesday, bringing his over four-decade flying career full circle. He flew a 55-minute sortie near Hyderabad in an HJT-16 Kiran Mk-1 trainer with his first flying instructor, Wing Commander V S Kochar (retd), aboard aircraft U 707.

Record 56L footfall at Char Dham this yr

Uttarakhand's Char Dham shrines recorded a record 56 lakh pilgrim visits this year, surpassing the previous high of 52 lakh in 2023. Authorities announced winter closure dates between Nov 10 and 16. Badrinath recorded the highest footfall at 20.6 lakh, followed by Kedarnath at 17.6 lakh, Gangotri at 9.4 lakh and Yamunotri at 8.3 lakh.

HC ex-judge to head Kol stampede probe

The judicial commission probing the Chorbagan stampede will examine lapses by Puja organisers, police, civic body and fire department, Bengal govt told Calcutta HC. CM Suvendu Adhikari said it would likely be headed by a retired HC judge, with no Kolkata police or KMC officials on it.

Mika backs Daler amid drinking allegations

Singer Mika Singh defended fellow artist Daler Mehndi and dismissed widespread social media allegations that the singer performed under the influence of alcohol in Uttarakhand Sunday. In a video message on Instagram, he said, "If you ever see Daler Mehndi drinking alcohol, I'll quit singing."

Ladakh's first med college gets nod

Health ministry approved operationalisation of Ladakh's first medical college in Leh, with courses set to begin in 2027–28. SNM Hosp will provide clinical training.

In presence of Pak min, Rajnath slams terror

Says There Can Be No Double Standards

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Rajnath Singh during the SCO meeting in Dushanbe Tuesday

Defence minister Rajnath Singh, in the presence of Pakistan's deputy PM and foreign minister Mohammad Ishaq Dar at the SCO meeting in Dushanbe, said Tuesday there should not be "double standards" on terrorism as it "not only harms innocent lives but also investment and commerce".

Addressing the 25th meeting of the Council of Heads of Govt of SCO, Rajnath called upon member states to make concerted efforts to dismantle the entire ecosystem of terrorism, describing the menace as one of the gravest threats to peace and development. "Terrorism radicalises societies and deprives youth of the opportunities they rightfully deserve. There can be no justification for terrorism, no double standards in addressing it, and no place for those who finance, support, or provide safe havens to terrorists," he said.

Hinting at the supply chain disruptions due to West Asia conflict, Rajnath, who represented India on behalf of PM Narendra Modi, said, "In the changing global economic environment, SCO countries will have to work together on resilient supply chains, better trade and investment, and technology-driven development. India's vision is clear — ensuring inclusive development for all member countries through security, connectivity, and opportunity."

Pointing out that India supports initiatives that link markets, facilitate trade and create new avenues for development, he said initiatives such as the International North-South Transport Corridor and Chabahar Port can contribute to connecting Central Asia with broader markets. Stressing that the benefits of economic cooperation must reach all sections of society, he reaffirmed India's support for the adoption of an action plan for the multilateral trade and economic cooperation programme for the period 2026-2030.

He urged the SCO to build on the foundation established over past 25 years and chart a forward-looking roadmap focused on consensus-driven cooperation and tangible outcomes.

TVK under fire over parole to blasts convicts who targeted Advani in '98

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

BJP demanded immediate cancellation of the parole, saying it amounted to an injustice to the 58 people killed and over 250 wounded in the Feb 14, 1998 serial blasts in Coimbatore

Coimbatore: Tamil Nadu govt's 60-day parole for five convicts in the 1998 Coimbatore serial bomb blasts has triggered a BJP backlash, with party members accusing CM C Joseph Vijay's TVK of "minority appeasement" and linking the move to its alliance with IUML.

BJP state chief Nainar Nagenthran demanded immediate cancellation of the parole, saying it amounted to an injustice to the 58 people killed and more than 250 wounded in a series of coordinated blasts on Feb 14, 1998. The explosions were intended to target then BJP chief LK Advani, who was in Coimbatore to address a campaign rally before that year's LS polls.

BJP's Vanathi Srinivasan questioned the grounds for granting the relief.

"On whose recommendation was the parole granted? The TN minister for prisons must explain the reason behind the decision," she said.

Convicts Mohammed Ansari, Mohammed Ali, Monappa alias Mohammed Hassan, Mohammed Ajam and Nawab Khan were released from Coimbatore central prison Saturday.

TVK MLA VMS Mustafa defended the move and thanked Vijay, while BJP's Narayanan Thirupathi accused govt of taking a "soft approach" towards the convicts.

Police said the parole was not unprecedented, though earlier spells had lasted a week or a fortnight. The latest release followed a govt order issued in Feb allowing eligible convicts who have completed 10 years in prison to receive furlough of up to 60 days.

The order makes furlough conditional, including satisfactory conduct in jail. DGP (prisons) may grant up to 60 days in a year, while govt can approve a further spell of up to 60 days if necessary for rehabilitation, with reasons recorded in writing.

The order was issued on Feb 14. It followed a writ petition before Madras HC seeking release of bomb blast convicts who had spent more than two decades in jail. HC directed state govt to consider their demands.

Worker killed in illegal midnight hunt in SGNP

Mumbai: A 60-year-old municipal sanitation worker was accidentally shot dead during an illegal wild boar hunt inside Sanjay Gandhi National Park late Monday. Two persons were injured, reports **Suhas Birhade**. Police have arrested four, including a doctor accused of issuing a false death certificate, for allegedly concealing the death and arranging the deceased's cremation without informing cops or conducting a postmortem.

According to police, a group of five to six entered the forest with firearms. One of the hunters accidentally hit a member of his own group, Vijay Sukharu Sapte, in the chest. Sapte died on the spot. Two other members of the group, Kunal Shelar and Kalpesh Dhangala, sustained gunshot injuries.

Initially, the men said they sustained injuries when an explosive device used for fishing in a river exploded. However, investigations reportedly revealed that the injuries occurred during the hunting expedition.

Pending FIR no ground to stall gratuity: HC

Ahmedabad: Gratuity can't be withheld on the ground of pending criminal proceedings, Gujarat HC has observed, ordering authorities to release the "valuable statutory retiral benefit" to a petitioner and retired Arvalli district panchayat employee.

The petitioner, Kanaiyalal Patel, who retired in May 2025, moved HC after his gratuity was withheld due to a pending FIR lodged in 2017 regarding alleged financial irregularities in an employees' credit cooperative society, where he served as an office-bearer.

The state relied on Rules 142 and 145 of Gujarat Civil Services (Pension) Rules, 2002 to justify withholding the gratuity.

However, HC noted no departmental inquiry had been initiated into the criminal case. Moreover, the criminal proceedings were not related to Patel's job, and no loss was caused to the public exchequer due to the alleged criminal offence, it observed. TNN

HC cites nat'l security, junks CIC order to IAF on PMs' foreign trips

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: Delhi HC has set aside a Central Information Commission order directing the Indian Air Force to disclose flight records pertaining to foreign visits undertaken by PM **Narendra Modi** and former PM **Manmohan Singh**, stating such disclosure could compromise national security and the PM's safety.

Allowing a petition by the Central Public Information Officer of Directorate of Personal Services, Air Headquarters, Justice Amit Mahajan held the IAF was justified in denying access to the records under section 8 of RTI that exempts disclosure of information that could jeopardise national security or pose a risk to a person's life and physical safety.

HC said CIC erred in directing disclosure of Special Flight Returns (SFR-II) after redaction of the names and particulars of security personnel, observing removing such details would not necessarily eliminate the potential security risks.

The RTI plea was filed by retired Commodore Lokesh K Batra in 2018, seeking information about foreign visits by Indian PMs on IAF aircraft from April 1, 2013, until the date of his application.

In response, the IAF provided certain information about Modi's foreign travels, and stated there had been no travel by ex-PM Singh on IAF aircraft during the period from April 1, 2013 to May 25, 2014. However, it refused to disclose copies of the SFR, Part-I and Part-II, citing national security concerns and the confidential nature of the records.

Batra approached CIC, which directed the IAF on July 8, 2020, to provide certified copies of available and relevant SFR-II records to the applicant.

The IAF challenged the CIC order, contending the records contained sensitive information that could potentially enable the identification of security personnel, reveal the composition of PM's entourage and allow inferences to be drawn about patterns of security deployment.

Justice Mahajan said, "The mere fact that public funds have been expended on the foreign visits of the PM does not, by itself, justify disclosure of information which may compromise the security arrangements put in place for such visits."

Ladakh LG clears hill councils for all 8 districts

Srinagar: Ladakh will extend its autonomous hill council system to all eight districts under a presidential regulation notified on Tuesday by lieutenant governor **Vinai Kumar Saxena**, expanding a framework that covered only Leh and Kargil.

Saxena said Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Councils (Amendment) Regulation, 2026, took effect on Oct 19, after President Droupadi Murmu promulgated it on Oct 16. Union Cabinet approved the amendments on Oct 14. "The historic regulation, implemented in a record time of just six days, now paves the way for creation of LAHDC in all eight districts," he posted on X.

The Union territory, earlier divided into Leh and Kargil districts, has been reorganised into eight districts. On Oct 16, Saxena announced Sankoo as a new district.

Sankoo will come under the framework that allows each council between seven and twenty-four constituencies and four nominated members representing women and unrepresented communities. —**Naseer Ganai**

Captive-bred GIB released into wild killed by fox

Jaisalmer: The experimental release of captive-bred Great Indian Bustards (GIB) into the wild suffered a setback as a desert fox killed a six-month-old male bird at Desert National Park in Jaisalmer's Sam Sunday, reports **Vimal Bhatia**.

The bird, released last Wednesday, was drinking water at a gajlar, a natural water point, when the fox attacked it.

This came to light through satellite tracking, prompting Wildlife Institute of India (WII) scientists and forest department officials monitoring the birds from a control room at the Sam breeding centre to rush to the spot. By the time the team arrived, the fox had fled. Officials recovered scattered feathers and remains of the bird, collected blood samples for lab examination and retrieved the satellite-tracking device attached to it.

WII scientists are reviewing the release protocol and conservation measures to reduce the risk of similar attacks in future.

The remaining seven birds identified for release will be let into the wild only after the programme and its safeguards have been reviewed.

Degree can't make up for lost limb, says Maha tribunal

Rejects Insurer's Claim Of No Loss To Income, Awards BTech Grad ₹3Cr

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DISABILITY CLAIM

Mumbai: Observing that an engineering student's resilience in completing her degree "in no way" compensated for the loss of her right upper limb, Motor Accident Claims Tribunal directed a bus owner and National Insurance Co Ltd to jointly and severally pay Snehal Zanjurne almost Rs 3 crore, inclusive of interest, in compensation.

Member Gauri Kawdikar allowed Zanjurne's claim, holding she suffered permanent disability in a 2019 accident involving a private bus, and that the accident occurred due to rash and negligent driving.

Rejecting the insurer's contention that there was no loss of earning capacity because Zanjurne completed her BTech in first class and was preparing for the MPSC examination, the tribunal said, "Though the claimant has shown resilience and completed her BTech with First Class showing good amount of will power, determination, dedication; the personal qualities of the claimant in no way can be said to compensate for the loss of right upper limb."

In addition to other heads, final compensation also included Rs five lakh for loss of marriage prospects and Rs two lakh for disfigurement. "Amputation in itself undoubtedly leaves scar not only on the physical body but also very negative psychological, emotional and mental impact. Loss of right upper limb would undoubtedly cause hardship to the claimant, would lower her physical capacity and also affect her self esteem, societal appearance. Said loss is only because of the accidental injuries and she has to be duly compensated for the same," it said.

The tribunal held that the owner was vicariously liable and that the insurer must indemnify the owner under the insurance policy.

According to the claim submitted in 2020, on June 18, 2019, Zanjurne (then 20) was travelling from Satara to Surat when the bus, allegedly being driven at high and excessive speed on Western Express highway, turned turtle after the driver lost control. An FIR was registered under IPC and MV Act.

Owner, Omprakash Sadwani, was proceeded against ex parte on June 27, 2023. National Insurance, the insurer, contested the claim, arguing the bus driver did not possess a valid driving licence and that the vehicle lacked a valid permit, amounting to a breach of policy conditions. It also disputed Zanjurne's age, entitlement to compensation, etc.

The tribunal rejected the insurer's objections.

Influencer dies by suicide after cyberbullying, defamatory posts

TIMES NEW NETWORK

Police said his online channel was mass-reported and blocked in Sept, along with another social media account

Chennai: A 27-year-old financial consultant and social media influencer has died by suicide after alleged cyberbullying, defamatory social media posts and repeated blocking of his online channels.

V Harish, who had 1.3 million followers on social media, was found dead at his rented villa in Chennai Tuesday. He had been posting content on finance and investments for the past five years.

Police said his online channel was mass-reported and blocked in Sept, along with another social media account. He launched a new channel, which was also reported and blocked.

Harish's father, J Vinayagam, lodged a complaint with police alleging another influencer Jason Samuel had subjected his son to sustained cyberbullying, defamatory posts and threats, causing severe mental distress. As per the complaint, Samuel published videos and posts on Oct 18 accusing Harish of being a fraud and misleading people.

Harish purportedly recorded a video before his death, saying Samuel is responsible for his decision. In the video, Harish reportedly claimed Samuel had threatened to get all his social media accounts blocked and prevent him from creating new ones.

Samuel denied the allegations in a social media post. He said he had questioned Harish's credentials and authorisation to provide financial advice. Harish did not have Sebi's registered investment adviser licence and had misrepresented his registration with Association of Mutual Funds in India, he said, adding he never expected Harish to take such an extreme step.

Police have registered a case of unnatural death and are looking at statements of both the sides.

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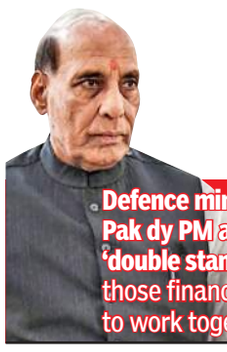

Defence minister Rajnath Singh, in presence of Pak dy PM at SCO meet, says there should be no 'double standards' on terrorism and 'no place for those financing it, and calls for member countries to work together on resilient supply chains, PG OPP

Alberta residents vote to remain part of Canada in the province's first referendum on separation, giving PM Mark Carney a boost as he seeks to unify the country amid a trade war with US, P 14

FLIPPED IT by THE TIMES OF INDIA

A 60-SECOND DAILY WORD CHALLENGE. Crack the word, build your streak, share your score. Top scorers get featured in **TOI**

India's medal tally surges to 35 at Asian Para Games, with a rich haul of 24 medals on Day 2. 5 gold medals include record performances by Deepthi in women's 400m T20 and **Simran in 200m T12** and Nishad Kumar in high jump, P 15

17-day hunger strike at JNU comes to an end

JNU Students' Union Tuesday called off its 17-day hunger strike after the administration agreed to address several of its demands, including revoking the rustication of union office-bearers, withdrawing FIRs against students and reviewing the controversial chief proctor's office (CPO) manual, which penalises protests on campus. The stir began on Oct 3, with 18 students sitting on hunger strike near Sabarmati T-point. P 4

13 feared drowned in UP, Rajasthan

Nine people drowned in UP and four in Rajasthan during immersion of Durga idols on Tuesday. In UP's Gonda, three teens and a man drowned; in Prayagraj, two cousins drowned. In Kota, four men were missing after a boat overturned. P 9

Smartphone sales plunge in July-Sept

India's smartphone market suffered its steepest contraction in several quarters, with shipments plunging 26% in July-Sept. Higher prices put buyers off upgrades and prompted companies to curb supplies ahead of the festive season. P 11

Fox kills captive-bred 6-mth-old bustard

The experimental release of captive-bred Great Indian Bustards into the wild suffered a setback as a desert fox killed a six-month-old male bird at a national park in Jaisalmer Sunday when the bird, released last Wednesday, was drinking water. PG OPP

India & US to boost def, energy ties, Rubio says trade deal close

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Foreign minister S Jaishankar met his US counterpart Marco Rubio in Mumbai, agreeing to further expand cooperation in energy, defence and technology ties and committing to an early conclusion of the trade deal still under discussion.

While Rubio emphasised the role that US can play in the diversification of India's energy and defence supplies, Jaishankar said in a post on X that they also discussed people-to-people ties, alluding to India's concerns over immigration and H-1B governance issues. Speaking at the US anniversary celebrations later, Jaishankar said in Rubio's presence that Indian talent and skills have helped shape the tech era in US.

The ministers met ahead of a likely meeting between PM Modi and President Donald Trump next month on the margins of the Asean summit in Manila, and also before Modi's visit to US in Dec for the G20 meet.

AP

Marco Rubio (2nd from left) and his wife Jeanette Dousdebes with Maharashtra CM Devendra Fadnavis and US ambassador Sergio Gor at Gateway of India

'Have to balance things': Rubio defends Pak ties

Defending ties with Pakistan, Rubio said US needs to have relationships with countries, including those it may have disagreements with. "So these are difficult things to balance, but they have to be as part of our foreign policy... It perhaps puts us in a position to help discourage the kinds of things that India is worried about," Rubio said. He confirmed the next Quad leaders' summit in Manila in Nov. P 6

A state department readout said Jaishankar and Rubio discussed regional and global issues, including developments in West Asia.

▶'Small items', P 10

US in talks with RIL to refine Venezuela crude

US was in discussions with Reliance Industries on creating capacity to refine Venezuelan crude, Rubio said, calling India a refining superpower and underlining that Washington understood India's need to diversify its oil imports and saw Venezuela as a potential source of supply.

Rubio will tour the Reliance refinery in Jamnagar Wednesday and, in a last-minute change of schedule, is likely to spend the night there. The visit comes in the wake of Elon Musk's swipe at Mukesh Ambani. Before his departure for Jamnagar, Rubio will meet Gautam Adani and Tata Group chief N Chandrasekaran in Mumbai. P 6

'Identify and defeat forces against India': Modi calls for unity

Urges Parties, Institutions To Put Nation First

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PTI

PM Modi participates in a Ramlila event in east Delhi on Tuesday

New Delhi: Calling for a united fight against forces seeking to divide society, undermine India's dignity and attack its culture, PM Narendra Modi Tuesday urged all political parties and national institutions to put the country first. He stressed that national self-respect and faith in one's own strength were essential for progress, adding India must protect its cultural identity while building the capabilities to overcome challenges without depending on others.

"We must identify the enemies of Mother India. We must defeat them," Modi said at Vijayadashami celebrations in east Delhi. "The forces that hurt the honour and dignity of the country, the people who divide society, the mentality of those who hate our culture — these are the enemies of the country," he said. Quoting a Vedic verse, Modi said all institutions and political parties must stand together in the national interest.

▶'Victory of truth', P 9

Hill councils for all 8 Ladakh districts cleared

Ladakh will extend its autonomous hill council system to all eight districts under a presidential regulation notified Tuesday by LG V K Saxena, expanding a framework that covered only Leh and Kargil. Saxena said Ladakh Autonomous Hill Development Councils (Amendment) Regulation, 2026, took effect Oct 19, after President Droupadi Murmu promulgated it on Oct 16. PG OPP

Murder FIR on 10-yr-old girl for pushing toddler

Mumbai police registered an FIR for murder against a 10-year-old girl who was allegedly caught on CCTV camera pushing a toddler from the sixth floor of a building. The girl was released in the care of her parents. Under the law, kids aged 7-12 are excluded from criminal prosecution only if a court thinks they did not understand the consequence of their actions. P 6

Guj HC: Gratuity a right, cannot be withheld

Gratuity can't be withheld on the ground of pending criminal proceedings, Gujarat HC has observed, ordering authorities to release the "valuable statutory retiral benefit" to a retired panchayat employee. HC noted that no departmental inquiry had been initiated, and the proceedings were not related to the employee's job, and no loss was caused to the exchequer. PAGE OPP

Mann 'detained for 3 hours' at IGI, fined ₹50k

AAP has claimed Punjab CM Bhagwant Mann was detained for three hours at IGI Airport on Oct 19 and fined Rs 50,000 on his return from Paris, **reports Vibhor Mohan**. AAP media incharge Baltej Pannu said the case reflects Centre's attempt to "humiliate" Mann. SAD's Bikram Majithia posted on X: "According to sources, they (Mann & wife) were questioned over allegedly carrying more luggage or money than permitted." P 16

▶Punjab hands over activist's case to CBI, P 6

Das, Ranka move HC; cases handed to Crime Branch

New Delhi: CJP's Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka Tuesday approached Delhi HC challenging their judicial custody, a day before the special executive magistrate decides whether to extend their custody, **reports Abhinav Garg**.

The two were detained on Oct 13 after they climbed a gate to enter Jantar Mantar, which has been denotified as a protest site, to protest against SIR. They have since spent 7 days in custody — initial five days, followed by a two-day extension that expires on Wednesday. Meanwhile, police have transferred the Oct 13 cases against them to Crime Branch.

IN THE COURTS

- 'Degree can't make up for lost limb': **Tribunal awards BTech grad ₹3cr** | PG OPP
- HC sets aside CIC directive to IAF to **disclose details of PM foreign trips** | PG OPP
- HC quashes SP's order **blocking FB page** | P 10

Das and Ranka have sought an urgent hearing, but the court is closed for Dussehra. If the executive magistrate releases them Wednesday, their petition will become redundant.

▶'Remand violates...', P 5

Salman target, plan changed to attack Tiger

Initial probe by Mumbai police into the firing at Tiger Shroff has indicated that Salman Khan was the real target of the Lawrence Bishnoi gang but it abandoned the plan because of the high security provided to him, **report S Ahmed Ali & V Narayan.** The gang subsequently shifted its focus to Shroff as he is very low-profile and moves around without any security. Any attack on a celebrity would have created fear, police sources said. The gang had issued threats to Shroff prior to the attack, sources said.

Day after 3 Meiteis killed, Kuki man shot dead

Guwahati: A 45-year-old Kuki tribesman was shot dead by gunmen while collecting bamboo shoots in a forest in Manipur's Kangpokpi on Tuesday. His companion escaped unhurt. The killing came a day after three Meitei villagers were ambushed and killed nearby, and amid the arrest of three Kuki-Zo suspects in that attack, **reports Prabin Kalita**.

P Muolding village authority said the deceased Kuki, Paolenmung Thangeo, was an unarmed civilian and alleged he was shot by Naga militants.

ADGP (law and order) Lhari Dorje said two of the men for Monday's ambush admitted to being part of the attack, while the role of the third is being investigated.

IMPHAL SHUTS

- Calls for **24-hr shutdowns** over **Kuki tribesman's killing and arrest of 3 men** over murder of 3 Meiteis
- Manipur police identified the **3 men as active cadres of Kuki National Front (N)**
- **48-hr strike call against killing of 3 Meiteis** on Monday paralyses Imphal

▶Valley shuts down, P 8

TIMES CITY

THE TIMES OF INDIA, NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 21, 2026

JNU students end fast after admin agrees to revoke rustication, FIRs | 4

TEMP ON TUESDAY
31.8° MAXIMUM | 17.7° MINIMUM

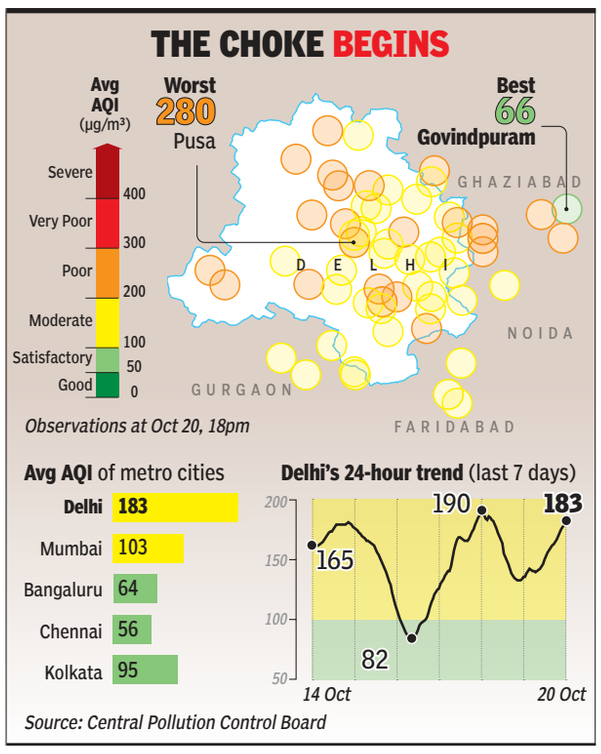
FORECAST Mainly clear sky. Max & min temperatures on Wednesday would be around 33°C and 20°C

MOONSET 2.22AM (THU) SUNSET 5.46PM (WED)
MOONRISE 2.51PM (WED) SUNRISE 6.26AM (THU)

*AQI at 6pm
183
AQI IN DELHI ON TUESDAY (MODERATE)

NDMC proposes 30% property tax rebate for self-occupied houses | 5

Pest activity, food handlers with no gloves at sweet units in Delhi | 5



Winds May Push Farm Fire Share In Delhi's PM2.5 To 13% By Thurs

Tuesday's Season High Of 4.1% Just A Preview; Peak Burning May Coincide With Diwali

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New Delhi: The contribution of stubble burning to Delhi's PM2.5 levels Tuesday touched 4.1%, the highest this season. It had been negligible so far at less than 1%, but the share of farm fires in the city's air quality is likely to rise sharply over the next three days.

Decision Support System (DSS), which functions under Union ministry of earth sciences, has estimated this figure could be around 8% Wednesday, 13.3% Thursday and 10.4% Friday. The actual contribution of the burning of paddy residue to the city's air quality will depend on the intensity of such fires and wind direction and speed.

"The wind direction is likely to change to north-westerly, which may carry smoke to Delhi," said Gufran Beig, founder of System of Air Quality and Weather Forecasting and Research (SAFAR) and chair professor at National Institute of Advanced Studies.

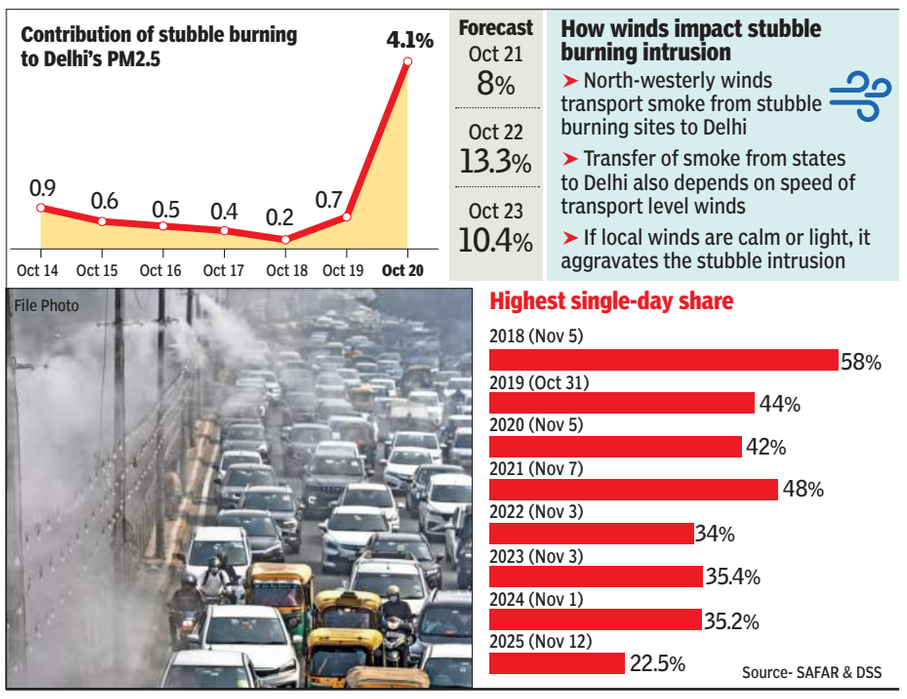
The harvesting pattern is different this time compared to previous years, he said. "Last year, Punjab and parts of Haryana had floods, but this time, monsoon was weak. As a result, harvesting was delayed, with farm fires set to peak later than usual. Besides, as many farmers burn paddy residue after satellite overpass time, the burning pattern will be different," Beig said.

TOI had reported that this stubble burning season could be complex as the El Niño effect is expected to lead to fewer western disturbances, which bring rain to Delhi, and slower wind speeds, resulting in more smoke from stubble burning blowing into the city. The peak farm fire period is also expected to coincide with Diwali (Nov 8) this year, when winter conditions begin setting in.

From Sept 15 to Oct 19 this year, Punjab recorded 368 farm fires, up from 308 during this period last year. Haryana reported just nine stubble burning counts, down from 38 last year.

The contribution of stubble burning to Delhi's PM2.5 was less in 2025 as the share of farm fires in Delhi's air quality surpassed 10% on just seven days and was over 20% on only one day. It remained below 5% on most days. The figure was above 20% on 14 days in 2024, according to DSS.

Punjab reported 5,114 farm fires last year, down from 10,909 in 2024, while Haryana recorded 662 incidents compared with 1,406 in 2024. Events of paddy residue burning in UP rose from 6,142 in 2024 to 7,290 in 2025. Rajasthan witnessed 2,890 cases last year as against 2,772 in 2024, and Delhi saw a reduction from 13 in 2024 to five last year.



AQI likely to worsen to 'poor' today

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: The city's air quality remained 'moderate' at 183 at 6pm Tuesday. However, it is likely to worsen to the 'poor' range Wednesday.

According to the Decision Support System, which estimates the contribution of various sources to Delhi's PM2.5, the highest estimated contributor Tuesday was Delhi's transport sector (23.8%). It was followed by 7.7% of emissions coming from Sonipat, Delhi residential areas (6%) and 5.7% of emissions from Jhajjar.

The Air Quality Early Warning System for Delhi predicted that the air quality is likely to be in the 'poor' category from Wednesday to Friday and in the subsequent six days.

Meanwhile, the maximum temperature was recorded at 31.8 degrees Celsius, one degree below normal, Tuesday. It is expected to hover around 31-33 degrees over the next few days. "No significant change in maximum temperatures is expected during the next 48 hours and a rise by 1-3°C is likely thereafter," said a Met official.

The minimum temperature dipped marginally to 17.7 degrees Celsius, one notch below normal. The city recorded the season's lowest minimum temperature at 17.1 degrees Celsius Monday. It is likely to stay between 18 and 20 degrees Celsius over the next few days.

Winter action plan kicks in from Nov 1

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: Bar on entry of vehicles that are registered outside Delhi and conform to standards below BS-VI, no fuel without PUCC, emphasis on 50% work from home, and monitoring construction dust using AI cameras are some key features of Delhi's winter action plan.

Stressing on clean air, healthy families and a pollution-free Delhi, chief minister Rekha Gupta said most of the measures under the plan will be in force from Nov 1 to Feb 28.

To control construction and demolition-related dust, Delhi govt will impose time-bound restrictions on demolition and outdoor civil construction activities that generate dust. There will be a complete ban on them from Dec 10 to Jan 20.

CNG and electric vehicles are exempt from the vehicular restriction that will be in force from Nov 1 to Jan 31.

Staggered office timings and work-from-home arrangements will be introduced. MCD offices will function from 8.30 am to 5 pm, while Delhi govt offices will remain open from 10 am to 6.30 pm.

From Sabarmati to Yamuna: 'First phase of project in current term'

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New Delhi: Delhi govt has initiated the process to replicate Ahmedabad's Sabarmati riverfront model along Yamuna, with water minister Parvesh Verma saying it will complete the first phase of the project in its current term.

Govt has moved a proposal to sign an agreement with Sabarmati Riverfront Development Corporation and is hiring consultants to start work, he said.

The project will be divided into two stretches by Wazirabad barrage. The first phase will cover Palla to Wazirabad, while the second will extend from Wazirabad to Kalindi Kunj, near Okhla barrage. The first stretch will be developed first, serving as a model for the rest of the riverfront, he said.

The plan includes dedicated zones for yoga, morning walk, cycling and sports, with govt looking to make the riverbanks easily accessible to all.

Parvesh Verma

Verma visited Sabarmati riverfront this Aug with officials from Delhi Jal Board and irrigation & flood control department to study the project.

Senior officials said that govt is also working on cleaning Yamuna, which is a bigger challenge. The river flows for about 52 kilometres through Delhi, with the 22-kilometre stretch between Wazirabad and Okhla among its most polluted sections.

The problem persists despite years of clean-up efforts. Delhi Pollution Control Committee data had on different occasions shown that faecal contamination increased in the river, especially near Wazirabad and Nizamuddin Bridge.

Verma said 28 of Delhi's 37 sewage treatment plants have been upgraded over the past 18 months. Govt plans to add another 250 million gallons per day of treatment capacity to address the existing shortfall. Yamuna could become visibly cleaner in about two and a half years when the sewage treatment projects are completed, he added.

Delhi has been trying to restore and develop Yamuna's banks for years. In 2019, Delhi Development Authority (DDA) prepared a plan to rejuvenate nearly 1,476 hectares of the river's floodplains through 10 projects.

Development along the river faces environmental restrictions, particularly in its floodplains. DDA informed National Green Tribunal that it had installed 277 boundary markers along the Wazirabad-Okhla stretch.

Delhi govt pulls up officials for skipping meetings called by CM

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New Delhi: Delhi govt has directed all departments to accord priority to meetings called by the chief minister and ensure the attendance of officials required there after some senior officials skipped such meetings and failed to communicate to the CMO the decisions taken in meetings called by the Centre or lieutenant governor.

"This has been viewed seriously by the chief minister," an official said.

Officials have been asked to avoid scheduling conflicts for meetings and inform the CMO in advance if they cannot be present. Separately, Delhi govt has directed all departments to expedite the disposal of public grievances.

All additional chief secretaries/principal secretaries and heads of all departments, and heads of all bodies of govt have been sent a communication to keep these matters in mind.

"Meetings convened in the chief minister's office under the chairpersonship of the CM shall be accorded due priority and the officers concerned shall ensure their attendance. In case of a clash with a later scheduled meeting, the organisers shall be requested to reschedule it, with an intimation to the CMO. Where a clash with a scheduled meeting cannot be resolved, the matter shall be brought to the notice of the CMO for appropriate directions," a circular issued by the general administration department said.

Meanwhile, govt has warned that HoDs will be held accountable for overdue grievance resolution.

A circular has been issued directing officials to prioritise pending complaints, regularly monitor grievance redressal portals and ensure that cases are resolved within prescribed timelines. "Officials have been instructed not to dispose of complaints merely by submitting replies. Each grievance must be examined on its merit and addressed through a clear, specific and reasoned response, supported by details of the action taken," an official said.

Reviews will be done Fridays. Avoidable delays, repeated instances of overdue grievances and inadequate responses will invite action.

Two injured after falling from ride at Vikaspuri fair

New Delhi: Two people were injured after falling from a moving "mixer" ride at a fair in west Delhi's Vikaspuri Dussehra Ground around 1.30 am Tuesday. Preliminary probe suggests the ride's gate may have broken while it was in operation.

Police said Gudiya and Ravi, residents of Uttam Nagar, were rushed to Mata Chanan Devi Hospital and later referred to RML Hospital, where they are undergoing treatment.

Fair organiser Sunil Jindal claimed they lost their balance, denied any malfunction and said all rides had undergone safety checks. Meanwhile, a DDA official said DDA limits role to ground bookings; organisers must obtain all clearances. TNN

Nov opening for 645-vehicle parking at Bhikaji Cama

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New Delhi: Delhi Development Authority (DDA) has completed construction of a 645-vehicle multilevel parking facility at Bhikaji Cama Place District Centre, scheduled for inauguration in the first week of Nov 2026.

The Rs 40-crore facility is receiving finishing touches. Initiated under LG TS Sandhu, the project aims to resolve parking shortages, reduce roadside parking and ease congestion at the busy South Delhi commercial hub and adjoining roads.

"The facility comprises a basement, ground floor, two upper floors and a terrace, connected by an internal vehicular ramp. Its parking capacity includes 424 cars, 193 scooters, 20 designated spaces for persons with disabilities (PwD) and eight adapted scooter spaces," said officials.

The facility features nine EV charging points, electronic payment options and an automatic sensor system for parking space availability

To ensure smooth traffic flow, the authority has planned separate entry and exit points, directional signage, and road markings. The facility features nine EV charging points, electronic payment options and an automatic sensor system for parking space availability.

Officials stated that a connecting tower with a lift and bridge will link the parking lot to the raised plaza. This improves pedestrian access, allowing visitors to reach their destinations without navigating traffic or surface parking.

Amenities include four passenger lifts, two 50-capacity waiting halls, drinking water and separate restrooms. Accessible parking spaces and all-floor lift access ensure seamless movement for persons with disabilities.

Safety features include firefighting installations, fire-check doors, a fire-escape staircase, basement ventilation, lighting and power backup. Rainwater harvesting and landscaping of the surrounding area are also part of the project.

According to DDA, the facility is designed to provide safe, organised and accessible parking for visitors to Bhikaji Cama Place, one of South Delhi's prominent commercial centres. It is expected to benefit office-goers, visitors and businesses by improving parking availability and traffic circulation in the area.

"The project forms part of DDA's initiative to create structured parking infrastructure in commercial areas and district centres to reduce roadside parking. Earlier, DDA shared plans to set up 232 surface parking lots by the end of the year," said an official.

For pollution season, 125 C&D waste centres now operational

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New Delhi: To curb illegal dumping of construction and demolition (C&D) waste on city roads ahead of winter, when air pollution levels typically rise, Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) has made all 125 secondary C&D waste collection centres operational.

MCD officials said, as of Oct 1, 118 centres now have signage and barricades or protective sheets, while 116 have water-sprinkling arrangements to control dust. As many as 113 sites have been equipped with 360-degree cameras to discourage dumping outside the designated areas.

"Of the 125 sites, 88 are registered on the Delhi Pollution Control Committee (DPCC) portal. All arrangements have been made at these secondary centres. Malba is collected departmentally and transported to processing plants by the respective concessionaires," an official said.

To discourage unauthorised dumping, the civic body has reiterated that up to 20 metric tonnes (MT) of malba can be deposited at these centres free of cost.

"Delhi Malba Collection App, launched in March this year, is fully operational. People can submit requests for malba removal, and the JEs concerned are mapped on the app to act on them. After receiving a request, MCD vehicles or registered transporters collect the waste from the applicant's premises and transport it to the secondary C&D site free of cost. For quantities exceeding 20 MT, the waste generator has to pay the processing fee as the material is sent to the nearest C&D waste processing plant. Earlier, the free lifting facility was limited to 1 MT, but looking at the limited response, the quantity has been increased to 20 MT," the official added.

To discourage unauthorised dumping, the civic body has reiterated that up to 20 metric tonnes of malba can be deposited at these centres free of cost

Zone-wise details of the secondary collection centres are available on the MCD C&D portal.

MCD has four C&D waste processing plants at Burari, Rani Khera, Bakkarwala and Shastri Park, with a combined capacity of 5,000 tonnes per day (TPD). Work is underway on a fifth plant at Tehkhand. Delhi generates approximately 6,000 MT of C&D waste daily.

"The plants process malba into coarse sand, fine sand, recycled aggregates and screened soil. While screened soil is used to fill low-lying areas, recycled aggregates and stone dust are used to make paver blocks, tiles and concrete blocks for footpaths, berms and boundary walls, and other civil works. Efforts are also underway to improve processing efficiency at all four plants," the official said.

MCD expects the integrated system of collection centres, mobile app, junior engineers, registered transporters, concessionaires and scientific processing plants to improve waste collection and processing, curb unauthorised dumping and maximise recovery.

Meanwhile, as part of its air-pollution mitigation measures, MCD Tuesday flagged off 12 newly procured truck-mounted multipurpose vehicles equipped with anti-smog guns, water sprinklers and jetting systems. Each vehicle has a water tank capacity of 7,000 litres.

"The multi-functional systems will also enable more effective road washing, drain jetting and cleaning of public toilets," mayor Pravesh Wahi said.

Not maid for each other? Trust broken, lockers emptied as over 200 arrested in less than 2 yrs

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New Delhi: Trust, at times, can come at a steep price. In Delhi, employees entrusted with household keys and daily routines are increasingly coming under police scrutiny for allegedly betraying their employers.

Earlier this month, a businessman's employee allegedly staged a Rs 36 lakh robbery near Zakhira flyover, while in another case, a domestic help allegedly stole from her employer's home in northwest Delhi's Bharat Nagar while he was abroad.

Till Aug this year, 69 people have been arrested in employee-related thefts and 62 cases registered, while in 2025, police recorded 139 arrests and 111 cases — a total of 208 arrests in 173 cases in 20 months.

According to police, the motives for such crimes vary, ranging from financial distress and mounting debts to unfulfilled aspirations and the desire to lead a high-end lifestyle. In some cases, employees are allegedly lured by organised gangs that exploit their access to employers' homes, valuables and daily routines to plan and execute thefts.

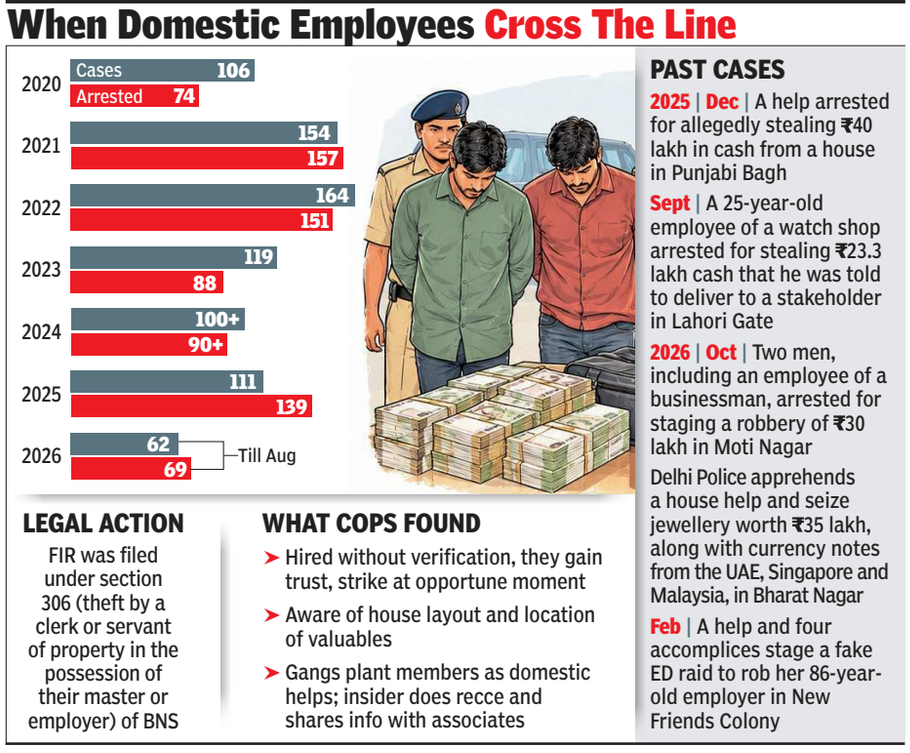
Investigators said employees often know household routines, security arrangements and where cash and jewellery are kept, making them potential sources of information or accomplices in planned thefts. In several cases, trusted employees who had worked for years allegedly fled with money or valuables.

In June, thieves stole valuables worth nearly Rs 1 crore from a Karol Bagh mobile phone shop. Police arrested four men within 24 hours, including 24-year-old Ravi, a trusted employee who allegedly masterminded the heist. The thieves used a duplicate key and wore masks, while Ravi posed as an innocent employee and witness the following morning, said cops.

Police said some gangs use forged documents or recommendations to place a member in a household. The employee then allegedly spends days or weeks studying the family's routine before helping other gang members gain entry and escape with valuables.

In April, a businessman's family was held hostage during a dacoity at their Golf Links bungalow in Lutyens' Delhi. Police said a domestic help, hired barely a week earlier using a fake identity and without verification, allegedly opened the main gate for the armed gang. The masked men held the businessman, his wife, daughter-in-law and minor grandson hostage for nearly 15 minutes, assaulting and threatening them before fleeing with cash and jewellery worth Rs 25-30 lakh.

A senior police officer said the lack of verification makes it difficult to establish employees' criminal backgrounds or determine whether the documents they submit are genuine. Police have often asked employers to verify the antecedents of domestic workers before hiring them. "Employers must also maintain details such as family contacts, Aadhaar cards, home addresses and bank details. This can help trace them," an officer said.



ON THE MARK

Rajesh Mehta

LG TS Sandhu and Vice-President C P Radhakrishnan at Red Fort grounds for Luv Kush Ramlila Committee's Dussehra celebrations. LG urged citizens to renew the collective resolve to build a cleaner, safer and more compassionate Delhi

Teach lesson to anti-national elements: CM

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New Delhi: Chief minister Rekha Gupta Tuesday called upon people to stand united against social evil and anti-national elements and follow the ideals of Lord Ram.

Addressing Vijayadashami celebrations at Sector 10 in Dwarka, Gupta said: "Hatred must be eliminated and the lamp of love must be lit to build a brighter future for the country. People should stand united against the evils prevalent in society and teach anti-national elements a lesson. All Indians must work together for the country's progress and a brighter future."

President Droupadi Murmu attended the Vijayadashami celebration as the chief guest. "I offer my warm Dussehra greetings to all my fellow countrymen. This festival celebrates the victory of righteousness and justice over unrighteousness and injustice," she said, according to an ANI report.

PTI

CM Gupta delivers her address at Dwarka

The CM said Lord Ram was not merely a deity to be worshipped but also an ideal figure whose teachings should guide people. Referring to Lord Ram's victory over Ravana, she said the latter had symbolised evil for centuries, but several forms of evil have continued to exist in modern society. Corruption, addiction, crime, social discrimination, atrocities against women and hatred remained major challenges, she said. These can be overcome only when people embrace Lord Ram's ideals, she added.

Vijayadashami is also a reminder that truth ultimately triumphs over falsehood, righteousness over unrighteousness and justice over injustice, She appealed to people to rise above differences, promote love and harmony.

(With inputs from ANI)

EVIL DEAD! CITY LIGHTS UP AS RAVANA FALLS

Celebrations Carry Messages On Pollution, Women's Safety

Photos: **Jatin Kumar, Rajesh Mehta, Tarun Rawat, Vinay Gupta**

The Dussehra celebrations saw the participation of several prominent dignitaries. As the flames died down and crowds dispersed, the messages accompanying this year's celebrations offered a broader interpretation of the age-old tradition, as per organisers, that the battle against evil does not end with Ravana's symbolic defeat, but continues in the challenges society confronts every day

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New Delhi: Towering effigies of Ravana, Kumbhakarna and Meghnad went up in flames amid dazzling fireworks, thunderous cheers and chants of 'Jai Shri Ram' as the city celebrated Dussehra Tuesday.

From the historic Red Fort grounds to neighbourhood Ramlilas, thousands of spectators gathered to witness Ravan Dahan, bringing the curtain down on days of festivities and marking the symbolic triumph of good over evil.

Unlike last year's Dussehra, when sudden showers drenched effigies and disrupted celebrations at several venues, clear skies and a slight nip in the air offered a welcome change for visitors this time.

The Dussehra celebrations saw the participation of several prominent dignitaries. President Droupadi Murmu joined the festivities at Dwarka Shri Ram Leela, where she performed the traditional aarti of Ram, Lakshman and Sita before symbolically shooting an arrow to set Ravana's effigy ablaze. Chief minister Rekha Gupta and cabinet minister Parvesh Verma were also present at the event.

PM Narendra Modi attended the Vijayadashami celebrations at the Indraprastha Ramleela Ground in east Delhi's IP Extension. Vice president C P Radhakrishnan, LG T S Sandhu and Chandni Chowk MP Praveen Khandelwal joined the festivities organised by the Luv Kush Ramlila Committee. Congress MP Priyanka Gandhi attended the Nav Shri Dharmik Leela Committee's event.

Amid the spectacle of burning effigies, the celebrations also carried messages about the evils confronting society today. From air pollution and traffic congestion to counterfeit medicines and inflated prices, organisers used the traditional ritual to draw attention to everyday problems affecting Delhiites.

At Luv Kush Ramlila at the Red Fort grounds, the 110-foot Ravana delivered a message that went beyond the familiar tale of good defeating evil. Before being engulfed in flames, the demon king's recorded voice urged spectators to confront pollution and traffic congestion, drawing attention to their impact on public health, fuel consumption and the economy.

The symbolism extended to IP Extension, where organisers continued their three-decade-old tradition of burning a fourth effigy representing a contemporary social evil. This year, the additional effigy represented counterfeit medicines and inflated maximum retail prices, drawing attention to concerns over consumer safety and unfair pricing.

At Shri Dharmik Leela Committee's celebrations, Ravana's fiery end unfolded with a dramatic sequence as the symbolic arrow struck his navel, setting off a chain reaction in which sections of his garland caught fire, creating the appearance of individual burning beads. At Nav Shri Dharmik Leela Committee, a 110-foot Ravana met a similarly dramatic end. Ravana's blinking eyes and flowing tears added to the spectacle, while his illuminated garland and green crackers heightened the visual effects.

At Dwarka's Sector 10 Ram Leela, where a towering 221-foot Ravana was set ablaze, organisers said the significance of Ravan Dahan went beyond the burning of an effigy and lay in the resolve to overcome arrogance, injustice and evil.

For younger spectators, particularly Gen Z, the festival also offered an opportunity to reflect on what constitutes evil in present-day society, and issues like women's safety, discrimination and environmental degradation.

Alekha, a DU student visiting Dussehra celebrations in east Delhi, said, "We burn Ravana every year, but women still have to think twice before stepping out alone at night. For me, the real evil that needs to be burnt is the mindset that makes women feel unsafe."

Paritosh, another college student, said, "Pollution and corruption are the Ravanas of our generation. The real change will come when we start addressing these problems in our everyday lives."

As the flames died down and crowds dispersed, the messages accompanying this year's celebrations offered a broader interpretation of the age-old tradition, as per organisers, that the battle against evil does not end with Ravana's symbolic defeat, but continues in the challenges society confronts every day.

IGNCA campus and Yamuna riverfront garden plans languish

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New Delhi: Even as the govt has pushed construction of office buildings under the Central Vista redevelopment project, plans to build a new campus for Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts (IGNCA) and develop Nav Bharat Udyan along the Yamuna remain stalled.

When the master plan for Central Vista revamp was unveiled, the housing and urban affairs ministry had announced that IGNCA would get a new campus near Jamnagar House. The first three Common Central Secretariat (CCS) buildings, known as Kartavya Bhawan, have since come up on the plot where IGNCA was located. The centre was shifted to Hotel Janpath.

Though the housing and urban affairs ministry did not respond to queries on the status of the proposed IGNCA project, officials said the plan remained on the table and that the culture ministry was working on it. Culture ministry did not respond to repeated queries from **TOI**.

There have also been reports of IGNCA writing to the culture ministry seeking clarity on the project. The centre has reportedly sent multiple communications to the ministry since 2021. Govt had proposed a new campus spread over 14 acres in the vicinity of Central Vista.

Officials familiar with Central Vista projects acknowledged that there had been little movement on the plan. They said IGNCA was functioning well from Hotel Janpath, a prime property that was once shortlisted for monetisation.

The Nav Bharat Udyan project also has seen little progress. The ministry had initially set Aug 2022 as the deadline for its completion, coinciding with India's 75th year of Independence. CPWD had floated a tender and received entries for the design of an iconic structure, but the project has made no headway in the past four years.

MCD to clean up post festivities: MCD will deploy more sanitation workers at major grounds to clear the waste generated during Ravana Dahan on Vijayadashami. Special cleaning drives to be conducted Wednesday morning. TNN

Toddler dies after falling from scooter

New Delhi: An 18-month-old boy died after falling from a scooter following a collision with a three-wheeled cargo vehicle in north Delhi's Derawal Nagar Monday afternoon. Police have arrested the cargo vehicle driver, identified as Girish, in connection with the incident.

According to police, the child was travelling with his family from their residence in Cigarette Wala Bagh, Model Town, to visit a doctor. The boy's mother was holding him on her lap while her brother was riding the scooter when it was allegedly hit by the cargo vehicle.

The impact caused the child to slip from his mother's arms and fall onto the road, suffering serious head injuries. He was rushed to a nearby hospital, where he later succumbed to his injuries.

Police have registered an FIR at Model Town police station under relevant BNS provisions for rash driving, causing death by negligence and endangering human life. TNN

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Woman stabbed to death after son's altercation; man held

New Delhi: A woman died after being stabbed in southwest Delhi's Najafgarh in an attack on her and her husband, allegedly linked to an earlier altercation involving their son, police said. The accused, Satish Lamba, has been arrested.
On Oct 15, around 11.15 pm, Lamba was standing with friends at a chowk when a group of men—Dhruv Rishi, Afjal and Dev Bakshi — allegedly abused him. Dhruv allegedly stabbed Lamba in the left thigh during the scuffle, police said. Around 11.45 pm, a PCR call was received about a knife attack near Old Roshanpura. Kamal Rishi and his wife, Seema, sustained injuries. "We went to check on our son when we were attacked," Kamal said. Seema died during treatment. Police arrested Lamba for allegedly attacking the couple. TNN

JNUSU calls off 17-day stir after assurances from admin

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New Delhi: Jawaharlal Nehru University Students' Union (JNUSU) Tuesday called off its 17-day hunger strike after the administration agreed to address several of its demands, including revoking the rustication of union office-bearers, withdrawing FIRs against students and reviewing the controversial chief proctor's office (CPO) manual, which penalises protests on campus.

The stir began on Oct 3, with 18 students sitting on hunger strike near Sabarmati T-point. After multiple rounds of negotiations, nine students were still on fast when JNUSU announced the withdrawal.

According to the minutes of a meeting held on Oct 19, an administrative panel agreed that all FIRs against students will be withdrawn, while proctorial enquiries initiated during protests against anti-rustication measures and UGC regulations, as well as over hostel infrastructure, will be withdrawn. A committee comprising student representatives will review the CPO manual and recommend changes.

The committee set up by the JNU administration is headed by Prof Vivek Kumar, dean of School of Social Sciences, and includes Prof Sudheer Pratap Singh, Prof Sharad K Soni, Dr Poonguzhali N, Dr Jaikhlong Basumatary and Dr Fauzia Firdous, according to the minutes. Student representatives include JNUSU office-bearers and elected councillors. The committee will meet again after 14 working days to take forward the demands and work out modalities for their implementation.

The administration also agreed to constitute committees to examine the reinstatement of JNU Entrance Examination in place of CUET, hostel reservation and functioning of the equal opportunity cell. An audit report on the cell is to be submitted within a week. The committee will also recommend discontinuing Siddhanta Knowledge Foundation's role in the curriculum.

Other assurances include structural audits of hostels, extending school library hours until 9 pm and considering a 25% increase in the merit-cum-means scholarship.

Multiple shots fired at bizman's factory

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: Multiple rounds were fired at a businessman's factory and a vehicle parked outside it in outer Delhi's Pooth Khurd Monday, police said. While sources suspected a possible link to an alleged Rs 5-crore extortion demand by a gangster based abroad, police said they had not established any such connection so far.

Police received information about the firing around 4 pm and a team from Bawana police station rushed to the spot.

"Inquiry revealed that two bike-borne, helmet-wearing persons opened fire and fled from the spot. No one was injured in the incident. Some bullet marks were found on a parked vehicle and a nearby godown gate," police said.

According to police sources, two rounds were fired at the parked car and three at the gate of a nearby factory. The vehicle was unoccupied and the factory was closed at the time of the incident.

Sources said the businessman had allegedly received an extortion call some time ago, during which Rs 5 crore was demanded. The name of a foreign-based gangster had allegedly surfaced in connection with the threat call. They claimed the businessman did not pay the amount and the firing could be linked to the demand.

A senior police officer, however, said the investigation was at a preliminary stage and denied any confirmed extortion angle.

Police are examining the crime scene and scanning CCTV footage from the area to identify the suspects and establish the motive. Multiple teams have been formed to trace and apprehend the accused. Further investigation is underway.

In July, the name of the foreign-based gangster had surfaced in connection with the murder of Joginder alias Kala in Bawana.

According to police, three men riding a motorcycle intercepted Joginder and opened fire at him multiple times before fleeing the scene. He was rushed to a nearby hospital, where doctors declared him dead on arrival.

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NOTICE INVITING BID
(Through http://kppp.karnataka.gov.in only)
(Competitive Bidding under Two Cover System)

RFP for **"Construction of Elevated Corridors from Sholay Circle to St. John Hospital Road on Hosur Road via Anepalya Junction and Adugodi Junction"**
The Government of Karnataka has constituted Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited ("B-SMILE") for implementation of specific infrastructure works in the city of Bengaluru. **B-SMILE (the "Authority")** is engaged in the development of elevated corridors and other urban road infrastructure in the city of Bengaluru. The Authority has decided to undertake the work of **"Construction of Elevated Corridors from Sholay Circle to St. John Hospital Road on Hosur Road via Anepalya Junction and Adugodi Junction" (the "Project")** through an Engineering, Procurement and Construction (the "EPC") Contract, and has decided to carry out the bidding process for selection of a Bidder to whom the Project may be awarded. A brief description of the Project may be seen in the **Information Memorandum of the Project** on the e-Procurement portal of the Government of Karnataka at https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in. **Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited** now invites bids from eligible contractors for the following project:

Name of the work	Estimated Project Cost (Civil work cost excluding GST)	Construction Period	Maintenance Period
Construction of Elevated Corridors from Sholay Circle to St. John Hospital Road on Hosur Road via Anepalya Junction and Adugodi Junction	**Rs. 564.07 Crores**	**30 Months (Including Monsoon Period)**	**10 years**

The complete BID document can be viewed / downloaded from https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in. Bidder must submit its Financial bid and Technical Bid at KPP Portal of the Government of Karnataka - https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in.
Bid through any other mode shall not be entertained. However, Bid Security, Power of Attorney for signing the Bid, Power of Attorney for lead member of JV, if any, Joint Bidding Agreement for JV, if any, Integrity Pact and experience certificates apostile at foreign origin, if any shall be submitted physically in original by the Lowest Bidder before issue of Letter of Award (LOA) by the Authority. Please note that B-SMILE reserves the right to accept or reject all or any of the BIDs without assigning any reason whatsoever.
Officer In-charge: Project Engineer- 02, Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited, No. 30/1, 3rd Floor, Thimmaiah Road, Miller Tank Bund Area, Vasanth Nagar, Bengaluru – 560 051
Phone - +91-8050480689 (Smt. Amruta Sai), e-mail – pe2bsmiile@gmail.com
Schedule of Bidding Process - The Authority shall endeavour to adhere to the following schedule:
(1) Invitation of RFP (NIT): **19.10.2026, (2)** Availability of Tender Documents: **22.10.2026, (3)** Last date for receiving queries: **31.10.2026, (4)** Pre-BID meeting at venue as per clause 2.11.4 (B-SMILE office - No. 30/1, 3rd Floor, Thimmaiah Road, Miller Tank Bund Area, Vasanth Nagar, Bengaluru – 560 051): **31.10.2026, (5)** Authority response to queries latest by: **05.11.2026, (6)** Last date of Request for BID Document: **23.11.2026, (7)** BID Due Date: **23.11.2026, (8)** Opening of Technical BIDs at venue shown in point 4 above: **24.11.2026, (9)** Declaration of eligible/qualified Bidders: **Will be notified, (10)** Opening of Financial BID: **Will be notified, (11)** Physical Submission of originals documents required as per clause 2.11.2 of RFP by the Lowest Bidder: **Will be notified, (12)** Letter of Acceptance (LOA): **Will be notified, (13)** Return of signed duplicate copy of LOA: **Will be notified, (14)** Validity of BID: **120 days from BID Due Date, (15)** Submission of Performance Security (PS) and Additional Performance Security (ASP), if any: **Within 30 days of receipt of LOA. (The bidder has the option to provide 50% of PS and APS, if any within 30 days of receipt of LOA and the remaining PS and APS, if any to be provided within 30 days of signing of agreement), (16)** Signing of Agreement: **Within 10 days from the receipt of 50% of Performance Security and 50% of Additional Performance Security, if any.**

Sd/-
Project Engineer-02
Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited (B-SMILE)

NOTICE

IN THE COURT OF SENIOR CIVIL JUDGE, BHUBANESWAR
(Substituted Service under Order V Rule 20 of CPC)
CIVIL SUIT NO. 496 / 2025

Dr Tapan Kumar Pradhan ..... Plaintiff
VERSUS
Hemangi Sharma & Ors..... Defendants

To
Defendant No 10
Union of India,
Represented by Secretary,
Ministry of Rural Development,
Government of India,
Krishi Bhawan, New Delhi - 110 001.

Whereas you are intentionally evading service of summons in the above mentioned suit for malicious prosecution, defamation and other injuries, you are hereby summoned to appear and file a written statement in this Court in person or by a pleader duly instructed on 30.11.26 at 10:30 AM to answer all the material questions relating to the suit, failing which the suit will be heard and determined in your absence.

Given under hand and seal of this Court on this 14th day of October 2026.

seal

Senior Civil Judge,
Bhubaneswar

How this 113-yr-old Puja traces Delhi's Bengali migration story

Amit Bhattacharya

New Delhi: Epochs have come and gone, and the city has changed beyond recognition; but one annual tradition has endured since 1914. The Durga Puja at north Delhi's Timarpur, the city's second oldest according to its organisers, marked its 113th year with a tribute to one of the migration stories that helped shape the capital — the arrival of Bengali settlers more than a century ago.

How did Bengali families who migrated to Delhi around the time the British shifted the capital from Calcutta in 1911 stay in touch with those they had left behind? What did their journey look like, and how did they build lives in a city where the weather, language and surroundings were unfamiliar?

Exhibits at the Puja pandal delve into these questions, recreating the past through evocative images and displays. The theme, 'Dilir Buke Bangla' (Bengal in the heart of Delhi), is evident at the entrance, shaped like a giant steam engine bearing the insignia of the East Indian Railway, which operated the Calcutta-Delhi train route at the time.

"We wanted to tell the story of our forefathers, the Bengalis who migrated to Delhi from around 1908 till roughly 1920," said Kamal Banerjea, one of a seven-member team that curated the presentation. "Many came and settled in Timarpur. It was their first destination in north India. They were uncertain about a lot of things, but they came with hope, intellect and determination."

According to several accounts, Timarpur was the city's first govt colony, established after Delhi was declared the capital of British India. Initially, families arriving in Timarpur were housed in temporary quarters.

The organisers have used stories of six imaginary families to recreate the experience. "We did not want to overcomplicate the narrative. We have no records of the people who shifted during that migration. So, we created a representation of six families," Banerjea said.

He said the team spent six months piecing together the past. It filed Right to Information applications with different departments, searched digital archives in Delhi and drew on old wedding invitations and receipts preserved by community members. It also investigated the railway companies and routes connecting Calcutta with Delhi at the time, looking for tickets and other evidence of the journey.

The material was then painstakingly recreated. Old documents and letters were reproduced using illustration software, treated with tea water to give them an aged appearance and printed using offset rather than digital printing.

"It was like an invisible grandfather hidden in documents telling us our story. We just had to find it. At the same time, we did not want to present anything that was not authentic," Banerjea said, adding that artificial intelligence was used, but most of the creative thinking came from the team itself.

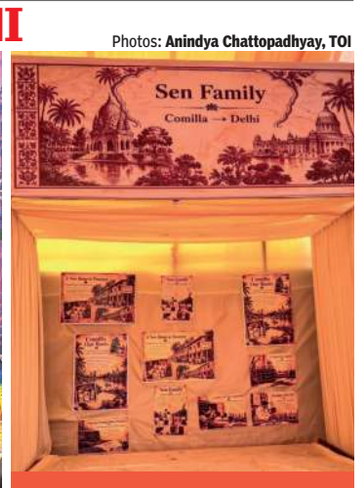
While Bengalis had been arriving in Delhi in a trickle ever since the rail link from Calcutta became operational in 1864, the numbers rose significantly around the time the capital shifted.

Banerjea was careful to point out that the presentation does not claim to represent the entire Bengali migration to Delhi. "Communities established in Kashmere Gate and Chandni Chowk, and later in Karol Bagh, Minto Road and areas around Kali Bari have all been part of this common story. This account is simply an attempt to introduce this legacy to the people," he added.

BENGAL IN HEART OF DELHI

Photos: Anindya Chattopadhyay, TOI

The migration theme extends to the backdrop of the Durga idol



One of six fictitious families whose migration history is recreated using displays that contrast their lives in the hometown with that of Delhi

The entrance is shaped as a steam engine from the 1900s, recreating an era when migrants arrived in Delhi on trains after a journey of nearly two days

Original documents such as letters, receipts, train tickets, etc, are part of an interesting display on vignettes of life among the early Bengali settlers in the capital

30% Tax Rebate Proposed For Self-Occupied Houses

NDMC DRAFT: Women, Persons With Disabilities, Men Over 65 Eligible

Vibha.Sharma
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New Delhi: New Delhi Municipal Council (NDMC) has prepared a draft introducing the unit area method (UAM) to calculate property tax, proposing a 30% rebate for self-occupied residential properties for men aged 65 and above, and all women and persons with disabilities (PwD).

The rebate, applicable only to plots with a built-up area of up to 100 sqm, will be available for not more than one residential building within the jurisdiction of New Delhi, NDMC stated.

The council has invited public feedback on the proposed changes and sought suggestions by Oct 23. The move is in accordance with the Jan Vishwas Act (Amendment of Provisions), 2026, and aims to simplify the property tax system, said officials.

According to the draft, property tax will be calculated based on several factors, including the property's use (residential, commercial, office, hotel, hospital, nursing home, recreational or industrial), age of the structure (before or after 1960), structural characteristics (kuccha/puccha), occupancy (self-occupied or rented), location based on circle rate categories (A to H) and the area's infrastructure. The width of the road on which the property is located will be considered, with separate categories for roads – those measuring 24 metres and more, between 13.5 metres and 24 metres, and less than 13.5 metres.

As per other proposals in the draft, the standard tax rate would apply if 25% of a plot's area has been built upon. Where construction covers less than this threshold, an additional tax, termed 'vacant land tax', may be levied at a rate determined by NDMC.

Property tax may be paid in a lump sum or in four equal quarterly instalments. A rebate of up to 15% is proposed for taxpayers who pay the entire amount by June 30 of the financial year. For delayed payments, a simple interest charge of 1.5% per month or part thereof has been proposed.

The council has invited public feedback on the proposed changes and sought suggestions by Oct 23

The draft also proposes a processing fee of Rs 100 per assessee for each assessment period for providing information on the apportionment of property tax among multiple occupants of a building or vacant land, including for previous assessment periods.

NDMC calculates property tax using the rateable value method, which is based on the assessed value of a property. In contrast, MCD follows UAM, which calculates tax using a formula based on factors like property size, use and age, among others, thereby reducing the taxable amount.

Residents in NDMC area have been demanding the introduction of UAM since 2016. Traders in prominent markets and business centres, including Khan Market and Connaught Place, still pay the tax as per the rateable value method.

"The draft will be placed before the council for approval after suggestions received from the public are examined and incorporated, where required. Once approved, a formal notification will be issued and submitted to Parliament for ratification," stated the agency.

After parliamentary approval, a municipal valuation committee will be formed to recommend tax rates, slabs, base values and categorisation of colonies within NDMC area. The recommendations will be then placed before the council for approval and implementation.

"The reform will reduce disputes, improve transparency and bring greater predictability to tax liabilities," said an official.

Dipke urges supporters to spend time with families

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New Delhi: CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke Tuesday urged supporters to spend time with their families and loved ones during the festive season, acknowledging the toll that the prolonged protests have taken on them.

He also rejected comparisons with agitations in France, Nepal and Bangladesh, saying CJP's movement is rooted in Mahatma Gandhi's principles of peace and non-violence.

In a video captioned "message to all cockroaches", Dipke said the past few days had been difficult for the party's volunteers, many of whom he claimed were beaten up or detained. He said their families faced great anxiety despite not having chosen to be part of the struggle. "We are fighting against hatred, but we have to ensure hatred does not consume us," he said.

Dipke said the resolve of Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka despite being in jail gave him strength. He urged supporters to pray for the two.

He said comparisons with protests in France, Nepal and Bangladesh overlooked the current movement's commitment to non-violence. CJP activists had gone to jail "with a smile" rather than resorting to violence, he added. "Our movement's strength is Gandhi's ideal. It is satyagraha."

Two-day remand violates legal procedure: Petition

▶Continued from P1

However, until late Tuesday, the court's cause list didn't have any case listed for hearing this week. However, sources said a call will be taken Wednesday if urgent listing has to be permitted and a vacation bench assembled for the same.

In their petition, the two said their two-day remand violated the legal procedure and their 'Right to Liberty' under Article 21 of the Constitution. They continue to remain in custody for six days despite submitting the required sureties multiple times, it said.

"The mandatory procedure under Section 140 BNSS was not followed for rejecting the surety, showing complete misapplication of the law in the impugned order. That delay and obstruction in the acceptance and verification of sureties frustrates the very purpose of release," the plea said.

The plea further argues that restricting the petitioners' liberty in the interest of public order requires a "proximate and real nexus with disturbance of public order" and not a remote possibility, pointing out that the issue of protest at a denotified site is, at its highest, a question of regulation, not a threat to public order.

File Photo

Saurav Das and Ashutosh Ranka were detained on Oct 13 after they climbed a gate to enter Jantar Mantar, which has been denotified as a protest site

Pests in storage area of sweet units, food handlers sans gloves

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New Delhi: Signs of pest activity and employees handling food without gloves in a sweet house's storage area in Okhla Phase-II, open dustbins in a Naraina unit and improperly stored food items in a freezer at IP Extension were among the lapses found by Delhi govt's food safety department during inspections ahead of the festive season.

The inspections revealed shortcomings in hygiene, cleanliness, food storage and compliance with prescribed food safety standards at several sweet manufacturing units and related establishments across the capital, said a senior official. The department also collected samples of sweets and other food products for laboratory testing.

In Okhla Phase-II, inspectors found that the water testing report was unavailable. In Badli Industrial Area, two establishments were found lacking in the display of FSSAI licences, training of food handlers and packaging-related documentation.

At a unit in Naraina, inspectors found employees' clothes kept in the work area and no insect-proof mesh on windows. Water and product testing reports were also unavailable. Another unit in the area had cobwebs on the chimney, inadequate measures to prevent the entry of pests and no designated space for employees to keep personal belongings. The prepared premix was also not labelled with its manufacturing date.

In IP Extension, inspectors noted peeling ceiling plaster, the absence of insect-proof mesh on windows and grease accumulation on the exhaust system. Moreover, food items stored in the freezer were not properly segregated and labelled.

The department also found unsatisfactory hygiene and cleanliness at a sweet manufacturing unit in Vidya Vihar (Hastsal) Industrial Area, while improvements were needed at an outlet in Uttam Nagar. Several hygiene and cleanliness shortcomings were reported at an establishment in Chandni Chowk while at two manufacturing units in Narela Industrial Complex, inspectors found lapses in compliance with prescribed standards.

Samples collected included khoya, rasbhari, barfi, milk cake, boondi dana, kesar rasbhari, aloo bhujia, ghee, palak boondi, boondi laddoos, kaju bites, kaju barfi and khajoor barfi. Samples of yellow-coloured rasmalai and fat emulsion used in cake preparation were also collected. The department collected samples of pista barfi and khoya in Chandni Chowk, kesar peda on Mathura Road, almonds in Okhla and peda in Patparganj Industrial Area too. No specific hygiene lapses were mentioned at these establishments.

CM Rekha Gupta urged food businesses to take responsibility for hygiene, safe storage, staff training and proper food-handling practices.

LAPSES FOUND AT SWEET UNITS

Okhla Phase-II | Signs of pest activity in storage area; **employees handling food without gloves**; water testing report unavailable

Chandni Chowk | Several shortcomings related to **hygiene and cleanliness** found at a sweet shop

IP Extension | **Peeling ceiling plaster, no insect-proof mesh on windows, grease accumulation on exhaust system,** and improperly segregated and labelled food items in freezer

Naraina | **Open dustbins, employees' clothes kept in work area,** no insect-proof mesh on windows; water and product testing reports unavailable at one unit

Naraina | **Cobwebs on chimney, inadequate pest-prevention measures,** no designated space for employees' personal belongings, and prepared premix without a manufacturing date label

Two women electrocuted by snapped power cable in Gzb

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Ghaziabad: A woman and her daughter-in-law were electrocuted, while her 18-year-old daughter suffered injuries after they came into contact with a snapped power cable in a field at Raj Nagar Extension in Ghaziabad Tuesday morning.

Satyawati (50) and Ruby (20) died on the spot, while Devshree is undergoing treatment, police said.

ACP (Nandgram) Ziauddin Ahmad said the incident took place around 6 am near 22 CG Stadium opposite Migsun society. The three women, residents of Khiriya Bakharpur in Badaun, were working in the field when the incident happened.

Family members rushed the women to a hospital, where Satyawati and Ruby were declared brought dead.

"Police received information around 8.15 am. The condition of the 18-year-old girl is stable," ACP Ziauddin said.

The ACP said the victims' field lies three feet below road level, where construction work was underway. Locals told cops that an earthmover struck an electric pole Monday night, snapping a wire that fell onto the road. A subsequent short circuit caused another cable to snap and fall into the field. The victims' family is yet to file a complaint, police said.

Akash Rastogi, a junior engineer in the power department, said a complaint has been submitted at Nandgram police station against the contractor engaged by Ghaziabad Development Authority.

No relief for 'predatory' rape convict

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New Delhi: A Delhi court has refused to show leniency towards a man convicted of rape as he had proved he had "predatory instincts" and so "cannot be allowed to roam freely and endanger other children".

The convict, Shamshad, had repeatedly sexually assaulted a 13-year-old boy in 2020. While in jail, he had tried to sexually assault undertrials too. The court cited a jail superintendent's report alleging Shamshad's sexual misconduct behind bars.

Sessions judge Sachin Sood said that the convict had showed no remorse and he posed a continuing threat to children, who could fall prey to his "lust".

The court noted that even behind bars, he had allegedly continued engaging in sexual misconduct with undertrials.

In June 2020, the 13-year-old approached police with his father, alleging that Shamshad, who lived near his house, had sexually assaulted him repeatedly over three to four months and threatened to circulate his photographs and videos if he disclosed the abuse.

The court found that Shamshad had "groomed" the child over three to four months, luring him with motorcycle rides, cold drinks and samosas before repeatedly sexually assaulting him. Prosecutor Shreyas Pragyan said the prosecution's case was supported by the victim's testimony, medical evidence and obscene photographs and videos found in Shamshad's phone.

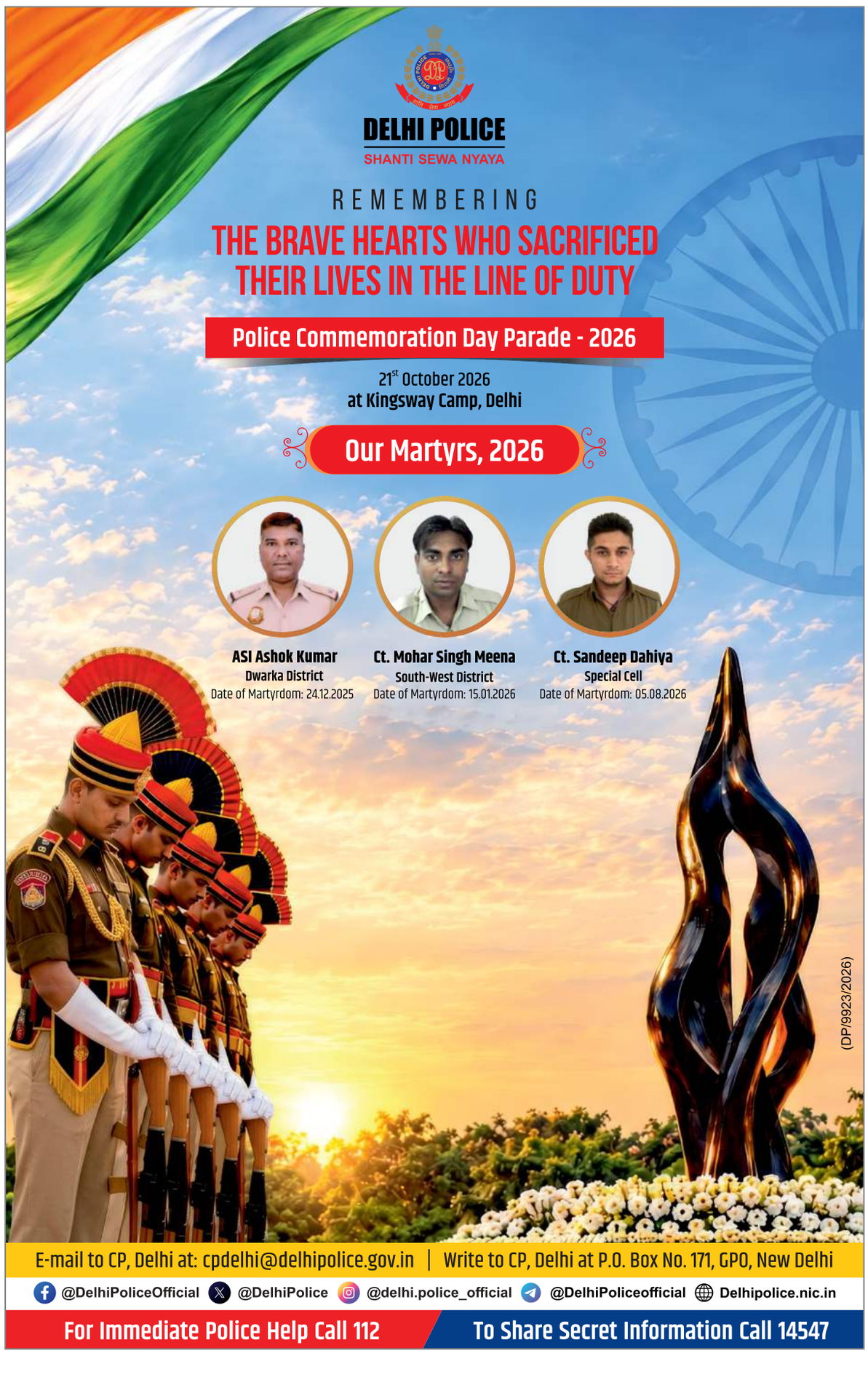
Rejecting the defence's claim that the photographs and videos were generated using AI, the court convicted Shamshad of aggravated penetrative sexual assault under the Pocso Act, criminal intimidation and offences relating to using and possessing child pornographic material.

It noted the medical evidence that repeated assaults had left the child's anal sphincter lax.

"The offences committed by the convict are barbaric and diabolical as he committed unnatural offence against the victim who was only a 13-year-old child. The trauma of the victim can be well understood," the court said.

The court added that Shamshad's jail record "reflected unsatisfactory conduct, with at least two punishment tickets issued against him" for alleged sexual misconduct against fellow undertrials in 2021 and 2024.

The court convicted Shamshad under Sections 377 (unnatural offences) and 506 (criminal intimidation) of IPC, along with Sections 6, 14 and 15 of the Pocso Act. Judge Sood awarded the boy Rs 10.5 lakh under the Pocso Act and the Delhi Victim Compensation Scheme.



TIMES NATION

* THE TIMES OF INDIA, NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 21, 2026

HAS RAHUL TAKEN VACATION TO VIETNAM BECAUSE HE'S TIRED FROM SPREADING FALSEHOODS, ASKS BJP

WON'T LET FARMERS FACE BLACK DIWALI, SAYS MAHA DY CM SHINDE, ASKS SAINIKS TO WORK 24x7 FOR RELIEF

YOU SAID IT

TN trash collector burns 3 puppies

An FIR has been lodged against an unidentified garbage collector for burning three puppies alive in Tamil Nadu's Tiruvarur following the intervention of People for the Ethical Treatment of Animals India (Peta India). The horrific killings came to light from CCTV at a nearby resident's house, Peta India said. The footage shows the trash collector covering the three sleeping puppies with cardboard sheets and burning them alive. Cops have filed charges under Prevention of Cruelty to Animals Act, 1960, and BNS Section 325. Efforts are on to identify him. TNN

Mom, beau held for killing twins

Twin brothers (13) were found murdered in Badesra village in Rajasthan's Deeg district Tuesday, police said, adding that their widowed mother likely conspired with her paramour to kill them after the boys opposed her relationship, reports **Rajendra Prasad Sharma.** Vinay and Vishnu Chaudhary were found dead in a plot near their house around 6am. Police said their mother, Preeti, called her paramour to the house and he and her 16-year-old son carried out the killings. The three were taken into custody.

Affair suspicion ends in 2 deaths

Two men were killed in a clash in Kachchh Monday following a dispute linked to suspicions of an extramarital affair, cops said. The deceased were identified as Jaypalsinh Sarvaiya and Prakash Suthar, reports **Nimesh Khakhariya.** Police said Vijay Gadhvi, a former driver at Jaypalsinh's travel firm, suspected his wife had an affair with Jaypalsinh. Gadhvi said Jaypalsinh knifed him, and Suthar suffered a fatal injury in the clash. Jaypalsinh's brother alleged Gadhvi and Suthar attacked Jaypalsinh.

Rubio: In talks with Reliance to refine more Venezuelan oil

'US Keen To Be Energy Supply Source For India'

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

PTI

Rubio at the 26/11 memorial at Taj Mahal Palace Hotel in Mumbai

Mumbai/Delhi: US secretary of state Marco Rubio Tuesday said US was in discussions with Reliance Industries on creating capacity to refine Venezuelan crude, calling India a refining superpower and underlining that Washington understood India's need to diversify its oil imports and saw Venezuela as a potential source of supply.

Rubio is visiting Jamnagar Wednesday to tour the Reliance refinery and, in a last-minute change of schedule, is likely to spend the night there. He was earlier scheduled to leave around 9pm and return to Mumbai. In Jamnagar, he will have dinner with Mukesh Ambani at the Vantara centre.

Rubio's visit to Jamnagar comes within weeks of a vicious attack on Ambani by Elon Musk, who even addressed him as "PM Ambani".

Before his departure for Jamnagar, Rubio will meet Gautam Adani and Tata group chief N Chandrasekaran in Mumbai.

Rubio, speaking to the media in Mumbai, said Reliance had previously operated in Venezuela and had the refining capabilities to process heavy crude oil. As Venezuelan oil production increases, the Indian company could play a role in processing more of the country's output, he said, adding that the discussions would continue.

"India is a refining superpower," Rubio said, noting that Reliance had existing oil concessions in Venezuela and had refined its crude in the past. "We'll see how the conversation goes," he said.

On India's purchase of Russian oil, Rubio said New Delhi had repeatedly expressed its desire to diversify its energy portfolio, describing it as a sensible strategy. He acknowledged shifting supply sources could not be achieved overnight but said India had made substantial progress.

"In the end, it's not just about Russian oil; it's about their desire to diversify," he said, adding US was keen to be a source of energy supplies for India. Washington had discussed Venezuela and other countries as potential sources, he said, arguing a diverse energy portfolio was in the interests of both.

India, US 'perfectly aligned' on key issues: Rubio

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Mumbai: US secretary of state Marco Rubio urged businesses to view the India-US relationship as a strategic partnership spanning technology, trade and security, saying the two countries were "perfectly aligned" on issues that would shape the 21st century, even as he acknowledged that disagreements between them would persist.

Addressing a gathering of India Inc's leading business figures at a Freedom 250 event at BKC, Rubio said the relationship between the two countries could help shape the future of the global economy, particularly as advances in artificial intelligence and quantum computing transform industries and societies.

"I truly believe the relationship between US and India is defining, in many ways, in a positive way, what the 21st century can look like," he said.

The gathering included Noel Tata (Tata Trusts), Anand Mahindra (Mahindra Group), Kiran Mazumdar-Shaw (Biocon), Ashok P Hinduja (Hinduja Group), Amit Dixit (Blackstone), Hitendra Dave (HSBC India), K Balasubramanian (Citi India) and Rahul Badhwar (JPMorgan Chase).

Rubio identified emerging technologies and secure trade routes as two areas in which the countries' interests converge. "US and India are perfectly aligned," he said, referring to the challenge of harnessing new technologies for public benefit. "We have the same talented people working on it, from engineers to creative thinkers and innovators."

He linked economic growth to the security of international shipping routes, arguing that businesses needed the freedom to move goods across borders and reach markets.

For India and US, he said, this required "a free and secure Indo-Pacific" in which "no nation can claim dominance or ownership of international shipping lanes".

"No two nations on earth will ever be perfectly aligned on every issue," he said. "But on the core issues that matter..., alignment between our countries is extraordinary."

The speech did not signal any immediate change in tariffs or market access.

Rubio said he believed US should engage more frequently with India, and he planned to return in three months.

US secy of state defends ties with Pak

US is required to have relationships with countries, including with those with whom it may have some disagreements, said secretary of state Marco Rubio while defending ties with Pakistan and condemning terrorism. Rubio also confirmed the next Quad leaders' summit would take place in Manila next month.

"In the case of Pakistan, it's a country that we have to have a relationship with, a country that possesses nuclear weapons. It's a country that from a geographic standpoint, we need to be able to interact with them in much the same way as govt of India has to have and has a relationship and meets with leaders from Iran," said Rubio speaking to Network 18.

"... It could be a positive thing because if... we can speak to them, it perhaps puts us in a position to help discourage the kinds of things India is worried about," he added. TNN

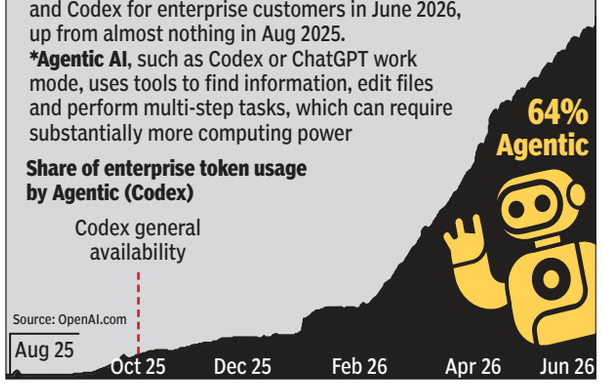
STATOISTICS A slice of life in numbers

Agents* now do nearly 2/3rd of business AI work

Codex tokens (used by agentic AI) accounted for 64% of all output tokens generated by ChatGPT and Codex for enterprise customers in June 2026, up from almost nothing in Aug 2025.

***Agentic AI**, such as Codex or ChatGPT work mode, uses tools to find information, edit files and perform multi-step tasks, which can require substantially more computing power

Share of enterprise token usage by Agentic (Codex)



Ahead of Shah's meet with Jhota kin, Punjab hands over case to CBI

Vibhor Mohan, Neel Kamal, Yudhvir Rana & Bharat Khanna

Amit Shah with Jhota's wife and son in Mansa Tuesday

Chandigarh/Mansa/Gurdaspur/Sangrur/Ludhiana: Hours before home minister Amit Shah was to meet the families of three persons who died fighting against drugs in Punjab, CM Bhagwant Mann announced Tuesday that his govt would hand over the probe into the murder of anti-drug activist Parvinder Singh Jhota to CBI.

While Mann said the decision was taken "respecting the family's demand", Shah said Mann had "done one good thing", and urged him to do the same for Gulzar Singh, a Sangrur man who died by suicide after being allegedly harassed for questioning the ready availability of drugs, and Gurdaspur's Bikramjit Singh, who was killed for taking on alleged drug sellers.

"The AAP govt is incapable of handling the drug issue so it should leave it to Centre. I assure the people of Punjab we will wipe out drugs from the state, as well as India, by Dec 31, 2029," Shah said.

"I will never forget this Dussehra as I met the families of three men from Gurdaspur, Sangrur and Mansa who were killed or driven to suicide for raising their voices against drug-related activities," Shah said in Ludhiana. In Mansa, he told Jhota's family he would attend his bhog ceremony after ensuring justice was delivered.

Mann posted on X: "We stand firmly with Parvinder Singh Jhota's father and his family at all times as they fight against drugs... Our fight against drug traffickers is a battle to the finish. We will not back down..."

Jhota's father, Bhim Singh, said in Mansa: "Till we do not get justice we have to accept the assurance. Now both the Union and Punjab govts are talking to us. We are also ready for talks with the Punjab govt but the state should be sincere in providing justice." He claimed Shah had told them justice would be delivered "in 24 hours".

The decision to transfer the probe to the CBI came as a surprise as AAP and Mann have repeatedly accused CBI of working to further BJP's political ambitions.

HC: Settlement can't override public interest in Pocso cases

Chandigarh: Punjab and Haryana HC has refused to quash a Pocso case against a man accused of making obscene gestures at two minor girls, holding a settlement between parties cannot override public interest in offences involving children, reports **Jagpreet Singh**.

Justice Neerja K Kalson dismissed the petition seeking quashing of an FIR registered in Dec 2024 in Rohtak. The accused argued the matter had been settled with the intervention of relatives and locals. "Such offences cannot be treated as disputes of a personal or private character so as to warrant quashing merely on the basis of a compromise between the parties," the court observed.

10-year-old charged with toddler's murder in Mum

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

Mumbai: Four days after an 18-month-old was allegedly pushed to her death down the stairwell from the sixth floor of a Goregaon building, Dindoshi police Sunday registered an FIR for murder against her 10-year-old neighbour.

The case was lodged on the basis of a complaint by the toddler's mother.

Soon after the death, police had produced the 10-year-old before Juvenile Justice Board, which said the girl would have to undergo counselling and appointed an NGO for the purpose. The girl was released in the care of her parents. Sources said the family left the housing society and moved in with relatives.

On Oct 14, the toddler was playing with a cat in the corridor outside her sixth-floor house. After some time, her mother, on not being able to see her, sent her 12-year-old brother to look for her. He spotted her at the bottom of the stairwell. Residents rushed her to a civic hospital where she was pronounced dead.

"After police checked CCTV footage, it was found the 10-year-old girl had gestured at my daughter and summoned her towards the lift," the mother said in her statement. She said the 10-year-old lifted her, threw her down the stairwell and ran away.

Youth killed by Assam mob after accident

Guwahati: A Class XI student died and his friend was critically injured after being assaulted by bystanders following a road accident while out puja pandal-hopping at Rangia in Assam's Kamrup district Monday night.

The student was identified as Dhanajit Kalita. People gheraoed the Rangia police station, demanding action against those responsible. Cops have detained two persons in connection with the assault. TNN

On Karachi's garba nights, Gujarat is just a song away

Ashish.Chauhan
@timesofindia.com

For some in Karachi, garba is an act of devotion. For others, it is a way to keep their Gujarati heritage alive across borders

A folk song that sends a little bird flying towards a goddess in Gujarat has found its wings in Pakistan, where generations of Gujarati-speaking communities have kept garba alive through Navratri, weddings and social gatherings. A new initiative aims to bring people of different religions and backgrounds together on a single dance floor.

In Karachi's Narayanpura, Ranchhor Lane and Keamari neighbourhoods, garba is a fixture on the festive calendar. Hindu families organise celebrations throughout Navratri, while Gujarati Muslim communities dance at social events. For some, it is an act of devotion. For others, a way to keep their Gujarati heritage alive across borders.

"There is no difference between garba in Pakistan and garba in India," says Ramesh Mana (84), a social activist and columnist who has watched the celebrations for decades.

When "Pankhida re udi jaajo" rings out, the song needs no passport to find an audience in Karachi. Classics such as "Umbre ubhi sambhlu re bol" share the dance floor with Bollywood favourites "Dholi taro dhol baaje" and "Chogada tara", drawing younger participants.

Shree Ratneshwar Mahadev temple and Swaminarayan temple are among Karachi's prominent venues for garba. As in Gujarat, celebrations range from neighbourhood gatherings to larger organised events.

Amarshi Bhatti (46), who works in Karachi's health department, says security remains essential. "We have to arrange bouncers. But it has seldom happened that a garba in Karachi has led to a clash or tension," he says.

Hyder Khoja, who leads a movement to preserve the Gujarati language in Karachi, says garba has become more visible over the past decade. "More people are taking part, and non-Gujaratis are showing interest too," he says.

Senior journalist and Gujarati linguist Syed Abdul Rehman says social media has exposed younger Pakistanis to festivals and traditions beyond their immediate communities.

While Gujarati Muslim families perform it at weddings and social gatherings, Khoja underlines a distinct practice among Khoja Ismaili Muslims, who perform garba on Oct 12 to mark the birthday of their 50th imam. "Views on music, dancing and participation differ within Muslim communities," he says.

Eruj Fatima, a Karachi influencer who recently graduated in New York, wants to turn that shared cultural thread into a gathering that cuts across community lines. She is organising a garba night on Oct 25, open to people of all religions.

"When I came back to Pakistan, I noticed that people from different communities performed garba, but often within their own circles. A garba night brings everyone together under one roof, celebrating unity in diversity. That is its true purpose," she says. Garba's magic lies less in who knows the steps than in who joins the circle, and "you often dance with people you have never met. That is what makes it special," she adds.

For a few hours on the dance floor, borders and backgrounds can all take a back seat. The circle keeps moving, and everyone has a place in it.

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L.K. Kakkar (I.R.S)

You gave us love, you gave us light, You taught us what's wrong and guided right. Though tears may fall and hearts may grieve, Your love is all we'll ever need.
We miss you always Reeta, Vivek, Vaibhav

Rajat Sikka (Mickey)

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Forever in our hearts,
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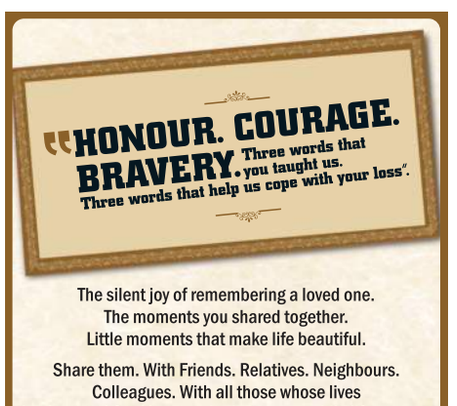

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HC cites long trial, lets off offenders, SC slams 'misplaced sympathy'

AmitAnand.Choudhary
@timesofindia.com

New Delhi: A "gracious" trial court and a "very indulgent" Allahabad HC paved the way for two offenders in a grievous hurt case to go scot-free without spending a day in jail on the grounds that they suffered because of a 22-year-long trial, but the courts did not consider the victim, who is still getting treatment, Supreme Court has said.

Now, SC has directed the accused in the 2003 case to surrender and asked the HC to conduct a fresh hearing.

A bench of Justices J B Pardiwala and K Vinod Chandran said it was a case of misplaced sympathy. The trial court had awarded five-year jail terms to the two, but the HC released them on probation. SC said the case was "doomed from its inception insofar as justice delivery to the victim is concerned".

"We cannot but, with an amount of consternation, notice the casual manner in which the trial court and the high court considered the issue from the stage of taking cognisance till the release of the accused on application of Probation of Offenders Act. They have gone scot-free without suffering a single day of imprisonment, especially by reason of the misplaced sympathy based on grandiose expositions of law," it said.

The court passed the order on an appeal filed by the brother of the victim, who has lost substantial functionality of both upper limbs.

SC said the HC "went overboard" and wondered how it could pass such an order despite the adverse report on the character of the offenders, noting that they were involved in multiple criminal cases. "True, protracted trial is agonising but here, the accused were on bail and merrily indulging in criminal activities," the bench said.

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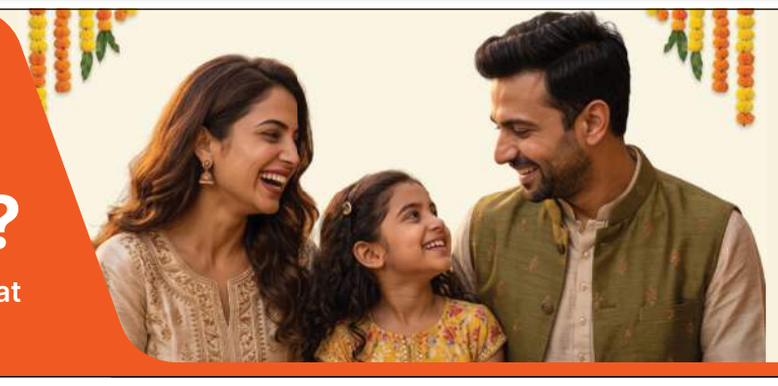

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Why longevity experts are reading organs, not disease

Measuring 'intrinsic capacity' has become the new core of healthy ageing science, moving clinicians away from a single summary clock

Shimona.Kanwar@timesofindia.com

Can your body's hidden reserves of everyday strength be the key to living a longer, healthier life instead of mere disease management? That's how 'intrinsic capacity' is quietly redefining conversations around longevity. The concept — introduced in 2015 by World Health Organisation (WHO) — tests how your organs and body systems are performing from the inside out: how briskly you move, how sharply you think, how clearly you see and hear, your emotional groundedness, and your overall biological energy to evaluate your true functional age.

Tracking these can reveal early cellular wear long before physical symptoms appear, allowing doctors to predict speed of organ decay years ahead. "For instance, dementia often starts taking root at around age 45, even though noticeable symptoms may not surface till you're 70," says former AIIMS geriatrician Dr Prasun Chatterjee. Catching subtle shifts early opens a vital window for targeted lifestyle tweaks to slow down, freeze, and even gradually reverse the ageing process.

How well are you ageing? What to look out for

- **Thinking:** Memory, word recall, ability to plan and make decisions
- **Movement:** Walking speed, balance, ease of getting out of a chair
- **Senses:** Ability to see and hear
- **Mental health:** Emotional resources that help you function in daily life
- **Vitality:** Underlying energy and reserves that support other capacities. Grip strength, balance can offer clues

Ageing has a score

Dr Chatterjee is leading an Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) study that's working towards India's first prospective biological ageing score. Aiming for a mid-2027 rollout, this research integrates surrogate markers across 13 recognised hallmarks of ageing (including DNA changes, inflammation and metabolic imbalance) into a multi-marker diagnostic algorithm, tracking a cohort of 200 people across five generations in NCR to forecast disease trajectories and functional decline decades earlier.

Early monitoring of intrinsic capacity can also uncover heart threats, hastened lung ageing in smokers, liver wear in heavy drinkers, or systemic strain in those living with obesity, adds Dr Chatterjee. "By 2027, advanced testing panels measuring heart inflammation, kidney filters, lung capacity, DNA changes, and gut bacteria are expected to power digital health applications. But bringing these tools to everyday clinics will take time as family doctors are still getting familiar with modern ageing science," he says. For now, local clinics can assess physical vulnerability by measuring hand grip strength, timed walking speed, waist-to-height ratio, body mass index, blood pressure, blood fats, and basic memory tests.

Every organ has an age

The Longevity India initiative by the Indian Institute of Science (IISc), Bengaluru has launched the Bharat study that moves away from single summary ageing clocks to map organ-specific ageing, from 18 to 100-plus. "Since organs degrade at different speeds based on geography, diet, daily habits and economic background, researchers are analysing deep molecular layers — genes, proteins, fats, biological chemicals and gut microbes — to pinpoint organ-specific decay," says study lead Deepak Saini, professor of developmental biology at IISc. The project aims to create a national health dashboard to enable early, preventive primary care tailored to local Indian genetic, dietary and environmental realities. Translating intrinsic capacity into clinical practice is critical for those in their 40s and 50s, feels Mumbai-based geriatrician Dr Shreya Gudi. While datasets like Longitudinal Aging Study in India (LASI) and LASI-DAD (Diagnostic Assessment of Dementia) demonstrate that higher intrinsic capacity correlates with better long-term survival, clinicians stress tracking subtle shifts in functional ability — minor drops in grip strength, walking speed, muscle mass, or balance — is more important than hunting for one abnormal lab value. Dr Gudi says telling someone their heart is 45 while their birth age is 60 might be appealing, but one must tread with caution. "Most organ-age algorithms are still experimental tools that need validation. What doctors can do is identify modifiable risk factors for organ damage and intervene early."

Role of epigenetics

Ageing is heavily shaped by epigenetic changes and lifelong exposures, including nutrition, physical activity, metabolic health, smoking, pollution, sleep, stress, and socio-economic environment. "Chronic low-grade inflammation, altered cell metabolism, immune system ageing, and build-up of damaged cells are therefore being studied as true biological ageing signatures," adds Dr Gudi.

Dr Marcus Ranney, founder of Mumbai-based precision longevity clinic Humanedge Essentials, says we are witnessing a catalytic moment where millions in India are beginning to appreciate the importance of a preventive approach to staying healthy for longer. "Ageing is inevitable but decline is optional. And that's where longevity medicine, or geroscience, is going to play a crucial part going forward. At Humanedge, we have a series of scientific protocols to help people on this journey."

Researchers say such initiatives may help medicine move from asking "what disease does this person have?" to "how is this person ageing, which organ systems are beginning to change, and what can we modify right now to preserve their function for longer?" That shift represents the real promise of healthy ageing research.

Additional reporting by Lata Mishra

Here's A 5-Star Workout Regime For Your Knees

Knee-friendly strength training is not just about lifting weights. You need exercise that builds muscle, maintains mobility, agility and balance, and reduces risk of falls as you age. These five moves can get you there, and are suited for all fitness levels

1 Goblet squat

HOW TO DO
- Hold a kettlebell, dumbbell or heavy book
- Keep weight in front to engage the core
- Bend your hips and knees to lower into a squat
- Keep your torso upright, then stand up

HOW IT HELPS: Targets thigh muscles (quadriceps), crucial for knee health

2 Step-up

HOW TO DO
- Use a sturdy box, low step or stair
- Step up with one foot, then bring the other foot up
- Step down, leading with the same foot
- Use a wall or chair for support

HOW IT HELPS: Strengthens leg muscles, improves balance

3 Jump squat

HOW TO DO
- Start without weights
- Stand with feet shoulder-width apart
- Bend your knees and hips into a squat
- Push off the ground and land softly with bent knees

HOW IT HELPS: Builds power and quick movement. Beginners can start with a tiny jump or rise onto their toes

4 Twisting jump-ups

HOW TO DO
- Stand on a sturdy, low platform
- Step off and land with knees slightly bent
- Turn your body after landing
- Practise stepping and turning before attempting jumps

HOW IT HELPS: Improves ability to twist, rotate. Helps prevent falls

5 Quick feet

HOW TO DO
- Place a flat, stable marker on the floor
- Stand with feet on either side of it
- Quickly step or hop from side to side
- Stay controlled and gradually increase speed

HOW IT HELPS: Builds balance and coordination

Why these moves matter

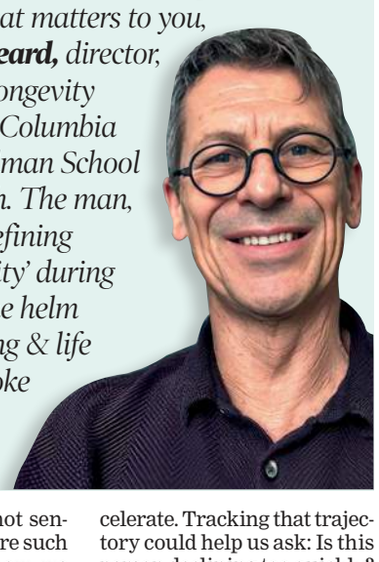
- Strength alone is not enough; knees need mobility, speed and balance
- Better coordination helps you recover when you trip
- Falls can lead to serious injuries, including hip or wrist fractures

Sources: The Washington Post, BBC

> The knee is one of the most complex joints in the entire body. It bears the full load of our body weight. When surrounding muscles don't work together, stress on joints leads to pain
> **Anikar Chhabra,** ORTHOPAEDIC SURGEON MAYO CLINIC, US

'If we just wait for disease, we've missed the real opportunity'

Healthy ageing is about retaining the ability to do what matters to you, says ***Dr John Beard,*** *director, International Longevity Center-USA at Columbia University Mailman School of Public Health. The man, credited with defining 'intrinsic capacity' during his decade at the helm of WHO's ageing & life course dept, spoke to* ***Shimona Kanwar***



■ You helped develop the concept of intrinsic capacity while leading the WHO global framework for healthy ageing from 2009-19. What does it mean?
We wanted to shift focus from preventing individual diseases to thinking more holistically about people's ability to be and do the things they value. Traditionally, if somebody does not have a disease, they are deemed healthy, and if they do, they are not. But what older adults identify as most important is whether they can still do what they want to do. Intrinsic capacity describes the individual attributes that contribute to that ability. A disease-focused approach can also fragment care. Someone with heart, respiratory and bladder problems may see different specialists and receive conflicting interventions, ending up taking a lot of drugs, some of which can interact. We need a more integrated view of their health.

■ What capacities does this framework look at?
We identified five pivotal domains: cognitive capacity, or the ability to think; locomotor capacity, or the ability to move; sensory capacity, including hearing and vision; psychological capacity; and vitality, an underlying domain that helps sustain the others and gives you the energy to do what you want. But functioning also depends on your environment. To see you, I need glasses. To sit down, I need a chair. What you can do reflects the interaction between your individual capacities and the environment you inhabit.

■ Do all these domains influence one another?
Yes, they are interconnected. We can look at each separately and also try to bring them together into an overall measure, but they do not operate independently. Hearing loss is a good example. It can worsen cognitive decline as people are less able to maintain connection with the environment around them.

■ Can intrinsic capacity be measured by a score?
Ideally, we would measure each domain and overall intrinsic capacity on a continuum, allowing us to detect small improvements or declines throughout life. Unfortunately, most measures currently available are not sensitive enough to capture such small changes. For now, we draw on existing tests. For cognition, we might assess memory, word recall or executive function. For movement, we can measure walking speed, balance and how easily someone gets out of a chair. Hearing and vision can be tested readily. Psychological assessments have generally focused on depression, although we need a broader approach. Grip strength is one measure that appears to tell us quite a lot about underlying vitality.

> A disease-focused approach can also fragment care. Someone with heart, lung and bladder problems may see different specialists and end up taking a lot of drugs, some of which may interact

■ These tests already exist. What does intrinsic capacity add to them?
We have had these measures, but have not necessarily used them to build a picture of someone's health across their life. Early in life, we develop and reach a certain level of capacity. As we get older, there may be a gradual decline, which can later accelerate. Tracking that trajectory could help us ask: Is this person declining too quickly? Are they doing well? Is something changing that needs investigation? Currently, a doctor often waits for someone to present with a clinical problem. We hope to detect changes much earlier, creating an opportunity to investigate and intervene before a condition develops. This is about health promotion as well as disease prevention.

Scan this to watch our podcast with **Dr John Beard**

■ How does this concept differ from assessing frailty?
Frailty is already a holistic concept: it describes an overall health state rather than an individual disease. Intrinsic capacity offers a way to monitor changes over time. Think of paediatrics. Doctors monitor whether a child is growing at the expected pace and meeting developmental milestones. We could take a similar approach to changes in capacity across later life, asking whether someone is moving away from a typical trajectory and, if so, why. That needs a different clinical mindset: maximising the capacity people achieve early in life, then helping them maintain the best possible trajectory month by month, year by year.

■ Does this mean disease diagnosis loses importance?
No. Disease remains important and needs treatment. But if we wait for disease, we have missed the real opportunity for intervention. I exercise and eat a fairly good diet, so I feel my health is all right. But I would like something that tracks it. That feedback might reinforce helpful behaviours or prompt changes. Detecting early biological warning signs could encourage people to rethink lifestyles or help clinicians identify suitable interventions.

■ Could phones, wearables help track these changes?
Yes. They collect a lot of data that we currently use quite crudely, such as counting steps. Some devices can also measure walking speed, which provides useful information about how your health is tracking. Phones could potentially analyse speech patterns and word use to provide inputs about cognitive capacity. The opportunity is to bring these different signals together into a coherent picture.

■ Could this concept lead to personalised care or interventions that slow down ageing?
We all have different genetic profiles and risks. Ideally, we would identify those risks and tailor interventions accordingly. Physical activity matters for everyone, for example, but the type or intensity may differ between people. Theoretically, if we understand the biological changes driving declines in capacity, we should be able to intervene earlier. Intrinsic capacity could potentially become an outcome in trials, helping researchers examine whether an intervention changes the trajectory of capacity, rather than looking only at the risk of a particular disease.

■ What is the biggest myth this approach could challenge?
That it is too late to change. Since intrinsic capacity follows a trajectory, interventions even late in life may help alter outcomes. There are opportunities at every stage to build capacity and, as far as possible, slow declines. Understanding that could challenge the belief that there is no longer any point in making a change.

▶ Continued from P1

Imphal valley shuts down over three Meitei killings

Manipur Police identified them as cadres of Kuki National Front (N), which is outside the ambit of the tripartite Suspension of Operations agreement with Centre and the state govt.

Based on the trio's interrogation, security forces confiscated 12 firearms, including INSAS, M16, AK-47, Type 81, sniper and Heckler & Koch rifles, three 12-bore guns, a lethode gun and a locally manufactured rocket launcher, along with 1,095 rounds of ammunition. The explosives haul included TNT slabs, rifle grenades, Chinese-made hand grenades, crude mortars and three detonators.

In a separate operation Tuesday, teams of Manipur Police, CRPF, CoBRA, Assam Rifles, and NSF searched the area around the designated SoO camp, known as Sinai.

The ADGP said 17 people were detained after their identities did not match the listed cadres of the KNO and KNA groups. He added that ammunition and magazines were found missing from the camp and verification was underway to determine whether they match the weapons seized during the operations.

The Committee on Tribal Unity, Kangpokpi, announced a 24-hour total shutdown from Tuesday midnight, condemning Thangeo's killing and terming the arrests of three Kuki-Zo men "indiscriminate". It alleged the arrests were made "without first establishing their involvement through a fair and impartial investigation." The organisation said 32 Kuki-Zo lives had been lost, 30 villages targeted in arson, 271 houses destroyed and 2,516 people displaced since the conflict escalated.

Zero FIR row: Raj Cong ups ante, BJP says 'mobocracy'

ShoebKhan@timesofindia.com

Jaipur: Congress members climbed barricades and protested Tuesday as Jaipur police refused to register a zero FIR over NSUI national secretary Ritu Barala's alleged assault by Delhi police, prompting BJP to accuse the opposition of fomenting disorder and announce a "Save Democracy, Remove Mobocracy" campaign in Rajasthan from Thursday.

State Congress president Govind Singh Dotasra and party MLAs spent Monday night at Jaipur police commissionerate demanding action against three Delhi police constables accused of assaulting Barala during an Oct 13 protest in New Delhi. Police said the same complaint was already under investigation at Delhi's Connaught Place police station.

Protesters from neighbouring districts joined Tuesday, shouting slogans and disrupting traffic. Police used mild force to disperse the crowd, but the sit-in resumed and continued late into the evening. Congress refused talks until the zero FIR was registered.

Dotasra accused CM Bhajan Lal Sharma's govt of acting at Delhi's direction. Former CM Ashok Gehlot briefly joined the sit-in, while leader of opposition Tikaram Jully backed the agitation.

Barala named the constables in her complaint at Jaipur's Moti Dungri police station Monday. Jaipur police said further action would be taken by Delhi police under law.

BJP state chief Madan Rathore accused Congress of politicising the row, questioning why Rajasthan was being asked to register a complaint over an alleged assault in Delhi. He said an FIR is registered where an offence occurs and legal remedies exist if police refuse to act.

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RFP for **"Construction of Elevated Corridor from Doddaballapura road (Police Station Junction) to NH-7 (Navayuga Flyover) at Kogilu circle via Old Yelahanka town"**

The Government of Karnataka has constituted Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited ("B-SMILE") for implementation of specific infrastructure works in the city of Bengaluru. **B-SMILE (the "Authority")** is engaged in the development of elevated corridors and other urban road infrastructure in the city of Bengaluru. The Authority has decided to undertake the work of **" Construction of Elevated Corridor from Doddaballapura road (Police Station Junction) to NH-7 (Navayuga Flyover) at Kogilu circle via Old Yelahanka town" (the "Project")** through an Engineering, Procurement and Construction (the "EPC") Contract, and has decided to carry out the bidding process for selection of a Bidder to whom the Project may be awarded. A brief description of the Project may be seen in the **Information Memorandum of the Project** on the e-Procurement portal of the Government of Karnataka at https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in. **Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited** now invites bids from eligible contractors for the following project:

Name of the work	Estimated Project Cost (Civil work cost excluding GST)	Construction Period	Maintenance Period
Construction of Elevated Corridor from Doddaballapura road (Police Station Junction) to NH-7 (Navayuga Flyover) at Kogilu circle via Old Yelahanka town	Rs. 102.66 Crores	30 Months (Including Monsoon Period)	10 years

The complete BID document can be viewed / downloaded from https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in. Bidder must submit its Financial bid and Technical Bid at KPP Portal of the Government of Karnataka - https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in.

Bid through any other mode shall not be entertained. However, Bid Security, Power of Attorney for signing the Bid, Power of Attorney for lead member of JV, if any, Joint Bidding Agreement for JV, if any, Integrity Pact and experience certificates apostile at foreign origin, if any shall be submitted physically in original by the Lowest Bidder before issue of Letter of Award (LOA) by the Authority. Please note that B-SMILE reserves the right to accept or reject all or any of the BIDs without assigning any reason whatsoever.

Officer In-charge: Project Engineer – 01, Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited, No. 30/1, 3rd Floor, Thimmaiah Road, Miller Tank Bund Area, Vasanth Nagar, Bengaluru – 560 051, Phone - +91-8892939394 (Smt. Savita Padamati), e-mail – pe1bsmiile@gmail.com

Schedule of Bidding Process - The Authority shall endeavour to adhere to the following schedule:

(1) Invitation of RFP (NIT): **19.10.2026, (2)** Availability of Tender Documents: **22.10.2026, (3)** Last date for receiving queries: **31.10.2026, (4)** Pre-BID meeting at venue as per clause 2.11.4 (B-SMILE office - No. 30/1, 3rd Floor, Thimmaiah Road, Miller Tank Bund Area, Vasanth Nagar, Bengaluru – 560 051): **31.10. 2026, (5)** Authority response to queries latest by: **05.11.2026, (6)** Last date of Request for BID Document: **12.11.2026, (7)** BID Due Date: **12.11.2026, (8)** Opening of Technical BIDs at venue shown in point 4 above: **13.11.2026, (9)** Declaration of eligible/qualified Bidders: **Will be notified, (10)** Opening of Financial BID: **Will be notified, (11)** Physical Submission of originals documents required as per clause 2.11.2 of RFP by the Lowest Bidder: **Will be notified, (12)** Letter of Acceptance (LOA): **Will be notified, (13)** Return of signed duplicate copy of LOA: **Will be notified, (14)** Validity of BID: **120 days from BID Due Date (15)** Submission of Performance Security (PS) and Additional Performance Security (ASP), if any: **Within 30 days of receipt of LOA. (The bidder has the option to provide 50% of PS and APS, if any within 30 days of receipt of LOA and the remaining PS and APS, if any to be provided within 30 days of signing of agreement), (16)** Signing of Agreement: **Within 10 days from the receipt of 50% of Performance Security and 50% of Additional Performance Security, if any**

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Office of the Project Engineer - 09,
Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited, Annex-2 building, Ground Floor, GBA Head Office, NR Square, Bengaluru – 560 002.

Bid No: B-SMILE/PE-09/TEND-02/2026-27 **Dated 19.10.2026**

NOTICE INVITING BID

(Through http://kppp.karnataka.gov.in only)
(Competitive Bidding under Two Cover System)

RFP for **"Construction of Elevated Corridor (Flyover) at Konanakunte Cross on Kanakapura Road"**

The Government of Karnataka has constituted Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited ("B-SMILE") for implementation of specific infrastructure works in the city of Bengaluru. **B-SMILE (the "Authority")** is engaged in the development of elevated corridors and other urban road infrastructure in the city of Bengaluru. The Authority has decided to undertake the work of **" Construction of Elevated Corridor (Flyover) at Konanakunte Cross on Kanakapura road" (the "Project")** through an Engineering, Procurement and Construction (the "EPC") Contract, and has decided to carry out the bidding process for selection of a Bidder to whom the Project may be awarded. A brief description of the Project may be seen in the **Information Memorandum of the Project** on the e-Procurement portal of the Government of Karnataka at https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in. **Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited** now invites bids from eligible contractors for the following project:

Name of the work	Estimated Project Cost (Civil work cost excluding GST)	Construction Period	Maintenance Period
Construction of Elevated Corridor (Flyover) at Konanakunte Cross on Kanakapura Road	Rs. 76.76 Crores	30 Months (Including Monsoon Period)	10 years

The complete BID document can be viewed / downloaded from https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in. Bidder must submit its Financial bid and Technical Bid at KPP Portal of the Government of Karnataka - https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in.

Bid through any other mode shall not be entertained. However, Bid Security, Power of Attorney for signing the Bid, Power of Attorney for lead member of JV, if any, Joint Bidding Agreement for JV, if any, Integrity Pact and experience certificates apostile at foreign origin, if any shall be submitted physically in original by the Lowest Bidder before issue of Letter of Award (LOA) by the Authority. Please note that B-SMILE reserves the right to accept or reject all or any of the BIDs without assigning any reason whatsoever.

Officer In-charge: Project Engineer – 09, Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited, Annex-2 building, Ground Floor, GBA Head Office, NR Square, Bengaluru – 560 002. Phone - +91-9964843326 (Shri. Chethan N S Naik), e-mail – pe9bsmile@gmail.com

Schedule of Bidding Process - The Authority shall endeavour to adhere to the following schedule:

(1) Invitation of RFP (NIT): **19.10.2026, (2)** Availability of Tender Documents: **22.10.2026, (3)** Last date for receiving queries: **31.10.2026, (4)** Pre-BID meeting at venue as per clause 2.11.4 (B-SMILE office - No. 30/1, 3rd Floor, Thimmaiah Road, Miller Tank Bund Area, Vasanth Nagar, Bengaluru – 560 051): **31.10.2026, (5)** Authority response to queries latest by: **05.11.2026, (6)** Last date of Request for BID Document: **12.11.2026, (7)** BID Due Date: **12.11.2026, (8)** Opening of Technical BIDs at venue shown in point 4 above: **13.11.2026, (9)** Declaration of eligible/qualified Bidders: **Will be notified, (10)** Opening of Financial BID: **Will be notified, (11)** Physical Submission of originals documents required as per clause 2.11.2 of RFP by the Lowest Bidder: **Will be notified, (12)** Letter of Acceptance (LOA): **Will be notified, (13)** Return of signed duplicate copy of LOA: **Will be notified, (14)** Validity of BID: **120 days from BID Due Date, (15)** Submission of Performance Security (PS) and Additional Performance Security (ASP), if any: **Within 30 days of receipt of LOA. (The bidder has the option to provide 50% of PS and APS, if any within 30 days of receipt of LOA and the remaining PS and APS, if any to be provided within 30 days of signing of agreement), (16)** Signing of Agreement: **Within 10 days from the receipt of 50% of Performance Security and 50% of Additional Performance Security, if any**

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Applicants are requested to submit their responses on or before, Date: 3rd November 2026 before 5.00 PM.

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tender & notices

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IN THE COURT OF MS. TAVLEEN KAUR MOHI, DISTRICT JUDGE-02, ROOM NO. 605, 6% FLOOR, DWARKA COURTS COMPLEX, DELHI | PC No: 53/2026
RAJENDER SINGH
Vs.
STATE AND ORS
DOH: 27.11.2026
CITATION UNDER INDIAN SUCCESSION ACT, 1925

Whereas Petition U/S 276 of The Indian Succession Act, 1925 for Grant of Letter of Administration of Will Dated 23.06.2025 in respect of, estate left by deceased Late Poonam Tanwar W/o Late Dinesh Tanwar R/o Flat no. 30, LIG Sector-14, Phase-II, Om Pocket-2, Dwarka, South-West, Delhi-110078. Petition has been filed by the Petitioner Rajender Singh C/o Sh. Sher Singh R/o House no. 146, Devi Mandir Road, Rithala, North West, Delhi-110085 in respect of the immovable properties mentioned below.
Flat no. 30, LIG Sector-14, Phase-II, Om Pocket-2, Dwarka, South-West, Delhi-110078. Plot no. 5, Office Space No. 307, Third Floor, Block-G, Vikaspuri, Delhi-110018. Plot area measuring 200 Sq. Yds, Dharam Kanta, Sookhi Nahar, Mundka, Delhi. Plot 150 Sq. Yds, in Nizampur Goan, Delhi. Plot no. 230, Block-A, area 400 Sq. Yds, Khasra No. 45/17, Village Madanpur Dabas, Bhagya Vihar, Jain Colony, Delhi.
Plot no. 86 & 87/D, area 60 Sq. Yds, Total 366 Sq. Yds, Khasra No. 32/5, Mubarak Pur Dabas, Bhagya Vihar, Delhi. Plot no. 86 & 87/D, area 219.6 Sq. Yds, Total 366 Sq. Yds, Khasra No. 32/5, Mubarak Pur Dabas, Bhagya Vihar, Delhi. Khata Khatoni 293/299, Khasra No. 8, Karal Village, Lal Dora, Bangla Area 2206.140 Sq. Yds, Delhi. Flat no. 1247, Bakkar Wala, Delhi. Plot no. B-56A, B-56B, Kh. no. 47/19, Ground Floor, Block-B, Jain colony Bhagya Vihar, Village Rani Khera, Delhi-110081. Indian Bank Saving A/c No. 50135756176, Branch Sec-12B, Dwarka, Delhi. SBI(Saving A/c No. 10377208151), Branch-Village Rithala, Delhi. One Locker with Gold in Fed Bank 57-B, Ground Floor, Hastsal Village, Village, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059. **One Account in Muthoot Finance No. E-61, Ground Floor Pipal Wala Road, Opp. Kaashee Playway School, Mohan Garden, Nawada, Delhi-110059, Loan against, Loan A/c No. FEDCLOG00003397, FEDCL0502000023 98, FEDR0050200000268, AND FEDED0502000026 7**
Whereas the case has been fixed for hearing on **27.11.2026** Notice is hereby given that any person having any interest in the Administration of the Estate of the said deceased may if he/she desires to appear in this court of the said **27.11.2026** and see the proceedings before the Grant of Letter of Administration. Given under my hand and the seal of this court on this **07.10.2026.**

(Tavleen Kaur Mohi)
District Judge-02 South West
District Dwarka Courts Complex, Delhi

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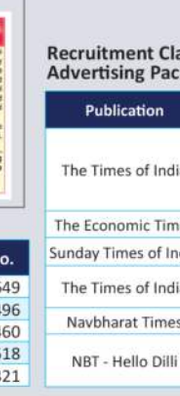

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Regime-change clamour fuelled by 'global forces' won't work: Bhagwat

'Public Movements Must Seek Solutions Within Constitution'

Vaibhav Ganjapure & Ved Ghulghule | TNN

RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat performs Shastra Puja at Reshimbagh ground as part of the Vijaya Dashmi celebrations in Nagpur Tuesday

Nagpur: A clamour for regime change "driven by demonic resolve to destroy all that is decent" won't work in India, RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat declared Tuesday, pointing to France, Albania, Nepal and Bangladesh as examples of upheavals that improved nothing, and warning that any attempt to destabilise the country would be thwarted.

Bhagwat, speaking at the annual Vijaya Dashmi event at Nagpur's Reshimbagh ground that also marked the conclusion of the Sangh's centennial, said India's "growing strength has turned it into a target for global forces". These forces, he cautioned, were "trying to weaken the country by exploiting its social divisions" and installing what he termed "proxies" in positions of influence. "A storm has swept in from the West. Even the so-called developed nations across the world are affected by this storm."

Alluding to protests by CJP and opposition (led by Congress), he said public movements must seek solutions within the Constitution and law instead of letting "bitterness", discord or pursuit of popularity deepen divisions.

He paired the warning with praise for Centre, albeit without mentioning PM Modi. Bhagwat said Bharat has carved out a place in the world through its strength and policy-making. "The collective endeavour of Bharat's society is bearing fruit in every sphere, driven by sound policies, leadership, national pride and an awakening of its awareness of its responsibilities towards the world."

He cited Captain Smit Machchhar, the flydubai pilot lauded worldwide as a hero after he helped avert disaster on a flight to Israel, as an example of values expressed through conduct. "His willingness to risk his life to protect others reflected his Hindu values passed down generations."

Bhagwat linked the recent floods in Nepal that claimed thousands of lives to one-sided development across the Himalayan region spanning Bharat, Bhutan, Tibet and China, and called for a "holistic approach weighing environmental limits against economic growth".

On the conflict between US and Iran, Bhagwat argued that geopolitical tensions, economic uncertainty and environmental crises all stemmed from an incomplete, materialistic view of development. "Bharat should draw on its civilisational values to offer the world a balanced model rooted in harmony."

Vijaya Dashmi is the victory of truth over falsehood: PM

▶ Continued from P 1

We should fight the enemies of the country together, PM Narendra Modi said, calling for a collective commitment to 'Nation First'.

His remarks came hours after RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat, speaking in Nagpur, cited political upheavals in France, Albania, Nepal and Bangladesh while warning against attempts to bring about regime change in India.

Bhagwat also cautioned against protests becoming political tools and urged both authorities and protesters to remain within constitutional limits.

Drawing lessons from Lord Ram's life, PM Modi stressed self-reliance. Despite the ocean separating him from Lanka, Lord Ram mobilised collective strength, brought together available resources and achieved what appeared impossible, he said. "We must not sit relying on others. We must recognise our own strength and we must have faith in our own resources," the PM said, linking the message to the goals of 'Atmanirbhar Bharat' and 'Viksit Bharat'.

Describing Vijaya Dashmi as the victory of truth over falsehood, Modi also recalled Lord Ram embracing Nishad Raj and honouring Shabari as examples of compassion and inclusion.

PM Narendra Modi attends Vijaya Dashmi celebrations in New Delhi Tuesday

He said that 'Ram Rajya' represented governance without discrimination, where everyone received justice and equal opportunities. "The objective of "power" is not to "rule", but public welfare," the PM said, urging service to the poor and deprived.

Linking national progress to cultural identity, Modi said, "A nation progresses only when it has a sense of self-respect," adding that heritage played an important role in building that confidence.

He said India's cultural treasures had been looted and taken abroad for centuries, but efforts were now under way to restore them. Over 650 ancient idols had been brought back in the past 12 years, he said, also highlighting Unesco recognition for Indian heritage sites and Diwali.

10 'drown' in UP & Raj during idol immersions

Prayagraj/Kota: Six people were reported drowned in UP and four in Rajasthan during Durga idol immersions Tuesday, report **Rajeev Mani** and **Rajiv Saxena**. In Gonda district of UP, three teenagers and a 50-year-old man drowned in Tedhi river in two separate incidents. The body of one has been recovered so far. At Devra village of Prayagraj, two young cousins drowned in Tons river.

CM Yogi Adityanath condoled the deaths and assured all possible assistance.

In Rajasthan's Kota, four young men went missing after a boat carrying seven people overturned in Kotri canal Tuesday. Three people were rescued while a search operation was launched to trace the remaining four.

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Gender Bias: The Quiet Dismantling of Female Leadership

By M Muneer

A woman can enter a global capability centre with an excellent résumé, strong credentials and the ambition to build a serious career. Then she meets the local organisational equivalent of a speed breaker: A manager who believes women are excellent at execution but not quite ready to be promoted to bigger roles.

The pattern is predictable. Men get the consequential assignments and the visibility; women get the routine work that keeps things running. An accomplished woman is told she is "not quite ready". An unremarkable man is "ready for the next challenge". And when a woman produces work that makes her manager shine, the credit acquires a male accent.

Worse is that organisations interpret departures as individual career choices rather than as data about managerial behaviour.

McKinsey's 2025 research covering 324 organisations and about 1.4 million employees found that women in India constitute 33% of entry-level employees but only 24% of managers. The report identifies recruitment, attrition and promotion as important barriers.

Globally, the so-called "broken rung" remains stubborn. McKinsey and LeanIn found that in 2025 only 93 women were promoted to manager for every 100 men. Only 31% of entry-level women reported having a sponsor, compared with 45% of men. The uncomfortable question for a GCC is "Who gets the career-making work?"

For women working under a manager with a gender bias, here are a few survival strategies:

Stop expecting performance alone to speak for itself:

Performance needs visibility, evidence and sponsorship. Document outcomes. Keep a record of projects delivered, revenue or cost impact, process improvements, client appreciation, automation created, risks avoided and problems solved. An objective record makes subjective narratives harder to manufacture.

Cultivate sponsors, not mentors:

A mentor may help in navigation, but a sponsor uses his or her organisational capital to put your name into the room when important assignments, promotions and succession discussions happen. Research says employees with sponsors were promoted at nearly twice the rate of others.

Deliberately build a career currency portfolio outside the immediate boss:

Global stakeholders, cross-functional leaders, senior executives, product teams and colleagues in other geographies should know what you actually do. In a GCC, this is particularly valuable. If your work serves London, New York, or Hong Kong, make sure the people benefiting from it can identify the person creating the value.

Don't allow "work-life balance" to become another gender trap:

Women should not have to choose between being seen as committed and protecting their personal lives. McKinsey research associates flexible-work and family-support policies with higher promotion rates for women, particularly in middle management. The practical answer is boundaries without invisibility: negotiate predictable working arrangements, and ensure that flexibility does not mean disappearing from high-value assignments.

Find allies:

A small network of capable women—and supportive men—can provide intelligence, sponsorship, emotional perspective and sometimes the courage to challenge behaviour that has become normalised.

Escalate patterns rather than personalities:

Present the organisation with evidence: allocation of high-value projects, promotion outcomes, performance ratings, attrition patterns, development opportunities and documented feedback. Ask senior leadership to examine the pattern. The International Labour Organisation points to organisational culture, unconscious bias and unequal power as continuing barriers. The most dangerous gender bias is not always the loud, offensive kind. Sometimes it arrives disguised as "business judgment", "readiness", "fit" or "performance". Sometimes the clearest evidence is the exit interview nobody conducted.

(The author is a start-up investor and co-founder of the non-profit Medici Institute for Innovation)

IIM MUMBAI
भारतीय प्रबंधन संस्थान मुंबई
Indian Institute of Management Mumbai
(Ministry of Education, Government of India)
Azadi Ka Amrit Mahotsav
VIKSIT BHARAT @2047
Advertisement for Teaching & Non-Teaching Positions
IIM Mumbai invites applications for Teaching & Non-Teaching positions from eligible candidates.

Advt. Number & Date	Post
Admn/Rectt/Faculty/2026/02 Date: 13.10.2026	Associate Professor; Assistant Professor (Grade-I); Assistant Professor (Grade-II)
Admn/Rectt/2026/41 dated 19.10.2026	Deputy General Manager (Career Development Services); Medical Officer; Manager (Civil); Manager (Electrical)

For detailed advertisements and other vacancies, please visit https://iimmumbai.ac.in/careers
Chief Administrative Officer

K.R. MANGALAM
World School
Gurugram
Affiliated to CBSE
Applications are invited from qualified and experienced candidates for the following positions:
- PRT Teachers - General, Hindi, English, Maths, Computer Science, SST, Science, EVS
- TGT - Physics, Chemistry, Biology, English, Maths, SST, Hindi, Computer Science, Sanskrit
- PGT - Accountancy, Physics, Maths, English, Biology, Chemistry, Economics, Psychology, Computer Science

FOE, IT Technician, Data Operator, Librarian, Counselor, Special Educator, Activity Teachers for Art, Dance, Music
Candidates with the necessary qualifications and relevant experience from a reputable school are eligible to apply.
E-mail : southcity.career@krmangalam.com
E Block, South City I, Gurugram

BHAIKAKA UNIVERSITY
Karamsad, Anand (Gujarat)
We are Hiring
Bhaikaka University
Instilling Purpose in Healthcare
Bhaikaka University offers healthcare and allied programs with a 1000-bed multi-specialty hospital. Applications are invited for the following positions.
General Manager / Deputy General Manager / Assistant General Manager – Pharmacy Department
Qualification: B.Pharm / M.Pharm with MBA or Master's in Supply Chain Management
Experience: 7+ years in managerial and leadership roles covering retail pharmacy, purchase and procurement
Clinical Research Executive - Research & Development Cell
Qualification: M.Pharm (Clinical Pharmacy / Clinical Pharmacology) with GCP certification/training.
Experience: 5+ years in clinical trial coordination and management.
Expertise: ICH-GCP, CDSCO/NDCT compliance, regulatory and ethics documentation, and clinical trial business development.
For details www.bhaikakauniv.edu.in/Career Interested applicants may share their updated CV by 29th October, 2026 at careers@charutarhealth.org, mentioning the position in the subject line.
Date: 21/10/2026 Registrar

SARDAR PATEL VIDYALAYA
Lodi Estate, New Delhi-110003
A remarkable legacy deserves an exceptional Leader
Sardar Patel Vidyalaya, New Delhi, invites an accomplished educationist as
PRINCIPAL
to lead its community and build on its ethos.
For nearly seven decades, Sardar Patel Vidyalaya has believed that a school's true impact goes beyond grades. We nurture young minds who think critically, know themselves and have a strong sense of purpose. Rooted in languages, culture and care, we shape a generation that is self-reliant, grounded, socially aware and resilient.
We seek an insightful educationist cum administrator to take this vision to its next chapter while making thoughtful choices for the future. Someone with intellectual openness, conviction and empathy who can lead and inspire teachers, bring out the best in students, and preserve a nurturing, values-driven environment where both children and teachers can flourish.
In return, we offer a collaborative environment, supportive colleagues, and the opportunity to shape young learners with purpose and integrity.
Eligibility
PG with a minimum of five years of experience as Principal/Vice Principal; deep familiarity with the emotional, social and developmental growth of diverse children; ability to communicate effectively in Hindi and English; in-depth knowledge of Delhi School Education and CBSE rules and fulfilment of their requirements.
As per rules, candidates above 50 years need not apply.
To Apply
Interested candidates may apply on the school website spvdelhi.org. by 30th October 2026
Outstation Candidates called for interview will be reimbursed for economy- air travel / 2nd AC train / Bus fare as applicable.

GRID CONTROLLER OF INDIA LIMITED
(A Government of India Enterprise)
Regd. Office: B-9, 1st Floor, Qutab Institutional Area, Katwaria Sarai, New Delhi –110016
Internship Opportunities in GRID-INDIA
Grid Controller of India Limited (GRID-INDIA), a Miniratna-I & Schedule "A" CPSE, a wholly owned Government of India Enterprise under Ministry of Power, invites applications for Internship under "विद्युत प्रज्ञा" – GRID-INDIA's Internship Scheme for Building Skills in Power System Simulation Studies.
For detailed information, please visit "Careers" Section of GRID-INDIA's website https://grid-india.in
Candidates are required to apply through the On-line registration system only.
Important Dates
Date of Commencement of Online Submission of Application: 22.10.2026
Date of Closing of Online Submission of Application: 06.11.2026

THE LAWRENCE SCHOOL, SANAWAR®
Celebrating Excellence Since1847
India's #1 premier co-educational residential public school, founded in 1847, invites applications for the following:
Teaching Positions:
1) PGT Mathematics -01
2) PGT Commerce -01
3) PGT Physics -01
4) TGT Sanskrit -01
Non-Teaching Position:
5) Lab Technician (School Hospital) -01
*Exp of Blood Collection & Testing
Completely filled Applications should be sent to, jobs@sanawar.edu.in within 10 days of publication of the advertisement i.e. on or before 31st October, 2026.
For more details please visit our website i.e. www.sanawar.edu.in or the link- https://www.sanawar.edu.in/jobs.php
ONLY SHORTLISTED CANDIDATES SHALL BE CALLED FOR THE INTERVIEW

L. K. SINGHANIA EDUCATION CENTRE
CBSE Affiliated
Invitation for Application – Principal
L.K. Singhania Education Centres are premier CBSE-affiliated Senior Secondary Co-educational institutions committed to academic excellence, character building, and modern educational practices. To lead our schools into their next phase of growth, we invite applications from dynamic, visionary, and accomplished educational leaders for the position of Principal at our Gotan and Nimbahera schools in Rajasthan.
Open Positions & Eligibility Criteria

Campus: L K Singhania Education Centre, Gotan (Day-Cum-Boarding School) https://www.lksec.org/	Campus: L K Singhania Education Centre, Nimbahera (Day School) https://lksecnbh.org/
School Nature: Residential / Day-Cum-Boarding School (Member of IPSC, Round Square, AFS, BSAI)	School Nature: CBSE Affiliated Day School
Mandatory Requirement: Strictly requires proven Boarding / Residential School experience.	Mandatory Requirement: Strong background in managing Day School administration & academic operations.
Age Limit: 40 – 55 Years	Age Limit: 40– 55 Years
Qualifications & Experience:	Qualifications & Experience:
• Min. 5 years experience as a Principal in a reputed boarding/residential school; OR • Min. 7 years experience as a Vice Principal in a reputed boarding/residential school. • Proven leadership in boarding operations, pastoral care, student welfare, and residential discipline.	• Min. 5 years experience as a Principal in a reputed Day School; OR • Min. 7 years experience as a Vice Principal in a reputed Day School. • Strong track record in academic administration, curriculum delivery, and parent-community engagement.

Key Focus Areas:
• Strengthening global and national networks
• Driving holistic development and co-curricular engagement
• Pursuing academic excellence, innovative pedagogical practices, and continuous learning outcomes
• Optimizing faculty continuous professional development (CPD), peer mentoring, and data-driven instruction among teaching staff.
•Taking administrative charge of student safeguarding and regulatory compliance
• Having complete oversight of residential/boarding life and hostel management (Gotan specific)
Desired Leadership Qualities (For both positions)
• Visionary Leadership: Progressive outlook with the ability to integrate digital pedagogy, experiential learning, and modern educational practices while preserving core Indian values.
• Communication & Interpersonal Skills: Excellent ability to lead, inspire faculty, and build strong relationships with parents, management, and stakeholders.
• Governance, Compliance & Strategic Fiscal Management: Enforce uncompromising standards in institutional compliance, risk mitigation, and fiscal health - working closely with management to ensure budget optimization, audit readiness, and long-term admissions growth.
• Campus Safety, Operations & Culture Building: Build a culture of discipline and safety, overseeing holistic campus health and safety protocols, operational excellence, and a values-driven environment.
How to Apply
Interested and eligible candidates are invited to submit their detailed CV along with a cover letter highlighting their leadership achievements, preferred location (Gotan or Nimbahera), and vision for the institution.
• Email Applications To: info.education@lksec.org
• Subject Line: Application for Principal – [Location: Gotan / Nimbahera]
Deadline: 30th October 2026
Note: Only shortlisted candidates will be contacted for the selection process.
LKSEC believes in ethos, traditions, and core values while nurturing an open, modern and inclusive campus culture.

DELHI METRO RAIL CORPORATION LTD.
(A Joint Venture of Govt. of India and Govt. of Delhi)
INDICATIVE ADVERTISEMENT
Delhi Metro Rail Corporation Ltd., The Lifeline of Delhi, invite applications for the following post(s):-

S. No.	Designation	No. of post(s)	Mode of Induction	Pay scale/ Remuneration	Last date of Receipt of Application
1	Sr. Engineer/ Engineer (Architecture, Civil/Track, Signalling & Telecom, Environment)	Nineteen (19)	Post Retirement Contractual engagement (PRCE)/ Deputation Basis	As indicated in the advertisement	04.11.2026
2	Supervisor (Architecture, Civil/Track, Signalling & Telecom, Environment)	Fifty-Four (54)			

The advertisement is only indicative. The detailed vacancy notification and particulars regarding the eligibility criterion, qualification, experience, age limit, mode of selection, etc. are available in the Career Section of the DMRC website: www.delhimetrorail.com under ADVT No.DMRC/PERS/22/HR/2026 (235).
Additional General Manager (HR) Project
Delhi Metro Rail Corporation Ltd.
Metro Bhawan, Fire Brigade Lane,
Barakhamba Road, New Delhi
Advertisement No.: DMRC/1003/2026

Hindustan Urvarak & Rasayan Limited
(A Joint Venture of NTPC, CIL, IOCL, FCIL & HFCL)
REQUIRES EXECUTIVES ON REGULAR & FIXED TERM BASIS
HURL invites applications in Executive cadre on Regular and Fixed Term Contract basis in various disciplines of Ammonia, Urea, Contracts & Materials, Mechanical, Security, Medical etc.
Interested candidates may visit HURL website www.hurl.net.in (career section) regarding registration, application process, eligibility criteria, experience requirement, corrigendum, updates, etc.
Registration Start Date: 16/10/2026
Registration End Date: 06/11/2026
Core-4, 9th Floor, SCOPE Minar, Laxmi Nagar, Delhi-110092
Website: www.hurl.net.in

THE SINGAPORE HIGH COMMISSION IN NEW DELHI
is recruiting for the post of
ASSISTANT MANAGER, FINANCE & HR
Is responsible for Managing the Finance & HR Section comprising one Finance Assistant and one HR Assistant.
The Assistant Manager, Finance & HR would be responsible for:
• Preparation of Budget and to conduct Quarterly budget review for the fiscal year.
• Handle and oversee day to day financial administration of the mission.
• Oversee and manage the recording, documention and submission of GST claims as well as to liaise with relevent Indian Government agencies.
• Create/ Update Employees EPF account on the portal as and when required and generate EPF reference number for payment of EPF via online banking.
• Organize and coordinate Mission's staff wellness events.
• Assist the Office Manger in providing relocation services and supports for Home Based Staff including application for stay visa, Diplomatic IDs, shipment and accommodation matters.
• Act as administrator for the LRS Leave Management Systems.
• Track employee contract renewals including medical screening and preparation of employment contracts.
The ideal candidate would:
• Have a degree, preferably in human resource and/ or Accounting & Finance.
• Have at least five years of experience in a relevant or related role.
• Have a good command of spoken and writing English and Hindi.
• Be proficient in Microsoft Word, Excel, etc.
• Have an eye for details and a preference for precision and rigour in his/ her work.
• Be adoptable and able to think on his /her feet, a team player and able to multitask.
A career at the Singapore High Commission will:
• Be rewarding and fulfilling.
• Starting Salary INR 49,350.00
Interested candidates should submit their CV/ application to: shc_hr@mfa.sg by Wednesday, 28 October 2026.

भारतीय प्रबंध संस्थान कोझिकोड
Indian Institute of Management Kozhikode
Globalizing Indian Thought
INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT KOZHIKODE
IIM Kozhikode Campus P.O., Kozhikode-673 570, Kerala
Advt. No.R-02/2026
Online Applications are invited for filling up the following regular vacancies at Main Campus & Kochi Campus of IIM Kozhikode:

01	Assistant :(05 Posts: UR-02, SC-01, OBC-01, ST-01[Backlog])
02	Junior Assistant :(04 Posts: UR-02, SC-01, OBC-01)
03	Junior Accountant :(02 Posts: UR-01, SC-01)

For details and online application, please visit www.iimk.ac.in
Sd/-
Lt. Col. M Julius George (Retd.)
Head-Administration & HR
Date:21.10.2026

'Forcibly kissing child not act of affection': 50-yr-old gets 5yrs' RI

Rebecca.Samervel
@timesofindia.com

Mumbai: A special Pocso court has sentenced a 50-year-old contractor to five years' rigorous imprisonment for aggravated sexual assault on a four- Jyear-old girl in March 2025, rejecting his claim that kissing her was an act of affection.

Noting that the girl had, during cross-examination, said that acquaintances would sometimes pick her up, toss her in the air, catch her, kiss her and return her to her mother, the court held that such conduct related to persons known to the child, whereas the accused was a stranger. Observing that the child's testimony was reliable despite her age and the accused's explanation "not believable and trustworthy", the court held that the kiss could not be treated as an act of love or affection.

Special judge Richa D Khedekar of the fast track special court held that the prosecution had proved aggravated sexual assault against a child below 12 years. The court also fined the accused Rs 10,000 and directed that, in default, he undergo simple imprisonment for two months, and awarded the girl Rs 5,000 compensation.

The accused, in custody since his arrest on March 3, 2025, was granted set-off for time served.

Imposing the minimum sentence, the court said sexual assault against a four-year-old child must be punished "at the initial stage" to prevent graver offences. "The punishment should be a message to the society for prevention of such acts by any person against any minor victim," the judge said, while also noting the accused's age, absence of past criminal record and the need to give him an opportunity for reformation.

The incident occurred on March 3, 2025, when the girl was walking ahead of her mother towards a temple. The prosecution said the accused caught her, held her neck and hands, forcibly kissed her and bit her cheek and the rear of her neck, making her cry. Local residents caught him and handed him over to police.

Only a small number of items left to wrap up: Rubio on Indo-US deal

▶Continued from P 1

Rubio reiterated that increased energy trade with US can play a transformative role in diversifying India's supply chains while meeting its sizeable consumer demand.

Rubio's second visit to India is taking place against the backdrop of US's Sanctioning Russia and Iran Act meant to penalise countries purchasing Russian oil and Trump's subsequent temporary suspension of related tariffs. India maintains that its oil procurement is essential not just for its own energy security but also stability of the global markets. Rubio lauded the "substantial progress" made by India in diversifying its energy portfolio.

Rubio also focused on reducing India's reliance on Russia in defence as he stressed the deepening of defence interoperability, framing enhanced technology purchases by India as a win-win situation for both nations.

According to the US readout, Rubio also commended recent progress in bilateral defence and civil nuclear cooperation, and advocated increased purchase of US technologies and systems, which can enhance the security and prosperity of both countries.

Rubio said in a post on X that he and Jaishankar reaffirmed the importance of advancing the US-India strategic partnership. The ministers will meet again on the sidelines of the G20 foreign ministers' meeting in Atlanta later this month. Both will also join their counterparts from Japan and Australia for a meeting of the Quad foreign ministers in Atlanta.

According to MEA, Jaishankar and Rubio welcomed the progress made in negotiations on the India-US bilateral trade agreement and reaffirmed their commitment to working towards its early conclusion. Rubio said both sides were "as close as you can be without having an executed agreement".

"I think there's a small number of items left to wrap up… and hopefully have some good news to announce fairly soon, and perhaps the leaders can sign it thereafter," said Rubio, addressing the US travelling media.

Shortly after his arrival, Rubio laid a wreath at Mumbai's Taj Mahal Palace Hotel to honour the victims of 26/11. "Secretary Rubio underscored the Trump administration's commitment to dismantling terrorist networks and ensuring that those responsible for acts of terrorism are brought to justice, including individuals facing charges for their roles in planning the 2008 Mumbai attacks," said the state department, without naming Pakistan.

India, US & UAE discuss energy at trilateral meet

Union external affairs minister S Jaishankar, UAE deputy PM and foreign minister Sheikh Abdullah bin Zayed Al Nahyan, and US secretary of state Marco Rubio held a trilateral meeting in Mumbai on Tuesday, exchanging views on energy, connectivity and contemporary developments. Jaishankar described the meeting as a useful exchange of perspectives on energy, connectivity and contemporary developments.

Following the meeting, US Ambassador to India Sergio Gor also posted on X, writing, "The US, India, and UAE have real opportunities to advance cooperation on energy, trade, technology, and regional connectivity. Marco Rubio, S Jaishankar, and UAE Foreign Minister Sheikh Abdullah bin Zayed Al Nahyan in Mumbai for a discussion on turning our close ties into concrete results!" TNN

Raut faces backlash for his 'learn from Albania' remark

Chaitanya.Marpakwar@timesofindia.com

Mumbai: Sena UBT MP **Sanjay Raut** courted controversy after suggesting that India should learn a lesson from student-led protests in Albania, which turned violent and targeted democratic institutions. Raut had claimed people in Albania set the country's Supreme Court ablaze for allegedly helping "corrupt PMs".

Raut later clarified that he had faith in India's SC. "What have I said, anarchy will spread. If this govt remains in power, anarchy will inevitably spread. SC should take cognisance... We have faith in SC, and it alone that can save the nation... The way Modi govt is opposing those hoisting the Tricolour, if we cannot hoist the Tricolour in our own country, what can we do?" Raut said.

Earlier, in a post on X, Raut said, "People of Albania have burned down the Supreme Court. People were enraged because it was helping corrupt PMs. The protesting public has also attacked Parliament and govt offices, as well as ministers' homes. All countries should learn a lesson from these events. Especially India."

Reacting sharply, BJP spokesperson Sidharth Yadav said opposition netas speak of bringing about "regime change" in India and suggest that Bangladesh has shown the way. He criticised Raut's remark about learning from Albania, where the Supreme Court was allegedly set on fire, saying opposition leaders sought to push India's democracy towards anarchy.

Former Sena UBT MP Priyanka Chaturvedi also disagreed with Raut, saying India did not need to learn from any other country. She warned against people taking the law into their own hands and destabilising institutions.

HC sets aside SP's notice to Meta to block FB page

Jagpreet.Singh
@timesofindia.com

Chandigarh: The Punjab & Haryana high court has set aside the Yamunanagar SP's order that directed Meta to block a local news outlet's Facebook page, calling the police action an arbitrary exercise of power.

Justice Tribhuvan Dahiya directed the SP to instruct Meta to immediately restore the verified Facebook page of Haryana 24 News Network Private Limited, which has been blocked in India since Aug 21.

"The SP usurped the power not vested in him in issuing the said intimation in flagrant violation of statutory provisions," Justice Dahiya said, holding that police failed to follow the statutory procedure under Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021.

The news portal argued that under 2021 IT Rules, blocking orders can only be issued by an authorised govt officer not below the rank of a DIG of police. It contended that neither a notice had been issued to the company nor a copy of the intimation issued to Meta furnished, causing business losses and adversely affecting its reputation.

Additional advocate general Bhupender Singh argued that one of the directors of the company was an accused in a case registered under Section 308(2) (extortion) of BNS. He had allegedly been continuously posting videos and sending messages through the Facebook page with an intent to intimidate the victim and witnesses in the case.

The high court noted rules required the govt to review such intimations every month to assess their necessity.

The HC called the police action an arbitrary exercise of power

BENGALURU SMART INFRASTRUCTURE LIMITED

B-Smile

Office of the Project Engineer - 07,
Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited
Annex-2 Building, Ground Floor, GBA Head Office, NR Square, Bengaluru-560002

Bid No: B-SMILE/PE-07/TEND-02/2026-27 **Dated 19.10.2026**

NOTICE INVITING BID

(Through http://kppp.karnataka.gov.in only)
(Competitive Bidding under Two Cover System)

RFP for **"Construction of Split Flyover at MEI Junction on Tumkur road in front of RNS Shanthinikethan"**

The Government of Karnataka has constituted Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited ("B-SMILE") for implementation of specific infrastructure works in the city of Bengaluru. **B-SMILE (the "Authority")** is engaged in the development of elevated corridors and other urban road infrastructure in the city of Bengaluru. The Authority has decided to undertake the work of **"Construction of Split Flyover at MEI Junction on Tumkur road in front of RNS Shanthinikethan" (the "Project")** through an Engineering, Procurement and Construction (the "EPC") Contract, and has decided to carry out the bidding process for selection of a Bidder to whom the Project may be awarded. A brief description of the Project may be seen in the Information Memorandum of the Project on the e-Procurement portal of the Government of Karnataka at https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in. Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited now invites bids from eligible contractors for the following project:

Name of the work	Estimated Project Cost (Civil work cost excluding GST)	Construction Period	Maintenance Period
Construction of Split Flyover at MEI Junction on Tumkur road in front of RNS Shanthinikethan	Rs. 41.62 Crores	30 Months (Including Monsoon Period)	10 years

The complete BID document can be viewed / downloaded from **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in**. Bidder must submit its Financial bid and Technical Bid at KPP Portal of the Government of Karnataka - **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in**.

Bid through any other mode shall not be entertained. However, Bid Security, Power of Attorney for signing the Bid, Power of Attorney for lead member of JV, if any, Joint Bidding Agreement for JV, if any, Integrity Pact and experience certificates apostile at foreign origin, if any shall be submitted physically in original by the Lowest Bidder before issue of Letter of Award (LOA) by the Authority. Please note that B-SMILE reserves the right to accept or reject all or any of the BIDs without assigning any reason whatsoever.

Officer In-charge: Project Engineer – 07, Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited, Annex-2 building, Ground floor, GBA head office, NR square, Bangalore-560002
Phone - +91-9900260607 (Shri. Mohammed Ajmal Ariff), e-mail – pe7bsmile@gmail.com

Schedule of Bidding Process - The Authority shall endeavour to adhere to the following schedule:

(1) Invitation of RFP (NIT): **19.10.2026**, **(2)** Availability of Tender Documents: **22.10.2026, (3)** Last date for receiving queries: **31.10.2026, (4)** Pre-BID meeting at venue as per clause 2.11.4 (B-SMILE office - No. 30/1, 3rd Floor, Thimmaiah Road, Miller Tank Bund Area, Vasanth Nagar, Bengaluru – 560 051): **31.10.2026, (5)** Authority response to queries latest by: **05.11.2026, (6)** Last date of Request for BID Document: **12.11.2026, (7)** BID Due Date: **12.11.2026, (8)** Opening of Technical BIDs at venue shown in point 4 above: **13.11.2026, (9)** Declaration of eligible/qualified Bidders: **Will be notified, (10)** Opening of Financial BID: **Will be notified, (11)** Physical Submission of originals documents required as per clause 2.11.2 of RFP by the Lowest Bidder: **Will be notified, (12)** Letter of Acceptance (LOA): **Will be notified, (13)** Return of signed duplicate copy of LOA: **Will be notified, (14)** Validity of BID: **120 days from BID Due Date, (15)** Submission of Performance Security (PS) and Additional Performance Security (ASP), if any: **Within 30 days of receipt of LOA. (The bidder has the option to provide 50% of PS and APS, if any within 30 days of receipt of LOA and the remaining PS and APS, if any to be provided within 30 days of signing of agreement), (16)** Signing of Agreement: **Within 10 days from the receipt of 50% of Performance Security and 50% of Additional Performance Security, if any.**

Sd/-
Project Engineer-07
Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited (B-SMILE)

ZONAL HEADQUARTERS CRIME BRANCH JAMMU

Phone No.0191-2544675 Fax No. 0191-2578901
e-Mail ID:sspcrmjmu@jkpolice.gov.in

LOOK OUT NOTICE

The public in general is hereby informed through the medium of this **Look Out Notice** that the present whereabouts of the below mentioned accused are required for the purpose of investigation of Case FIR No.41/2019 U/S 420,465,467,468,471,120-B RPC registered in Police Station EOW,Crime Branch Jammu.

Name	:	**Raj Kumar**
Parentage	:	**Lt Sh.**
Address	:	**Mohammodabad Gazipur, Mahend, Uttar pardesh.**
Age	:	**32 yrs.**
Height	:	**5'8"**
Color	:	**Wheatish**

Any person having any information about the whereabouts of above named person may contact the office of Sr. Superintendent of Police EOW,Crime Branch Jammu personally or share the information on E-mail ID sspcrmjmu@jkpolice.gov.in or Phone No. 0191-2578901 & 0191-2570060. The identity of the informer shall be kept secret.

Sd/-
Sr. Superintendent of Police
EOW,Crime Branch Jammu

DIP No: DIP/J-12710/26/19.10.2026

SPECIAL BRANCH
POLICE HEADQUARTER, M.P., BHOPAL

NO. SB / Store/2026-25 (784) Bhopal, Dated 14-10-2026

"ONLINE E-TENDER NOTICE "

E-tender are invited by Assistant Inspector General of Police, Special Branch (G) M.P., Bhopal on behalf of DGP MP Bhopal for the following item on website https://mptenders.gov.in/nicgep/app.-

S. No.	Name of Item(s)	Qty.	Tender Fees(Rs.)	EMD (Rs.)	Tender No.
			Paid Online Through mptenders.gov.in		
1	Vehicle Mounted Baggage Scanner	00	10,000/-	7,80,000/-	1st Tender

1. Cost of tender document (Tender Fee) is non refundable and cannot be exempted in any condition & **must submit online through** website https://mptenders.gov.in/nicgep/app.
2. Tender document can be download from the website of MP Police (www.mppolice. gov.in)
3. Bids shall be submitted online only at MP Tenders website: https://mptenders.gov.in/nicgep/app
4. **Tender Schedule** :

No.	Tender Activity	Date & Time
i	E-Tender Publish Date	14/10/2026 at 1700 hrs.
ii	Tender document download Start Date	14/10/2026 up to 1730 hrs.
iii	Submission of written queries -through e-mail: **aigg-sb@mppolice.gov.in**	**21/10/2026 up to 1700 hrs.**
iv	Pre Bid Meeting along with written queries	22/10/2026 at 1200 hrs.
v	Bid Submission Start Date	27/10/2026 at 1000 hrs.
vi	Last date of online e-Tender submission	03/11/2026 up to 1600 hrs.
vii	Bid will be opened on	04/11/2026 up to 1600 hrs.
viii	Demonstration from	Demo date will be announced seperately

5. Intending Bidders are advised to visit this website regularly till closing date of submission to keep themselves updated as any change/ modification in the tender will be intimated through this web site only by corrigendum /addendum/ amendment.
6. Bids will be opened as per date/time as mentioned in the Tender Critical Date Sheet. After online opening of Technical-Bid the results of their qualification as well Price-Bid opening will be intimated later.

Sd/-
D.I.G. of Police
Intelligence (G) M.P. Bhopal
Tel. No. 0755-2443654

G-20303/26

''पॉक्सो है सुरक्षा का हथियार, बच्चों पर न करें अत्याचार''

BENGALURU SMART INFRASTRUCTURE LIMITED

B-Smile

Office of the Project Engineer - 03,
Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited, No. 30/1, 3rd Floor, Thimmaiah Road,
Miller Tank Bund Area, Vasanth Nagar, Bengaluru – 560 051.

Bid No: B-SMILE/PE-03/TEND-02/2026-27 **Dated 19.10.2026**

NOTICE INVITING BID

(Through http://kppp.karnataka.gov.in only)
(Competitive Bidding under Two Cover System)

RFP for **"Construction of Elevated Corridors from Minerva Circle to Hudson Circle and loop flyover from existing Bala Gangadhara Nath Swamiji Flyover to Townhall and Elevated Corridors from Sangolli Rayanna Circle (Anand Rao Flyover) to Nrupathunga Road (KR Circle)"**

The Government of Karnataka has constituted Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited ("B-SMILE") for implementation of specific infrastructure works in the city of Bengaluru. **B-SMILE (the "Authority")** is engaged in the development of elevated corridors and other urban road infrastructure in the city of Bengaluru. The Authority has decided to undertake the work of **" Construction of Elevated Corridors from Minerva Circle to Hudson Circle and loop flyover from existing Bala Gangadhara Nath Swamiji Flyover to Townhall and Elevated Corridors from Sangolli Rayanna Circle (Anand Rao Flyover) to Nrupathunga Road (KR Circle)" (the "Project")** through an Engineering, Procurement and Construction (the "EPC") Contract, and has decided to carry out the bidding process for selection of a Bidder to whom the Project may be awarded. A brief description of the Project may be seen in the **Information Memorandum of the Project** on the e-Procurement portal of the Government of Karnataka at https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in. **Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited** now invites bids from eligible contractors for the following project:

Name of the work	Estimated Project Cost (Civil work cost excluding GST)	Construction Period	Maintenance Period
Construction of Elevated Corridors from Minerva Circle to Hudson Circle and loop flyover from existing Bala Gangadhara Nath Swamiji Flyover to Townhall and Elevated Corridors from Sangolli Rayanna Circle (Anand Rao Flyover) to Nrupathunga Road (KR Circle)	Rs. 539.94 Crores	30 Months (Including Monsoon Period)	10 years

The complete BID document can be viewed / downloaded from https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in. Bidder must submit its Financial bid and Technical Bid at KPP Portal of the Government of Karnataka - https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in.

Bid through any other mode shall not be entertained. However, Bid Security, Power of Attorney for signing the Bid, Power of Attorney for lead member of JV, if any, Joint Bidding Agreement for JV, if any, Integrity Pact and experience certificates apostile at foreign origin, if any shall be submitted physically in original by the Lowest Bidder before issue of Letter of Award (LOA) by the Authority. Please note that B-SMILE reserves the right to accept or reject all or any of the BIDs without assigning any reason whatsoever.

Officer In-charge: Project Engineer – 03, Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited, No. 30/1, 3rd Floor, Thimmaiah Road, Miller Tank Bund Area, Vasanth Nagar, Bengaluru – 560 051, Phone - +91-7406816031 (Smt. Geetha C), e-mail – pe3bsmiile@gmail.com

Schedule of Bidding Process - The Authority shall endeavour to adhere to the following schedule:

(1) Invitation of RFP (NIT): **19.10.2026, (2)** Availability of Tender Documents: **22.10.2026, (3)** Last date for receiving queries: **31.10.2026, (4)** Pre-BID meeting at venue as per clause 2.11.4 (B-SMILE office - No. 30/1, 3rd Floor, Thimmaiah Road, Miller Tank Bund Area, Vasanth Nagar, Bengaluru – 560 051) **31.10.2026, (5)** Authority response to queries latest by: **05.11.2026, (6)** Last date of Request for BID Document: **23.11.2026**, **(7)** BID Due Date**: 23.11.2026, (8)** Opening of Technical BIDs at venue shown in point 4 above: **24.11.2026, (9)** Declaration of eligible/qualified Bidders: **Will be notified, (10)** Opening of Financial BID: **Will be notified, (11)** Physical Submission of originals documents required as per clause 2.11.2 of RFP by the Lowest Bidder: **Will be notified, (12)** Letter of Acceptance (LOA): **Will be notified, (13)** Return of signed duplicate copy of LOA: **Will be notified, (14)** Validity of BID: **120 days from BID Due Date, (15)** Submission of Performance Security (PS) and Additional Performance Security (ASP), if any: **Within 30 days of receipt of LOA. (The bidder has the option to provide 50% of PS and APS, if any within 30 days of receipt of LOA and the remaining PS and APS, if any to be provided within 30 days of signing of agreement), (16)** Signing of Agreement: **Within 10 days from the receipt of 50% of Performance Security and 50% of Additional Performance Security, if any**

Sd/-
Project Engineer-03
Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited (B-SMILE)

BENGALURU SMART INFRASTRUCTURE LIMITED

B-Smile

Office of the Project Engineer - 07,
Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited
Annex-2 Building, Ground Floor, GBA Head Office, NR Square, Bengaluru-560002

Bid No: B-SMILE/PE-07/TEND-02/2026-27 **Dated: 19.10.2026**

NOTICE INVITING BID

(Through https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in only)
(Competitive Bidding under Two Cover System)

RFP for **"Construction of Grade Separators at Pipeline road from West of Chord Road to Outer Ring Road in Mahalakshmi Layout"**

The Government of Karnataka has constituted Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited ("B-SMILE") for implementation of specific infrastructure works in the city of Bengaluru. B-SMILE (the "Authority") is engaged in the development of elevated corridors and other urban road infrastructure in the city of Bengaluru. The Authority has decided to undertake the work of **"Construction of Grade Separators at Pipeline road from West of Chord Road to Outer Ring Road in Mahalakshmi Layout"** (the "Project") through an Engineering, Procurement and Construction (the "EPC") Contract, and has decided to carry out the bidding process for selection of a Bidder to whom the Project may be awarded. A brief description of the Project may be seen in the Information Memorandum of the Project on the e-Procurement portal of the Government of Karnataka at https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in. Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited now invites bids from eligible contractors for the following project:

Name of the work	Estimated Project Cost (Civil work cost excluding GST)	Construction Period	Maintenance Period
Construction of Grade Separators at Pipeline road from West of Chord Road to Outer Ring Road in Mahalakshmi Layout	Rs. 315.28 Crores	30 Months (Including Monsoon Period)	10 years

The complete BID document can be viewed / downloaded from https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in. Bidder must submit its Financial bid and Technical Bid at KPP Portal of the Government of Karnataka - https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in.

Bid through any other mode shall not be entertained. However, Bid Security, Power of Attorney for signing the Bid, Power of Attorney for lead member of JV, if any, Joint Bidding Agreement for JV, if any, Integrity Pact and experience certificates apostile at foreign origin, if any shall be submitted physically in original by the Lowest Bidder before issue of Letter of Award (LOA) by the Authority. Please note that B-SMILE reserves the right to accept or reject all or any of the BIDs without assigning any reason whatsoever.

Officer In-charge: Project Engineer - 07, Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited Annex-2 building, Ground Floor, GBA Head Office, NR Square, Bengaluru-560002
Phone - +91-9900260607 (Shri. Mohammed Ajmal Ariff), e-mail - pe7bsmile@gmail.com

Schedule of Bidding Process - The Authority shall endeavour to adhere to the following schedule:

(1) Invitation of RFP (NIT): **19.10.2026, (2)** Availability of Tender Documents: **22.10.2026, (3)** Last date for receiving queries: **31.10.2026, (4)** Pre-BID meeting at venue as per clause 2.11.4 (B-SMILE office - No. 30/1, 3rd Floor, Thimmaiah Road, Miller Tank Bund Area, Vasanth Nagar, Bengaluru – 560 051): **31.10.2026, (5)** Authority response to queries latest by: **05.11.2026, (6)** Last date of Request for BID Document: **12.11.2026, (7) BID Due Date: 12.11.2026, (8)** Opening of Technical BIDs at venue shown in point 4 above: **13.11.2026, (9)** Declaration of eligible/qualified Bidders: **Will be notified, (10)** Opening of Financial BID: **Will be notified, (11)** Physical Submission of originals documents required as per clause 2.11.2 of RFP by the Lowest Bidder: **Will be notified, (12)** Letter of Acceptance (LOA): **Will be notified, (13)** Return of signed duplicate copy of LOA: **Will be notified, (14)** Validity of BID: **120 days from BID Due Date, (15)** Submission of Performance Security (PS) and Additional Performance Security (ASP), if any: **Within 30 days of receipt of LOA. (The bidder has the option to provide 50% of PS and APS, if any within 30 days of receipt of LOA and the remaining PS and APS, if any to be provided within 30 days of signing of agreement), (16)** Signing of Agreement: **Within 10 days from the receipt of 50% of Performance Security and 50% of Additional Performance Security, if any.**

Sd/-
Project Engineer-07
Bengaluru Smart Infrastructure Limited (B-SMILE)

SEARCH FOR MISSING/KIDNAPPED

SANA

General public is hereby informed that one girl namely **Sana D/o** Imran Ahmad **R/o** in front of Sanjay Park, Baljit Nagar, Delhi, has been missing/ kidnapped from her house, since: **01.10.2026**. In this regard, a case **FIR No. 343/26 U/s 137(2) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita Dt. 16.10.2026**, has been registered at **PS: Patel Nagar, Delhi**. The description of the missing girl is as follows:

Age: 14 Years, **Height:** 5'3", **Complexion:** Fair, **Built:** Thin, **Face:** Long. **Wearing:** White colour Skirt & Pajama and Chappal in her feet. Sincere efforts have been made by the local police to trace out her but no clue has come to light so far. If anyone has any information about the missing girl then please inform **PS: Patel Nagar, Delhi** at following Tel No./ e-mail: **cic@cbi.gov.in** and Website: **http://cbi.nic.in**, providing clue about the person.

Ph: 011-24368638, 24368641 **Sd/-**
Fax No. 011-24368639 **S.H.O. Patel Nagar, Delhi**
DP/15023/CD/2026 **Tel No.: 8750870434, 7065506701**

TIMES BUSINESS

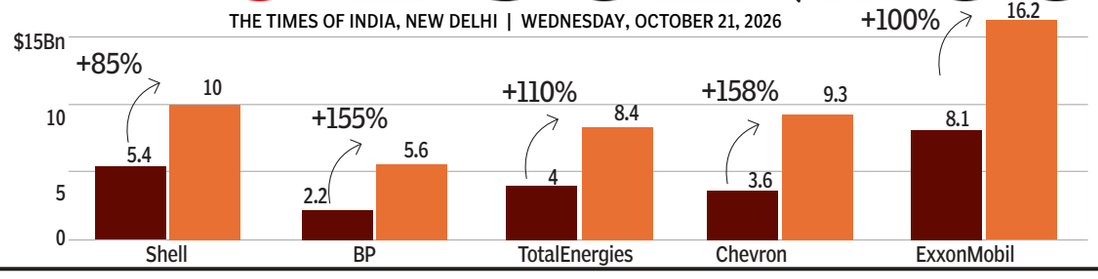
THE TIMES OF INDIA, NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 21, 2026

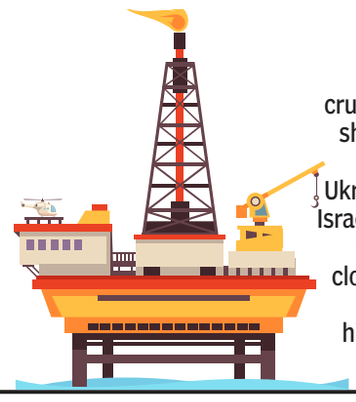
Oil Majors' Third-Quarter Profits Expected To Soar

As the US-Israel war with Iran disrupts global oil supplies and pushes energy prices higher, analysts expect oil companies to post net income gains between 85-158%

Note: All third-quarter 2026 numbers are estimates
Source: Reuters

War Has Boosted Refining And Trading Income





Profits on refining crude oil in Europe rose sharply in the wake of Russia's invasion of Ukraine, but the US and Israeli war with Iran and the Strait of Hormuz closure have sent margins to their highest ever for some refiners

Asean emerges as fastest growing region for exports

European Union Sees Slowest Pace Of Increase In April-Aug

Sidhartha@timesofindia.com

New Delhi: It all boils down to one commodity: Oil products. Asean has emerged as the fastest growing region for India's exports due to a spurt in petro product shipments – mainly to Singapore -- while the European Union saw the slowest pace of increase during April-Aug as export of petroleum products fell.

Latest data available with the commerce department showed that India's exports to Asean went up 56% during the first five months of the fiscal year as oil product shipments soared 2.4 times to over $6.1 billion, with Singapore accounting for almost three-fourths of it. What also helped was a 20-fold jump in computer hardware to $1.4 billion to Asean countries and strong growth of electric machinery (82% to $1.6 billion) and buffalo meat (42% to $1 billion)

OIL PRODUCTS GAME CHANGER

Region	2025-26	2026-27	% change
North America	44.4	47.9	7.9
EU	30.6	31.9	4.2
Africa	17.8	26.2	47.2
Asean	14.8	23.1	56.1
NE Asia	15.4	21	36.4
South Asia	10.3	12.8	24.3
Other European countries	7.7	9.5	23.4
Latin America	7.1	8.1	14.1
East Asia	3.6	4	11.1

Source: Commerce dept; Figs in $Bn

Since March, countries have recalibrated their energy purchases due to the disruption in West Asia.

In contrast, when it comes to EU, oil product exports fell 21% to $4.6 billion as the Netherlands cut back on purchases from India. While the Netherlands was the top destination for Indian fuel, with exports of $5.3 billion during April-Aug 2025, it has now slipped to the third place, behind Singapore and Tanzania, as the value of shipments crashed 47% to $2.8 billion.

A part of the impact in EU was offset by Spain and Italy. In April-Aug, India's exports to Spain rose 54% to $3.5 billion, with oil products jumping to $1.1 billion during the period, as against $172 million a year ago – an over six-fold increase. In case of Italy, the jump was even more dramatic as petroleum product exports rose from $4 million during April-Aug 2025 to $659 million so far this year.

Oil exports to North America fell 7% to $1.9 billion and the 8% rise in overall exports to the region, largely the US, was led by iPhones as telecom instruments rose 29% to over $11 billion, accounting for 23.5% of the exports to the region. Pharma exports too fell 5% to just under $4 billion.

Exports to the region slowed as the value of shipments to the US was up just over 6% to $42.8 billion, data showed.

Cognizant, Google Cloud expand tie-up to boost AI adoption

New Delhi: Cognizant and Google Cloud on Tuesday announced an expansion of their partnership to accelerate the adoption of agentic AI, including a new 'Gemini Frontier Capability Group'. The group brings together a dedicated global workforce that pairs Google's full-stack, enterprise-ready AI platform with Cognizant's domain, industry and engineering expertise as an AI-builder. Supported by more than 18,000 dedicated Cognizant associates, the new group represents a substantial joint investment by the duo. AGENCIES

Oyo parent to nearly halve fresh issue size

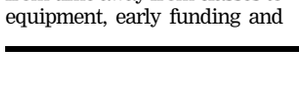
New Delhi: Oyo parent Prism is planning to nearly halve the size of the fresh issue in its IPO to up to Rs 3,350 crore from almost Rs 6,650 crore. People familiar with the matter said the reduction in the issue size follows continued strong cash generation and an improving balance-sheet position, which has lowered the amount of capital the company needs to raise compared with what was originally envisaged. The revised issue size comes with Prism continuing to focus on reducing its debt. AGENCIES

Gold extends decline as inflation weighs

Gold declined as elevated oil prices added fuel to inflation concerns and clouded the outlook for Fed Reserve's interest-rate path. Bullion traded around $4,120/oz, after falling 0.6% in the previous session. Oil climbed to a five-month high after Iran said it has "no choice" but to assert control over Strait of Hormuz, while US lawmakers resisted President Trump's diesel export deal with Russia. Gold has moved in the opposite direction to oil since Feb. BLOOMBERG

figure it out

28GW European Commission has proposed rules requiring data centres in Europe to disclose how efficiently they use energy and water. Data centres account for around 2.5% of EU electricity consumption. That share is expected to jump, as EU data centre capacity is expected to more than double by 2030, to 28 gigawatts compared with 12 GW last year



Source: Reuters

Smartphone shipments slip, Chinese brands lose ground

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

New Delhi: India's smartphone market suffered its steepest contraction in several quarters, with shipments plunging **26% in July–Sept** as higher prices put buyers off upgrades and prompted manufacturers to curb supplies ahead of the festive season. Shipments fell to 35.8 million units, the **lowest third-quarter volume since 2016**, according to Omdia. The slump also changed the pecking order: Samsung displaced Vivo at the top, while Chinese brands' combined share slipped to about 68% from 75% a year earlier.

Samsung shipped 6.7 million phones to regain leadership for the first time since early 2024. Its affordable Galaxy A-series supported volumes, while cashback, exchanges and longer financing plans helped attract buyers across price brackets.

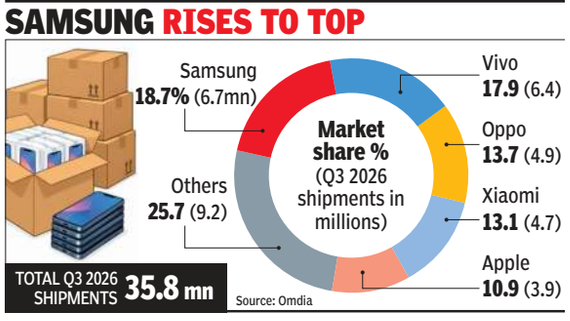
Vivo's shipments dropped 34% to 6.4 million — the sharpest decline among the top five. Repeated price increases disrupted retailers' inventory planning, while limited supplies of entry-level phones weakened its position. Xiaomi's traditional appeal of offering more features for the money also came under pressure. Rising component costs forced trade-offs on pricing and memory configurations, with shipments falling 28% to 4.7 million. OPPO ranked third with 4.9 million units, down 24%. Apple took fifth place with 3.9 million phones. Demand for the iPhone 16 and base iPhone 17, along with stocking ahead of anticipated price increases, supported shipments.

"Fewer exclusive launches, limited affordable SKUs and narrowing promotional differences reduced the online channel's traditional festive advantage," said Omdia principal analyst Sanyam Chaurasia.

A later Diwali exaggerated the quarterly fall by shifting some offline festive stocking into Oct. The figures track supplies to sellers, rather than purchases by consumers. But, the weakness could persist beyond the festive calendar.

Omdia expects another low-single-digit decline in 2027, with pricing pressure lasting through at least first half as consumers hold on to phones longer..

SAMSUNG RISES TO TOP



Review of 2019 mineral policy on cards amid new priorities

New Delhi: The Centre is set to review the National Mineral Policy, 2019, to align it with evolving sector demands, focusing on key priorities such as critical minerals, recycling, and deep-sea resources, according to people in the know.

The mines ministry has decided to constitute a panel to undertake a comprehensive review of the policy in the light of recent developments and emerging requirements.

The nine-member committee will be chaired by the additional secretary in the mines ministry, they said. The panel has been asked to submit its recommendations within two months of its constitution.

The National Mineral Policy, 2019, was approved by the Union cabinet chaired by Prime Minister Narendra Modi. It was aimed at ensuring more effective regulation and sustainable development of the mining sector, and addressing the concerns of project-affected persons, particularly those living in tribal areas.

The policy sought to create a more effective, meaningful and implementable framework by bringing in greater transparency, better regulation and enforcement, balanced social and economic growth, and sustainable mining practices. It also included provisions to boost the mining sector, such as measures to encourage exploration, attract private investment, promote ease of doing business and ensure sustainable mining. AGENCIES

Hacker group claims access to 3.8L SBI data entries

New Delhi: An unidentified hacker group operating under the name 'Siriusim' has claimed to have obtained confidential customer information allegedly linked to State Bank of India, including personal details, loan applications and account-opening documents.

The claim was highlighted by cybersecurity monitoring account CyberPulse56 in a post on social media platform X. According to the account, the group purportedly possesses about 3.8 lakh data entries in CSV format and 2,722 pdf documents associated with the country's largest public sector lender.

The allegedly exposed dataset is said to contain customers' personal information, residential addresses, loan applications, supporting documents and other application-related records. CyberPulse56 first reported the claim on Oct 16, stating that Siriusim had presented the material as its first disclosure of the dataset.

However, the authenticity and origin of the alleged data exposure remain unverified. The reported number of entries also does not establish how many individual customers may have been affected, as multiple records could potentially relate to the same person. There has been no independent confirmation that SBI's systems were compromised or that the documents originated directly from the bank. CyberPulse56 warned that if the dataset proves genuine, the information could potentially be exploited for identity theft, financial fraud, targeted phishing attacks and fraudulent loan applications.

The allegation comes amid broader concerns over cybersecurity risks facing India's financial sector. Meanwhile, earlier this year, RBI stepped up cybersecurity requirements for commercial banks. AGENCIES

PE-VC investments shine, may exceed $39bn this yr

PEs Double Down On Infrastructure Allocation, Mega Bets On Renewables, Data Centers Too

Yogesh.Kabirdoss
@timesofindia.com

Chennai: Despite ongoing geopolitical disruptions, India's private equity and venture capital (PE-VC) continues to rise. It is expected to exceed last year's levels of $39 billion, signalling a consecutive YoY revival. International PE investors' growing interest in Indian firms is putting greater focus on hard-asset businesses such as infrastructure and domestic manufacturing.

Data sourced by **TOI** from research firm Venture Intelligence shows that investments to the tune of $39 billion, comprising 1,434 deals, were recorded in CY2025. With 1,076 deals, it has already reached $32.7 billion during the nine-month period (Jan-Sept, 2026). It was primarily driven by record PE-VC investments in Sept 2026 at $6 billion. The PE-VC investments do not include those related to the real estate sector.

"Based on the very strong Jul-Sept quarter investment figures, the PE-VC investment tally for 2026 can be expected to end the year at an amount similar to or higher than the previous year," Arun Natarajan, founder of Venture Intelligence, said. After a plunge in PE-VC investments, which dropped to $48.9 billion in CY2022 from $64.4 billion in CY2021, it further decreased to $33.8 billion and $33.5 billion during CY2023 and CY2024, respectively. However, it revived last year (CY2025).

Noting that the Indian economy has been able to withstand many external shocks, including an oil-price-impacting US-Iran war, he said the IPO market has also held up—despite volatility in the secondary markets. "One of the key highlights this year is PE investors doubling down on their infrastructure investments. Large foreign investors have made several mega bets on infrastructure companies across sectors like renewable energy, telecom towers & data centers and toll roads; especially dominant has been the role of Canadian investors—like La Caisse (formerly CDPQ), CPP Investments and Brookfield—who have deployed over $3 billion in infrastructure companies in 2026," he added.

Aniket Dharamshi, co-founder and managing partner, ValueQuest Investment Advisors, said headline investment numbers in 2026 could exceed last year's levels, particularly if large infrastructure transactions sustain the momentum seen in the third quarter. "While India offers global investors an opportunity to diversify across sectors and growth drivers, beyond the concentration of capital in a few global technology themes, whether this translates into a higher deployment on core PE-VC will depend on economic and earnings growth, valuation expectations and a more stable investment environment," he said.

Geopolitics, national security, import substitution and supply-chain resilience are bringing greater strategic importance to businesses with tangible assets and domestic manufacturing capabilities. "At the same time, the AI build-out is creating demand from data centre infrastructure to power. Together, these forces are influencing where private capital is being deployed," he added.

ON A FIRM FOOTING

Top Five Sectors	Total Investment (in $ bn)*
Renewable Power	3
Hospitals	2
Data Centers	1.8
B2B Software	1.8
Sports Team	1.8

Source: Venture Intelligence | Jan-Sept 2026

Hotel tariffs in Delhi, Mumbai top Rishikesh, Ranthambore

Saurabh.Sinha
@timesofindia.com

New Delhi: For the first time since Covid, the leisure and spiritual destinations — Ranthambore and Rishikesh — have been overtaken by Mumbai and Delhi as the Indian cities with highest average hotel tariffs. Leading hospitality consulting firm Hotelivate's recently released trends & opportunities report for 2026 shows average revenue per available room (RevPAR) for Delhi at Rs 9,811; Mumbai Rs 9,761; Ranthambore Rs 9,649 and Rishikesh Rs 9,583 in FY 2025-26.

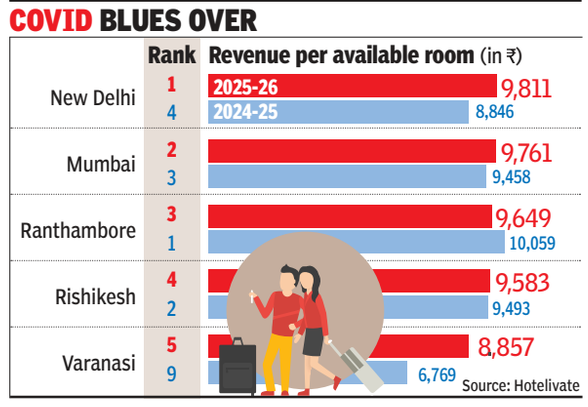
In the previous fiscal, the top four positions were Ranthambore (Rs 0,059), Rishikesh (Rs 9,493), Mumbai (Rs 9,458) and Delhi (Rs 8,846). This shows a revival in corporate travel, international visitation and the group-oriented Meetings, Incentives, Conferences, and Exhibitions (MICE) activity. Varanasi has shown a big jump in average tariffs with the holy city boasting of the fifth highest rates at Rs 8,857 — ahead of Udaipur (Rs 8,414) and Goa (Rs 7,614) — in FY26, up from the ninth spot in previous fiscal when its RevPAR was Rs 6,769.

The deadly Pahalgam terror attack last April saw Srinagar register its biggest fall in visitors. "Srinagar recorded the sharpest decline across the dataset, with RevPAR falling 51.9% year-on-year (to Rs 3,323 in FY 26) and the market moving from among the country's leading performers to the bottom 15. Jalandhar, Jammu and Amritsar faced similar pressures, as cancellations associated with Operation Sindoor weakened demand across markets closer to the border," says the report. "In recent years, leisure destinations, particularly emerging markets with limited supply and demand from destination weddings, (had) risen sharply in the national rankings. In 2025-26, however, Delhi and Mumbai emerged as the country's leading RevPAR markets.... Leisure destinations such as Ranthambore, Rishikesh and Udaipur nevertheless remained among the top performers," said the report.

"The gap at the top also narrowed considerably, with less than Rs 250 separating the four leading markets, compared with a much wider spread in the previous year. Strong performance in these leisure destinations has attracted additional mid-market and upper mid-market supply, resulting in some normalisation in market-wide rates without displacing them from the country's leading RevPAR markets," it added.

At the end of March 2026, India had a pipeline of 1.6 lakh hotel rooms to open in next five years. This was a 41% jump from the pipeline of 1.1 lakh exactly a year ago. "The pipeline is now approaching the scale of the country's existing branded inventory. If it materialises in full, India's branded hotel inventory would increase by 77% to approximately 3.7 lakh rooms. The top five markets are likely to be relatively unchanged with one exception; Jaipur is likely to surpass Chennai to become the fifth largest market in the country by operating inventory," it said.

COVID BLUES OVER



Classrooms to customers: What student founders need

Supriya.Roy@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: Classrooms have been carved out of office space inside a WeWork building on Bannerghatta Road in Bengaluru. A postgraduate timetable runs from noon to 8 pm, fitting study blocks around time for building businesses. Shrey Doshi (25), a postgraduate alumnus, walks in with a blue drink. "That's my product. Try it," he says, before explaining the blue spirulina and tender coconut.

This is Mesa School of Business, where students must build businesses and find paying customers. Elsewhere, engineering clubs and laboratories offer another route into entrepreneurship. Across campuses, the support founders need ranges from time away from classes to equipment, early funding and introductions to buyers. "The clearest difference comes from two things: time to build and access to infrastructure," said Richa Bajpai of Campus Fund, which invests in student-led businesses. She cited BITS Pilani's attendance flexibility and option to take time off to build as reasons it remained among the leading institutions supplying pitches to her fund. "Students who start companies still face rigid exam schedules and attendance rules that force a choice between their degree and their company," she said.

Colleges also need to let students learn across disciplines, she added. For technical businesses, support can be tangible. IIT Jammu gave MachFly Aerospace labs, resources and early financial support to build its first prototype, Bajpai said. Incubators also give young companies access to equipment they could not afford themselves, professors with domain expertise and alumni with industry experience, she said.

Bajpai points to govt grants, competitions and cloud credits as starting points for founders without family money or business connections. She also cited Human Biogenesis, whose founders came from humble backgrounds and started at BioNEST, IIT Guwahati's incubator. The company has since completed clinical trials, raised a seed round and is moving into production, she said. At IIT Madras, director V Kamakoti described Centre for Innovation as "run by the student for the student". Design clubs can feed into prototype development, with incubators, faculty and alumni supporting student teams. Citing Ather Energy's journey, he spoke of "12 to 13 years of gestation" and the need for patient capital.

Other businesses can test demand sooner. Campus Fund-backed Mumbai Pav Co began with Mesa classmates Tanay Agarwal and Jash Arora making food in another operator's kitchen and selling to business customers before opening a store, Agarwal said. He already knew his family's restaurant businesses; Arora brought culinary training. Access is uneven. Mesa's advertised four-year undergraduate programme costs Rs 48 lakh, excluding accommodation and overseas immersions. It does not award a university degree.

FROM CAMPUS TO STARTUP

TIME TO BUILD: Flexible attendance and academic breaks can help students pursue startups

LABS TO LAUNCH: Incubators provide equipment, expertise and prototype support

FUNDING FIRST STEPS: Govt grants, competitions and cloud credits help founders get started

CUSTOMERS BEFORE SCALE: Mumbai Pav Co tested demand by selling to businesses before opening a store

PATIENT CAPITAL: Ather Energy's journey highlights the need for patient funding

NETWORK GAP: Founders without warm introductions can struggle to get investor meetings

THE POLICY GAP: India's startup policy recommends academic flexibility, but implementation remains a challenge

GCCs emerging top career choice for tech talent: Survey

Shilpa.Phadnis
@timesofindia.com

Bengaluru: Indian technology professionals are increasingly looking for employers that offer hands-on artificial intelligence (AI) experience and clearly defined career paths, while multinational global capability centres (GCCs) are emerging as the preferred next career move for many, according to a Talent500 survey.

Talent500 is part of ANSR, which has set up more than 200 GCCs in India.

The survey of 2,000 technology, product and data professionals found that 71% wanted hands-on AI upskilling, but only 29% said their employers provided it. Career growth was another major concern: 87% said clearly defined career paths were very important when evaluating an employer, while 79% said they would abandon an application or decline an offer if growth opportunities were unclear.

The gap is also visible in employees' current workplaces. Only 46% of respondents described their career paths as very clear. Among GCC employees, the figure fell to 36%, compared with 50% in IT services and 51% in startups. This could make career clarity a differentiator for GCCs competing for experienced technology talent, particularly as candidates increasingly seek clarity on career progression before joining an employer.

GCCs were the first choice for the next career move for 69% of respondents, ahead of Indian product companies at 37% and IT services and outsourcing firms at 28%. Career growth was the leading factor in evaluating a GCC, cited by 48%, followed by the global parent brand at 41%, India-centre leadership and culture at 36%, and exposure to AI and technology at 33%. Vikram Ahuja, co-founder of ANSR and CEO of 1Wrk, said GCC hiring was growing 15-18% annually, with roles changing rather than hiring coming to a halt.

CONTRAPUNTO

Nobody is a villain in their own story.
We're all the heroes of our own stories

– GEORGE R R MARTIN

World's Refinery

Damaged W Asian refineries have caused a global fuel shortage. India has emerged as key swing supplier

Marco Rubio's visit to world's largest refinery at Jamnagar today, is a nod to something that we, as Indians, do not appreciate enough – India's heft as a global fuel supplier. Talk of hydrocarbons usually centres on W Asia, where the oil wells are. But crude by itself is no good – you can't even pave a road with it. Everyone everywhere needs a refined product, be it petrol, diesel, jet fuel, naphtha, or feedstock for plastics. And the ongoing troubles in W Asia and Russia have created a shortage of these refined products, which India is – not uniquely but advantageously – placed to fulfil.

Recent data shows that oil flows through Hormuz, and from Russia, aren't markedly lower than last year's levels. But because refineries in both regions have been damaged, fuels are in short supply globally. Diesel, for instance, is a political issue in US right now. French farmers are agitating over its high price; German citizens are simmering too. Even Russia has had to import petrol from India. Much of this has happened because about 20 refineries in Gulf countries have been damaged, knocking out 2.3mn barrels per day of refining capacity. Ukrainian strikes on Russian refineries have worsened shortages.

India has emerged as a strategic supplier in this scenario, for a bunch of reasons. First, investments in new refineries over the years, when many old refineries elsewhere have been shutting down. N America's current refining capacity is the same as it was in 1980, Europe's is down to 60%. About 100 refineries – 20% of world capacity – could shut by 2035. India, however, is aiming to increase capacity by 20% before 2030, and a further 45% thereafter. Second, its refineries are source agnostic. Europe's were made to handle Russian crude; they wind down when it's not available. Indian refineries can process any crude – Saudi, Venezuelan, Russian. Third, we're the closest major refining destination to W Asia, just four days away. So, now that oil is flowing, we're well placed to process it quickly and efficiently. In July, India exported 1.4mn barrels of refined products daily. Therefore, anyone who needs diesel – like Trump – or jet fuel – Europe – urgently turns to India, the world's swing supplier of fuels.

Lawrence Of Sabarmati

Mobsters are intricately intertwined with filmworlds for as long as films have been made

The attempt to target Tiger Shroff, because of his work with Salman Khan, sends worrying signals. Though, it's relatively early days for the Lawrence Bishnoi gang – ringleader in Sabarmati jail and brother in Tihar – making inroads into Bollywood, accused of murders, extortion and racketeering, and attempts on Salman Khan's life. As they say, nature hates a vacuum. With the end of syndicates' violent grip on tinsel town, could a new Bollywood mafia be wanting to emerge, embellished by, were it required, Bishnoi gang's businesses of narcotics and weapons smuggling?

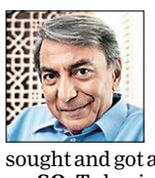
Bollywood's been as intertwined with the underworld as Hollywood. In fact, it's a foundational bond, symbiotic even. The inescapable irony will ever be that early Bollywood wannabe-moguls turned to mafia because banks wouldn't lend to them. Mafia was the alternative source – Haji Mastan, a pioneer, a celebrity criminal, unlike the brutal D-Company that was to follow. Just like in Hollywood, where docuseries *Hollywood Crime Story: The Mob Takes Over the Movies* notes how the Supermob, also called Kosher Nostra for its Jewish gangsters, carved up every aspect of Hollywood – "casting to funding to unionising". A half-million-dollar loan, in the 1960s, from Al Capone junior Johnny Rosselli was how Harry Cohn, Columbia Pictures' co-founder bought out his partners at the Hollywood studio. It is seen as the mob's first real stakes in Hollywood, after decades of running extortion rings and racketeering. "Where the mob once used violence to exercise control, these new figures wield the boardroom as their weapon." Mafia financiers remained low-key until they became subjects of movies they bankrolled. Post *The Godfather*, living kingsize became the thing to do, also kicking off Hollywood's blockbuster era. The iconic series, in turn, inspired underlings to make the kissing of the ring, and codenames, even more customary. It's hard to miss parallels in Bollywood – whether the lavish lives or the 'angry young man' movies based on mobsters' lives.

Corporatisation and streaming decentralised filming and its financing, to an extent defanging mafia's hold. Designated 'terrorist' in Canada, Bishnoi targets Salman Khan and those around for "hurting community sentiments". In filmy style, Khan's survival drives his crime. Another mobster, hanging onto a star.

Truth be trolled

Denizens of cyberspace are on the job night and day

Jug Suraiya



Before digital tech, trolls were imaginary creatures who lived in caves and possessed marvellous powers.

Today, trolls are far-from-imaginary beings who live in cyberspace and have marvellous powers of endlessly posting comments on all manner of subjects and all manner of people.

To find out more about this increasing tribe, **Second Opinion** sought and got an interview with a veteran troll.

SO: To begin with, how do I address you? Do you have a name?

Troll: Us trolls don't have individual names. We're a generic life form. Like bedbugs. Or body lice. Just call me Troll.

SO: OK, Mr Troll. How do you find things to troll?

Troll: We find things to troll by finding things that cause offence to our sensibilities. Like our political sensibilities, ideological sensibilities, cultural sensibilities, dietary sensibilities, and sensibilities about clothes that people should and shouldn't wear, particularly women. We even have a sensibility about sensibility itself which gets offended by dumb questions regarding our sensibilities.

secondopinion

SO: Wow! How do you find the mental space to fit in all these sensibilities which cause you offence and make you go on the offensive?

Troll: Other people fill their mental space with general knowledge, and common sense, and logic, and bunkum stuff like that. Our mental space is strictly for our sensibilities.

SO: But when your sensibilities are offended, don't you use language that's really offensive, like £@&*$!!?

Troll: Nonsense. Us trolls have high literary standards, like Leo Trollstoy, and Hemant Bhai who wrote a book praising us, called For Whom the Bell Trolls.

SO: I think it's Leo *Tolstoy*, and *Hemingway* who wrote For Whom the Bell *Tolls*.

Troll: That's as may not be. But now I'm off to see the latest post of the greatest troll of all. I'm going to check on us trolls' Trump card…

Lights, Camera, Billionaire Villains

New films about Elon Musk, Sam Altman, Mark Zuckerberg & Elizabeth Holmes show Hollywood turning on the tech tycoons. This twist reflects a growing American backlash against wealth creation

Ruchir Sharma

Columnist based in New York

For many years I've been analysing the Forbes list, to identify countries where rising wealth imbalances threaten to trigger social upheaval. A key assumption was that this threat would be low where wealth flowed to "good billionaires", in innovative and productivity-boosting sectors like tech, and high where "bad billionaires" were rising, in industries like real estate and mining, which are more closely associated with regulatory capture.

Hollywood is rewriting that script. Movies that trickled out after the dotcom bust of 2000 were either celebratory or partly slapstick "geek tragedies", about techie nerds who got greedy. Now comes a swarm of films that are closer to Greek tragedies, damning Silicon Valley billionaires, for godlike ambition and monstrous indifference.

Targets include Sam Altman in *Artificial*, Mark Zuckerberg in *The Social Reckoning*, Elon Musk in *Musk*, and Elizabeth Holmes in *You Can See Everything*, with more on the way.

Sampling these new releases in New York, got me thinking about why this dark turn is happening now, its ironies, and where it will lead. Hollywood tends to bash corporations after a crash, as was the case following 2000, and the financial crisis of 2008. But the AI boom is still in full flow. Americans are ambivalent about these tech billionaires – deeply invested in their stocks through 401ks, rapidly adopting their products and services, yet increasingly hostile to them.

This anger is personal. The American public embraced the digital revolution during the dotcom era, but has since turned on its biggest stars, including Zuckerberg and Musk, who have seen their popularity ratings fall deep into negative territory. Though normally far left of the national mood, Hollywood appears dead centre now, following mainstream popular opinion in recasting Big Tech CEOs as bad AI billionaires. And that suggests the backlash may intensify over time.

A theme running through these anti-tech movies is that hubris has consumed and corrupted Silicon Valley. In *You Can See Everything*, former Theranos CEO Elizabeth Holmes displays a delusional inability to grasp why she is headed to jail, for creating the miracle diagnostic tool that was later exposed as an empty hoax.

Artificial director Luca Guadagnino has Altman, CEO of OpenAI, muse about how the "Pandora's box" opened by AI will topple countries and industries, while "we shepherd people into this new world."

Musk director Alex Gibney describes Elon's key flaw as blind conviction that his own cause is so worthy, he is "willing and able and should be allowed to do anything" in its pursuit. Gibney coins a phrase, "noble cause corruption", for this Big Tech brand of corporate arrogance.

After long cultivating an image of political independence and socially liberal idealism, these billionaires are now seen as expedient monopolists, in bed with the Washington establishment, making them natural screen villains.

The second half of *Musk* dwells on his haphazard effort to deconstruct the deep state for Trump. Director Aaron Sorkin has a Zuckerberg "minion" claim that Facebook is "twice as big as the biggest country on earth", and therefore unafraid of Congress. "We are post-govt around here," he boasts.

The arc of character-decay is striking in every case. *Musk* traces its protagonist's evolution from EV entrepreneur out to save the world, to MAGA megalomaniac. Sorkin wrote both *The Social Reckoning* and its 2010 prequel, *The Social Network*, and his Zuckerberg has devolved from cold but dynamic to colder, more heartless, with no redeeming features. Once praised as an AI founder who cared about ill effects of digital tech, the Altman of *Artificial* could care less, saying with a shrug, "I didn't invent teen suicide."

These Hollywood takedowns reflect the nation's anti-establishment mood, capturing how completely it has engulfed the tech elite. Friends who attended the last Sun Valley conference in Idaho, the "summer camp for billionaires", told me the messianic faith of the tech moguls was striking: AI is all that matters; get on the train or get out of the way. For doubters, they express only disdain.

Given AI's potential to boost productivity and economic growth, I think it is premature to jump on the anti-tech bandwagon. But my billionaire framework tracks shifts in popular perceptions of the rich for warning signs of resistance, targeting the process of wealth creation. Socialist candidates and policies are gaining popularity, particularly among the young and in Democratic Party. More than 70% of Democrats now "say govt should act to reduce income differences", up roughly 15 points since 2010. And Hollywood is giving this movement a choice of public enemies to target.

US has nearly 1,000 billionaires, whose combined wealth of $8.4tn equals 27% of GDP – one of the world's highest shares. My framework has long assumed that the large share of this wealth held by tycoons in "good" sectors, helps US billionaires maintain a positive public image, and avoid political attacks.

But an overwhelming majority of the good US billionaires come from the tech industry, with only a few in manufacturing. Move the tech sector to the "bad" category, and the profile of the American billionaire class darkens dramatically.

The good share of US billionaire wealth plunges from over 40% to 2%. Among developed nations, the US ranking for good share of billionaire wealth slides from 4th to 16th. America then looks less like a model of entrepreneurial wealth creation, more like a society vulnerable to a backlash against the ultra-rich. Just like in the movies.

How To Take Research Beyond The Ivory Tower

India produces vast amounts of publicly funded science, but much of it remains locked behind academic language. Can a new project to make this knowledge accessible to farmers, policymakers, businesses…deliver?

Rich Rice and Soumya Kashyap

Imagine a researcher at a state university in Nagpur who has spent three years studying a fungal disease, which is damaging soybean crops across Vidarbha. Her findings are published online and freely available to anyone with Internet access. A QR code links to the paper. Yet, the farmers who could benefit most from this research may never see it. They may not read academic English, know how to search journal databases, or have experience navigating scientific publications. For them, the research might as well not exist.

Such gaps between producing knowledge and putting knowledge to work, affect many sectors of the Indian economy. No matter how much India invests in scientific research, value is created only when people can understand it, apply it, and act on it. When useful findings remain trapped inside academic journals, opportunities are lost.

This isn't a uniquely Indian problem. In UK and EU, funders including UKRI, NIHR, and Horizon Europe now expect a short, jargon-free "lay summary" alongside the final report. This is a distinct document from the scientific abstract, written so that a patient, a policymaker, a journalist, or simply a curious member of the public can follow what the research is about, and why it matters.

China is also taking interesting measures. In Dec 2024, it revised the law to formally recognise "science popularisation personnel" as a distinct professional category. Officials framed the revision as necessary, because the country suffers a) insufficient recognition of the value of public science communication, and b) too little initiative from researchers themselves.

In India, a new platform called SARAL.AI is attempting to address this challenge. How much it can make research easier for ordinary people to understand and use, remains to be seen. But its work really matters because scientific research influences nearly every part of India's economy.

In agriculture, research on crop diseases, pest management, irrigation, and soil health can help farmers increase productivity and reduce losses. But not as long as this info remains buried in technical publications that never reach farming communities. In public health, studies on nutrition, disease prevention, maternal health, and medicine rarely reach frontline health workers, or the communities they serve.

In education itself, students often encounter research written in dense academic language, which assumes prior knowledge they may not possess. In industry and entrepreneurship, valuable discoveries can remain underused when research findings are difficult for businesses, start-ups, and innovators to access and understand. The problem is not just access in the technical sense. Many papers today are freely downloadable, but that does not necessarily make them usable for non-specialists.

Image: AI

SARAL.AI (Simplified and Automated Research Amplification and Learning), launched on Oct 2, 2024, is an AI-powered platform supported by the Anusandhan National Research Foundation. ANRF is India's apex body to seed, grow, and promote R&D. One way to think about this project is as a translation service for research. Instead of asking the public to navigate dense academic papers, the platform converts research into formats people already use every day, such as presentations, audio summaries, short videos, reels, posters, and podcasts.

Developed by members of Ponnurangam Kumaraguru's research group at IIIT Hyderabad, the platform is free and open source. It can generate content in multiple Indian languages. As of Sept 2026, around 13,800 researchers had registered, with roughly 1,000 papers uploaded every 40-50 days, a sign that Indian researchers are genuinely hungry for ways to communicate their work, beyond journal pages.

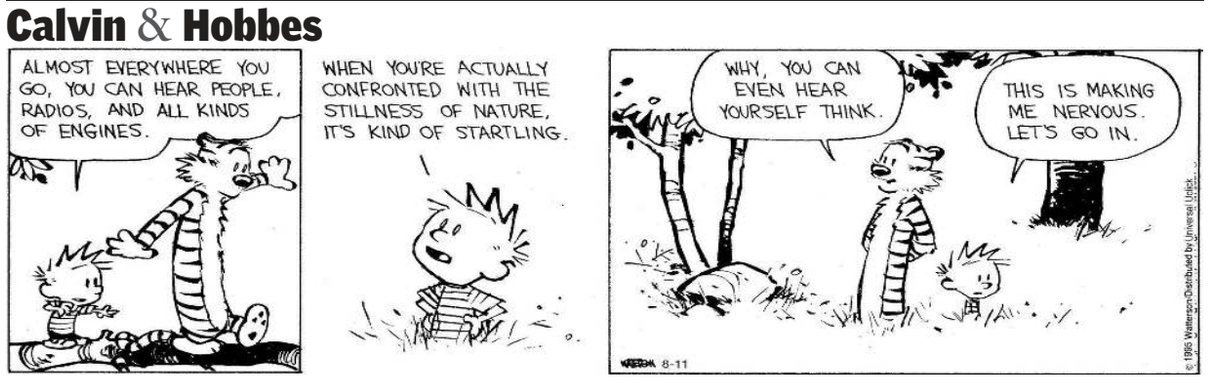
SARAL's three core verticals are democratising research, enabling knowledge diffusion, and using social media for knowledge dissemination. This is an ambitious trifecta, and the platform is currently more successful at the third level than the first two. But tech alone cannot solve the deeper challenges of research communication.

- First challenge is reach. Creating content is only one part of the communication process, ensuring it reaches the right people is another.
- Second challenge is incentives. India's research culture continues to reward publications, citations, and journal rankings. Researchers receive far less recognition for communicating their findings to broader audiences. A scientist who spends time improving public-facing research content, often receives little institutional credit for doing so.
- Third challenge is accuracy. AI-generated summaries can sometimes oversimplify complex findings, or omit important qualifications. And accuracy remains especially important in fields such as agriculture, medicine, and public policy, where misunderstandings can have real-world consequences.
- Finally, in a country as linguistically diverse and economically unequal as India, the challenge of making research matter is fundamentally a cultural and institutional one. The student in Nagpur, the farmer in Vidarbha, the civil servant drafting policy in a language other than English – these figures appear constantly in the rhetoric of Indian science, yet rarely in its reward structures.

Research becomes more fully realised only when it has been taught, discussed, translated, contested, and made accessible to audiences beyond those already seeking it. SARAL understands this, and that instinct is exactly right. What India needs now is for its universities, funding bodies, and promotion committees to understand this too.

Rice teaches technical communication at Texas Tech University and Kashyap at UPES, Dehradun

Calvin & Hobbes



Sacredspace

Hope is nature's veil for hiding truth's nakedness.

Alfred Nobel

Why Ravan Keeps Coming Back

Brahma Kumari Shivani

Ravan doesn't really live in paper and bamboo effigies. He lives in a harsh word spoken at the dinner table, in the silent jealousy of a colleague's success, in the restlessness that keeps us scrolling past midnight. The ten heads of Ravan are a portrait of ten human vices – lust, anger, greed, attachment, ego, jealousy, hatred, laziness, stubbornness and deceit. Each one is a thought pattern we have created and repeated so often that it now feels like our personality. 'I am short-tempered.' 'I am anxious.' 'That is just how i am.'

But none of these is who we are. They are just what we, as souls, have allowed ourselves to become over several lifetimes. In the epic battle, Ram removes Ravan's heads again and again, and each time a new one grows back. Doesn't this happen to us too? We work hard on our anger, practising patience for days. Then one day someone disrespects us, and we start fuming. We control greed, and jealousy returns.

We overcome attachment to a person but feel possessive about our designation. Essentially, we fight one weakness, and another appears in its place. Why? Because we are trying to sever heads without removing the source that keeps creating them.

Ravan could not be defeated. Ram's arrow struck his navel, where a reservoir of nectar kept regenerating him; only when that source dried up did Ravan finally fall. Similarly, every vice we carry is fed by one hidden reservoir: ego, also known as body consciousness.

Ego means attaching to a wrong image of myself, believing, 'I am this body, this name, role, status': We expect situations to go our way, so we get upset when they don't. We create endless desires to possess or achieve more, which makes us greedy. We fear losing what we have, so we become attached.

We compare ourselves with what others have, so we become jealous. All ten vices stem from the same source: ego consciousness. But we don't need ten arrows for the ten vices. It is a single arrow of soul consciousness. Soul consciousness is the true awareness: 'I am an eternal soul, a being of light, using this body as an instrument.'

THE SPEAKING TREE

Arundyuti Das Basu

When someone criticises, we do not think, 'They insulted me.' We pause and think, 'I am a humble soul. Let me evaluate their feedback and change myself if they are right.' When a colleague gets the promotion we wanted, we do not think, 'They must do it my way.' We think, 'I am a compassionate soul. Let me guide them.'

This is how we begin to finish Ravan – not by fighting each head separately, but by strengthening the soul consciousness that makes those heads powerless. The deeper victory isn't when anger disappears for a day, but when peace becomes natural. When jealousy is replaced by cooperation. When greed is replaced by contentment. When attachment is replaced by unconditional love. When fear is replaced by faith. That is the real Dussehra. Not just burning a demon outside us but awakening the light within us.

They wear white coats. They need armour now

Three incidents in four days around Mumbai show how quickly tension in a hospital can turn violent. For many healthcare workers, the threat is part of the job. Malathy Iyer examines why — and whether tougher laws can protect them

Illustration: Uday Deb

It was past midnight in the first week of Oct, when multiple police jeeps raced through north Mumbai's Ghatkopar — towards a nursing home, where a family had lost a young relative to dengue complications. The nursing home owner had called the police, not because an assault had taken place, but because he feared one might.

Recent incidents in Mumbai's far-flung suburbs of Dombivli and Palghar have shown how quickly grief and anger can turn into violence against doctors and hospital staff. He did not want to wait for it to happen at his hospital.

That fear captures a shift in Indian healthcare: violence is no longer an exception for doctors and hospital staff, but a routine occupational hazard.

Two days later, another patient with dengue shock syndrome died at a hospital a few kilometres away. Once again, police presence and constant communication helped defuse the situation. On Oct 6, a 59-year-old grandfather and eight of his friends slapped a paediatrician and ransacked the reception area of a hospital, barely 100km from Mumbai, after his seven-day-old granddaughter died. These three incidents unfolded within four days.

And they are not just a Mumbai or Maharashtra problem. From Tamil Nadu to Manipur, doctors face the same cycle of anger and assault.

National Insecurity

On Nov 13, 2024, senior oncologist Dr Balaji Jagannathan was stabbed seven times at Chennai's Kalaignar Centenary Super Speciality Hospital by the son of a woman he had treated. The woman had end-stage cancer, and had received six cycles of chemotherapy before the disease metastasised. Feeling "cheated", the son attacked Dr Jagannathan, who survived.

At the Regional Institute of Medical Sciences in Imphal, Manipur, young doctors found that 40% of assaults — verbal or physical — recorded in 2023 occurred between 6pm and midnight, when fewer doctors and staff were around. Another 23.6% occurred between 1pm and 6pm.

A review published last year in the indexed medical journal 'Atención Primaria' put the lifetime prevalence of violence among doctors in India at 77.3% — which means, nearly eight in 10 doctors reported violence at some point in their careers.

Not Just Physical Attacks

Violence against doctors is not an Indian problem, but a worldwide issue. A new 81-country survey presented at the recently concluded European Emergency Medicine Congress in Paris found that 75% of emergency-department workers had witnessed violence in the preceding year. Nearly 69% reported psychological, and 40.3% physical harm.

Mumbai paediatrician Dr Mangesh Pate recently compiled details of 100 attacks on doctors from across India. "I had an A4-size page that limited my entries, or we could have had 1,000 entries," he said.

The violence is not always physical. A doctor may be shouted at in an emergency department, threatened outside a ward, abused over a phone call or targeted on social media. "Go on social media, and every day there is at least one post berating a doctor or a hospital. Isn't this cyber assault on doctors?" Dr Pate asked.

Why Tensions Erupt

The consensus is that overcrowding, long waits, inadequate staffing, shortages of beds, medicines and equipment, financial stress and unrealistic expectations of what a doctor can deliver can all fuel tension.

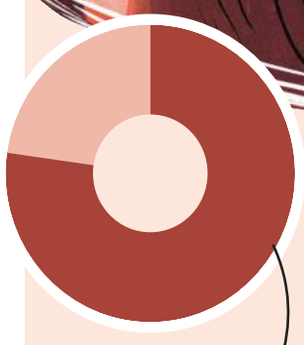
The problem is particularly acute in public hospitals, where the doctor communicating those limitations is often a young resident. "A resident doctor is usually the messenger of bad news in public hospitals, and bears the brunt of verbal or, at times, physical abuse," said a doctor completing his residency at a civic hospital in Mumbai.

Communication problems can deepen tensions.

"The doctor updates one set of relatives, but if the patient unfortunately dies, a completely different set of relatives may arrive, who know nothing about the patient's history. They then accuse the doctor of providing wrong treatment, or of keeping the patient in hospital for days to inflate the bill, even though the patient may have died much earlier," said Dr Deepak Baid of the Indian Medical Association (IMA).

Senior surgeon and health activist Dr Sanjay Nagral believes the deeper problem is access. "Hospitals are overcrowded. People bring their relative in a critical state, and come across some shortage — in terms of bed, equipment or manpower. The doctor in front of them then becomes the face of a seemingly uncaring system," he said.

But some doctors can be rude to patients or their relatives, a trigger in an emotionally fraught situation, Dr Nagral adds. "Also, there are doctors who make a big issue of minor things," he added.



Violence against doctors in India

77.3% doctors said they experienced workplace violence at some point

But most cases go unreported

23.5% was the reporting rate in one study

9.9% of formally reported cases resolved satisfactorily

Shiv Sena corporator Ramesh Mhatre (in white) assaults a doctor at Shastri Nagar Hospital in Mumbai's Dombivli in July, following a dispute

WHAT FUELS CONFLICT?

- Overcrowding, staff shortage
- Treatment delays
- Perceived wrong treatment
- Patient's death
- Communication failure
- Poor security
- Inadequate infrastructure
- Financial stress, distrust

Source: Dr Indranil Saha's 'Workplace violence against healthcare workers: a narrative review of evidence to inform policy and legislation in India', Critical Public Health, 2026

Courts Step In

Late last month, Supreme Court cancelled Mhatre's bail and directed that he be placed back in custody, giving Dr Baviskar's family some relief.

"Our hope is that no doctor is attacked in future and whoever commits such an act faces appropriate legal action and punishment," her father, Mahendra Baviskar, told **TOI**.

Supreme Court, while cancelling the bail, said the Dombivli incident could not be viewed in isolation, referring to reports from different parts of the country of elected representatives using "force, intimidation or other extra-legal means" against citizens or public functionaries. It also referred to the recent hospital incident in Palghar.

On Sept 5, a group led by politicians allegedly entered Relief Hospital in Palghar after injured govindas were brought there following Dahi Handi celebrations. Hospital authorities alleged that staff were assaulted, the ICU was broken into and the injured were forcibly taken away following a dispute over treatment and billing. Police arrested 23 people.

A Palghar court subsequently rejected the bail applications of six accused, including Shiv Sena leaders Rohit Gavit and Rahul Sankhe. They remain in judicial custody.

A Law Without Teeth

For doctors, the court action in Dombivli and Palghar has been significant. But Maharashtra's experience shows the gap between just having a law and enforcing it.

The Maharashtra Medicare Act was the first such state legislation in the country. Yet, of 636 attacks reported between 2016 and 2021, only 36 cases were decided and just four ended in convictions.

The poor record has strengthened the demand for a national law. In Aug, IMA, while considering a countrywide protest over the Dombivli attack, sought a central law to protect doctors and other healthcare workers from violence in hospitals, arguing that existing state-specific laws have failed to provide adequate protection or ensure convictions.

The IMA wants hospitals to be declared "safe zones", with mandatory security measures including controlled entry and CCTV, along with time-bound investigation and trial of attacks. It has also sought provisions covering damage to hospital property and cyber harassment.

What Legislation Can (And Cannot) Do

Legislation matters. But international experience suggests that deterrence alone cannot fix a problem in a strained healthcare system.

Spain, which is seeing a rising graph of assaults on doctors, amended its penal code to classify assaults against healthcare workers as crimes against public authority, bringing tougher penalties.

Turkey also found a fall in violence after introducing legal measures in 2022. A study of 132 'White Code' cases at a tertiary hospital found that violence in the ICU fell from 13.1% before the legislation to 1.4% afterwards — although incidents shifted towards emergency departments, outpatient clinics and wards.

The lesson is that stronger laws can deter some violence, but cannot, by themselves, eliminate the conditions that generate confrontation.

IMA, too, has stressed that alongside a central law, the major issues — such as overcrowding, staff shortage, inadequate infrastructure, unrealistic patient expectations and poor doctor-patient communication need to be tackled.

"Healthcare is the govt's responsibility," said Dr Pate. "Yet, in almost 80 years since Independence, have we been able to ensure primary healthcare across the country? Secondary and tertiary care will obviously be inadequate."

Inputs by Pradeep Gupta & Suhas Birhade

TIMES GLOBAL

THE TIMES OF INDIA, NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 21, 2026

YOU CAN DO ANYTHING WITH BAYONETS EXCEPT SIT ON THEM
— THOMAS HARDY

GEORGE CLOONEY'S INVESTIGATIVE ORGANISATION 'SENTRY' SUED FOR DEFAMATION OVER A $300M 'FALSE' FRAUD REPORT

GWYNETH PALTROW TO MAKE HER MAJOR TV DEBUT AS A VENGEFUL MOM IN NETFLIX'S TWO-SEASON 'THE APOLOGY'

France imposes fresh curfews ahead of new weekend protests

Massive Security Operation Planned, Says PM Lecornu

AFP

A man walks past a row of burnt out vehicles in Paris Tuesday

Paris: Fresh curfews were being imposed across the city centers of Paris and Lyon on Tuesday after the first quiet night since France's most destructive rioting in years, as Prime Minister Sébastien Lecornu said a "massive" security operation was planned for new protests Saturday.

Paris police said the curfew in two designated zones — around Place de la République and the Les Halles shopping district — had restored "public peace" overnight and would remain in place "for as long as necessary." The curfew zones leave out other areas hit on Saturday, including the Champs-Elysées and the area around the Saint-Lazare train station and parts of the Rue de Turbigo in central Paris, where protesters set up barricades and lit fires. In Lyon, one of France's largest cities, authorities also renewed a curfew in the city centre from 9pm to 6am saying no disturbances had been recorded overnight.

Marseille, France's second-largest city, imposed a curfew for unaccompanied minors starting Tuesday night. Lecornu said the targeted curfews "helped keep last night calm."

Student unions and groups from the " yellow vest " movement, whose protests over fuel prices shook France in 2018 and 2019, have called for another day of protests Saturday.

Soldiers from Sentinelle, the anti-terrorism operation that has patrolled French cities since the 2015 Islamic State group attacks, will take over guarding sensitive sites to free up more police officers and gendarmes for crowd control, interior minister Laurent Nuñez told lawmakers Tuesday. "The deployment (of police forces) for next Saturday will be massive," Lecornu told the national assembly, France's lower house of parliament, without giving figures.

Police on Tuesday arrested a suspect in the arson attack that charred the historic city hall in Limoges, in central France, Justice Minister Gérald Darmanin said, adding that the person was being held in police custody and may not have acted alone.

French media reported that the suspect was close to radical environmentalist movements and was on a watchlist of people considered potential threats to national security. Darmanin declined to comment on the suspect's profile, but said far-left groups appeared to have organized to attack symbols of the state throughout France. Footage of the 143-year-old building in flames, its bell tower collapsing, spread online over the weekend.

In Paris on Monday night, a police helicopter circled over Place de la République overnight, a central point in the weekend clashes, sweeping the square with a searchlight to check that the curfew was being respected. Early Tuesday morning, workers used a crane to remove a giant fluorescent yellow vest draped over the statue at the centre of the square, then used pressure washers to blast graffiti off the monument.

In Paris alone, about 300 people have been sent before prosecutors following the Oct. 17 protests, the city prosecutor's office said in a statement.

Darmanin said he had asked prosecutors to appeal any sentence they considered too lenient. "People with no criminal record ending up in prison for property crimes is extremely rare, if not unheard of," he said, arguing that the French justice system will be "extremely firm." AP

Police clash with protesters for an 8th day in Albania

Tirana: Police fired tear gas and used water cannons to push back protesters Tuesday on the eighth straight day of violent anti-govt demonstrations in the Albanian capital, Tirana, calling for the resignation of Socialist PM Edi Rama.

A wave of stones, an attempt to overthrow govt and change those in power through the imposition of violence — something that will never be allowed to happen, in any form or for any reason," Rama said after a meeting Tuesday with teachers and representatives of Tirana's schools. He argued that legitimate concerns were being hijacked by people deliberately causing violence during the protests. "This is a hybrid war that naturally works to the extent that it does because it is based on real concerns, not fantasies. Concerns about the cost of living are certainly real. Concerns about a secure future, housing, and greater opportunities to get ahead are also real," Rama said.

Portuguese police clear protest camps

Portuguese police cleared protest camps in Lisbon and Porto Tuesday, removing activists who had occupied two squares to protest against a worsening housing crisis, and making 55 arrests. AGENCIES

UK to fly missions to defend Saudi from Houthi attacks

British PM Andy Burnham has asked Royal Air Force to deploy Typhoon fighter jets to protect Saudi cities and infrastructure from aerial attacks by Iran-backed Houthi militants, Ministry of Defence said on Tuesday.

British jets will intercept Houthi drones and missiles but "will not conduct offensive strikes", a ministry statement said, confirming earlier Bloomberg reporting. Burnham's spokesman Tom Wells said aircraft would not be directed to strike Yemen and rejected suggestions Britain risked being drawn into wider conflict. UK defence secretary Wes Streeting said that Houthis targeting Riyadh airport showed an attempt to escalate regional tensions.

Deployment expands British support for Riyadh, previously limited to defensive air-to-air refuelling. UK will also provide an Atlas A400M heavy-lift transport aircraft to move equipment within Saudi Arabia, while British military advisers will assist Saudi counterparts on ground.

Move represents one of strongest demonstrations of support yet by a key Saudi ally as Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman seeks more assistance against Houthis. Saudi's requests to US President Trump have not secured direct military intervention, while a new defence pact with Turkiye and Pakistan has provided limited help.

France has sent radar systems to Red Sea port of Yanbu, and Egypt is expected to consider possible support. Gulf states have backed kingdom in statements but have not joined war.

Typhoons can shoot down large drones and most cruise missiles. Such patrols are more cost-effective than high-end air-defence missiles but offer little protection against faster ballistic missiles. BLOOMBERG

Hegseth meets Bibi days ahead of vote

US defence secretary Pete Hegseth discussed Iran and threats with Israeli PM Benjamin Netanyahu during an unannounced visit to Uvda air force base in southern Israel Monday, Israeli officials said. The visit comes ahead of elections in Israel which arescheduled on Oct 27. PM's spokesperson Doron Spielman said they discussed the US-Israel partnership, including offensive and defensive cooperation. The visit came amid US-Iran tensions over Hormuz and attacks by Iran-allied Houthis on Saudi Arabia. BLOOMBERG

Munir visits Iran to discuss mediation

Iran's President Masoud Pezeshkian discussed mediation efforts and regional developments during a meeting with Pakistan's army chief Field Marshal Asim Munir in Tehran, Iran's Nournews reported Tuesday. Munir also met Iranian parliament speaker Mohammed Baqer Qalibaf. The Iranian official said Washington can't earn Tehran's trust until it fulfils the seven conditions presented by Iran for reopening of the Strait of Hormuz last month, according to an Iranian readout of meeting. REUTERS

Zelensky meets Witkoff as US-Ukraine ties sink to new low

Oslo: Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky met US special envoy Steve Witkoff in Oslo Tuesday in a bid to repair relations strained by President Donald Trump's outreach to Moscow and Kyiv's complaints that Washington had withheld vital defences. Zelensky and Witkoff hugged before talks hosted by Norwegian PM Jonas Gahr Stoere and Finnish President Alexander Stubb. Trump's son-in-law Jared Kushner joined remotely. Zelensky had earlier met Stoere and Stubb, who have strongly backed Ukraine as European countries seek to prevent a deeper rupture between Washington and Kyiv.

The meeting came as Trump repeatedly rebuked Zelensky and called for his replacement. Stoere termed the meeting "constructive". On Monday, Trump said, "Russia, frankly, has been fine on Ukraine." He said Zelensky was "not helping matters much" and Kyiv should find "somebody else to negotiate".

Rubio acknowledged Tuesday that US air defence missiles bought by European countries for Ukraine might not have been delivered, but denied any policy change. "The important takeaway for you is that there has not been some deliberate political directive to go out and harm Ukraine," he said. Zelensky said Tuesday that Kyiv was again receiving early warnings from its partners following recent Russian missile attacks that he said occurred without notice. He also said that Kyiv should be represented in any meeting between leaders of US, Russia and China after reports that Donald Trump, Vladimir Putin and Xi Jinping could meet to discuss the war. AGENCIES

TOI LINE OF NO CONTROL — SANDEEP ADHWARYU

South Korea pulls embassy staff from Kyiv

South Korea has decided to withdraw some staff from its embassy in Ukraine in an escalating spat over Kyiv's disclosure it had transferred North Korean prisoners of war to the South. Seoul said it made the decision due to "the absence of any constructive steps by the Ukrainian side following the recall of South Korea's ambassador to Ukraine," foreign ministry spokesperson, Park Doo-soon, told a briefing Tuesday. "The difficulty of ensuring the personnel's safety amid the persistent threat of airstrikes across Ukraine," was also a factor, Park added. Seoul has demanded a public apology from Kyiv for allegedly violating an agreement they had made to keep confidential any transfer of North Korean prisoners of war to South Korea. Seoul will continue necessary diplomatic communication with Kyiv through its acting ambassador. BLOOMBERG

Aus lawmaker loses leg after being hit twice by vehicle

Sydney/Melbourne: Doctors have amputated the leg of an Australian lawmaker after a man rammed her with his car and then reversed to hit her a second time, media and officials said Tuesday, in an incident being investigated by anti-terrorism police. Helen Haines, an independent, underwent surgery overnight and remained in critical condition after Monday's attack in the small town of Wangaratta, north of Melbourne.

While the motive for the attack has yet to be revealed, PM Anthony Albanese linked it to a domestic climate of ugly, polarised political debate. "It's clear that there was a deliberate act here. This wasn't an accident, someone just skidding off the road," he told ABC News.

The 43-year-old alleged attacker was arrested at the scene. Police, who are investigating the incident, said in a statement they would allege the attack was targeted. REUTERS

Alberta separatists lose vote on leaving Canada

Calgary: Alberta residents voted overwhelmingly to remain part of Canada in the province's first referendum on separation, giving PM **Mark Carney** a boost as he seeks to unify the country amid a trade war with US.

With 1.8 million votes counted, 76% supported remaining in Canada and 24% backed beginning a separation process, unofficial Elections Alberta results showed. Monday's referendum was nonbinding. "Albertans made a clear choice," Carney said. "They chose unity, to build together, and to take care of each other."

Alberta Premier Danielle Smith, who announced the referendum in May, said she was "very pleased" that early results showed support for remaining.

Separatists argue Alberta's energy wealth subsidises poorer parts of Canada and that independence would free the province from Ottawa bureaucracy. Pollsters and analysts had ruled out a separatist victory, with data indicating only about one-third of residents supported a future referendum on leaving. Carney had warned that leaving would be "a dangerous bluff that will lead to years of division".

First Nations groups opposed independence, saying their treaties with Ottawa predated Alberta's creation. Separatists have said they would pursue another vote despite defeat. An Oct 16 Angus Reid poll found 62% of Albertans believed the movement would never end. Quebec previously held independence referendums in 1980 and 1995, both of which failed. Voters also considered nine non-binding proposals to strengthen Alberta's position in dealings with Ottawa, covering immigration and voter identification. Provisional results showed eight passed. AGENCIES

Tarique warns of unrest bid by '2 united parties'

Ahsan Tasnim

Dhaka: PM **Tarique Rahman** Tuesday alleged that the deposed authoritarian regime and another party that now operates inside Bangladesh have joined hands to create unrest in the country, apparently referring to banned Sheikh Hasina-led Awami League and main opposition party, hardline Jamaat-e-Islami, respectively.

"These two parties have united. One party is trying to create unrest by providing money from the other side of the border, while another party operating here is trying to create unrest," he said while addressing a public rally in Rajshahi.

PM said attempts were made to create labour unrest at some factories in different parts of the country, adding that intelligence reports indicated that the ousted authoritarian regime was supplying money for such activities. "There is a party also here that spreads rumours in the country. The party tried to sell various tickets to the people before the election by telling lies. These two parties have now united," he said.

Tarique urged people to remain alert to the attempts to destabilise the country so that none canobstruct the process of improving the lives of the country's people.

PM greets on Durga Puja

Rahman visited Rangpur, Rajshahi and Chittagong to exchange greetings with members of the Hindu community during Durga Puja. He reaffirmed his govt's commitment to building a democratic Bangladesh that embraces people from all walks of life.

2 men rearrested in UK on suspicion of aiding Iran over US-run air base plot

London: British police said Tuesday they have rearrested two men on suspicion of assisting Iran's intelligence service over a suspected plot at a US-run air base in England last month. Counter Terrorism Policing said the men, a 24-year-old British national and a 25-year-old dual UK-Iranian national, were arrested under the National Security Act.

One of the suspects was first arrested on Sept 27, while the second suspect was first arrested on Oct 1. Until Tuesday the men had been bailed.

Laurence Taylor, head of National Counter Terrorism Policing in UK, said detectives are looking at "many lines of enquiry involved in this hugely complex investigation." Iran has denied involvement, although it has previously said that it considers any base used to attack its territory a legitimate target. AP

2 British Indians assaulted during festival celebrations

Naomi Canton

London: Two British Indian Telugu Hindu men were assaulted during a Dussehra and Bathukamma celebration in the town of Ossett, West Yorkshire, last Saturday night in what police believe was a racially aggravated attack. The assaults happened on Oct 17 outside Ossett Town Hall, which was hosting the celebration. The event was organised by local Telugu Hindu community groups.

Earlier in the evening a group of around 25 local white youths, mostly male, were cycling around on e-bikes asking organisers what was going on in the town hall and who was inside. Some of them tried to force their way in, but security did not allow it.

One of the victims, a 51-year-old British Indian man from the Hyderabad region, left the event at around 9pm and walked to his car with a friend. As they did so, they encountered a group of eight to 10 youths, some in black balaclavas.

"One of them approached us and started asking us why we were here, what we were doing and looked aggressive," he told **TOI**. "He circled around us and used filthy language. We didn't respond. We didn't feel it was safe to go further and started to go back to town hall and then he hit both of us. He hit me hard and pushed me to the ground on my face and left me bleeding. I stood up and then he punched me in my left eye … My friend was left with a head injury and his hand was bleeding."

There have been no arrests yet. Inspector Andrew Dickinson said: "We recognise the distress this has caused to the wider Hindu community. We are treating these assaults seriously and are working to ensure those responsible are held accountable."

Desi Bela Bajaria leaves Netflix after giving global blockbusters

Chidanand Rajghatta | TNN

Washington: Bela Bajaria is leaving Netflix as chief content officer and will be replaced by former Disney and Fox executive Peter Rice, in a shake-up accompanied by layoffs affecting about 1,000 employees, or 6% of its workforce.

Netflix officially described her departure as a leadership change rather than a dismissal. It comes as the streaming company faces pressure to produce bigger hits and sustain viewer engagement, with investors examining returns from its annual content budget of nearly $20 billion.

Netflix boss Ted Sarandos, who had credited Bajaria with transforming its global content operation, has indicated that the company wants to improve its programming slate, particularly in the US and Canada. The Wall Street Journal reported that he had complained internally for months that Americans were spending less time watching Netflix and that the service lacked new hit shows.

Born in London in 1970 to Indian parents, Bajaria moved to the US as a child and worked in her family's car-wash business before joining CBS as an assistant in 1996. She later became president of Universal Television, the first Indian to head a major studio, overseeing productions including Brooklyn Nine-Nine, The Mindy Project and Unbreakable Kimmy Schmidt.

She joined Netflix in 2016, initially handling licensing, co-productions and unscripted programming. She became head of global television in 2020 and chief content officer in Jan 2023. Her tenure included global hits such as Squid Game, Bridgerton, Beef, Adolescence, Lupin, Cobra Kai, KPop Demon Hunters and Frankenstein, as well as Netflix's expansion into live events and sports.

She also promoted locally rooted stories and expanded Netflix's Indian-language slate. Indian Matchmaking drew worldwide attention, while Delhi Crime and Mismatched broadened its Indian offering. Her record also drew criticism over projects involving British royalty and from MAGA supporters who considered her programming too progressive.

Trump wants 'New America' for New Mexico, reviving debate on America's name

Chidanand Rajghatta | TNN

Washington: First, he renamed the Gulf of Mexico the Gulf of America, Then he wanted Lake Ontario to be called Lake America. Now he wants to rename New Mexico New America. At this rate, goes the joke, US President Trump may soon rename America itself – perhaps call it New India, since Christopher Columbus was looking for India when he got here.

"New Mexico should immediately change its name to New America. We are not Mexico, we are the United States of America!" Trump declared on Truth Social Monday. The new name, he promised, would add "great value and prestige" to the state, boost residents' pride in saluting the American flag and even ensure that "the Crooked Elections, that New Mexico is known for, would become honest again!"

New Mexico's political reps were unimpressed. Senator Ben Ray Lujan, a Democrat, reminded Trump that the state's name dates back centuries, long before US itself came into existence. "We are New Mexicans. We're proud of our name, proud of our home, and we're keeping both. Long after Donald Trump is out of office, we'll still be New Mexico," he shot back.

There is also a constitutional obstacle to the Trump threat: the state's constitution does the naming and a social media post cannot change that. Renaming it would require action through the state's constitutional and legislative processes, as well as Congress.

New Mexico's history stretches much further back than that of the country Trump wants to insert into its name. Spanish explorers entered the region in the 16th century, and Santa Fe, New Mexico's capital, was established in 1610, decades before the English settlement at Plymouth and more than 150 years before American independence in 1776. Indigenous peoples had inhabited the region long before the Spanish arrived.

The question of who named America is itself a reminder that geography and nomenclature have rarely followed a straightforward path. The name America was popularised by German cartographer Martin Waldseemuller, who used it on a world map in 1507 in honour of Italian explorer Amerigo Vespucci, whose accounts helped persuade Europeans that the lands across the Atlantic were a separate continent, rather than part of Asia.

Christopher Columbus, meanwhile, had sailed west seeking a route to India and he died in 1506 still believing he had reached India. Spain consequently referred to its American possessions as the West Indies, distinguishing them from the East Indies he had hoped to reach. Early European maps also used terms such as the New World and, in some cases, India Nova, or New India. In short, America was named after Vespucci, not Columbus, although Columbus's voyages helped set the European encounter in motion.

Indeed, cartographers note the continent was hardly nameless before Europeans arrived with their maps. Various indigenous tribes, notably the Lenape, Iroquois, and Anishinaabe, called America Turtle Island, referring to the creation story where the continent was built on the back of a giant turtle. Abya Yala, a term used by the Guna people of Panama, has gained wider currency among Indigenous activists as a name for the Americas. Many American states have indigenous names: Alabama, Connecticut, Massachusetts, Michigan, Minnesota, Mississippi, Missouri, Nebraska, Ohio, Oklahoma, Tennessee, Texas, Utah, Wisconsin and Wyoming among them.

There is also irony in the term "American-Indian" itself. Columbus's geographical mistake helped give rise to the label applied to Indigenous Americans – Indians, and pejoratively, "Red Indians." Clearly, Europeans' confusion about where they had arrived left a lasting – and deadly – imprint on the people they encountered. So if Trump really wants to correct history's naming errors perhaps, chuckled one wag, he could start at home and rename America as New India, in honour of Columbus's original destination.

DAILY PLANET

Australia set to sue Facebook, TikTok in child-safety push

Australia's govt is set to sue Facebook, TikTok and other major digital platforms for alleged non-compliance with a nationwide social media ban for under-16s, communications minister Anika Wells said in an interview. The country's online safety regulator, eSafety Commissioner, said in March it was investigating Facebook and Instagram — both owned by Meta Platforms Inc. — TikTok, Snapchat and YouTube for potentially failing to adhere to the law. The legislation requires the companies to take reasonable steps to stop underage users from holding social media accounts.

Altman's sister's sexual abuse lawsuit junked

Sam Altman Tuesday won the dismissal of a civil lawsuit filed by his sister accusing the OpenAI co-founder and chief executive of repeated sexual abuse more than two decades ago, an accusation he denies. In dismissing Annie Altman's lawsuit, US district judge Zachary Bluestone wrote that she had refused to appear for a medical examination despite warnings that failure to do so would result in the case's dismissal.

TIMES SPORT
THE TIMES OF INDIA, NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY, OCTOBER 21, 2026

EGYPT COACH HOSSAM HASSAN, FORWARD ZICO SUSPENDED FOR CRITICISING REF DURING WC

INJURED IGA SWIATEK RISKS MISSING WTA FINALS AFTER WITHDRAWING FROM NINGBO OPEN

IT'S RAINING GOLD FOR INDIA

Five Gold, Four Silver And Five Bronze Medals In A Day Of Records And Remarkable Comebacks For India's Para Track & Field Athletes In Aichi-Nagoya

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India's track and field athletes turned grit into glory on Tuesday, collecting five gold, four silver and five bronze medals at the Asian Para Games in Nagoya to take their athletics tally to 20. The 14-medal haul featured record-breaking performances, emotional comebacks and podium sweeps — proof that determination can outpace the toughest odds.

Nishad Kumar stood tallest, literally and figuratively. The Himachal Pradesh high jumper cleared 2.04m to win the men's T47 gold with a Games record, adding to the long jump title he claimed on Monday. He became only the third Indian to win two golds at a single Asian Para Games, joining runner Ankur Dhama and armless archer Sheetal Devi. T47 is for athletes with upper-limb impairments.

Deepthi Jeevanji launched India's gold rush by defending her women's 400m T20 crown in a Games-record 56.36 seconds. The 23-year-old from Telangana, who has an intellectual impairment, is also a world champion and Paralympic bronze medallist. Raised by small-farmer parents in a village in Warangal, she pursued running despite social taunts directed at her family for supporting her ambitions. A school physical education teacher first spotted her talent; later, coach N Ramesh and badminton coach Pullela Gopichand helped her journey gather pace.

Simran claimed her maiden Para Games gold in the women's 200m T12, clocking a record 24.80 seconds. The sprinter, who has moderate visual impairment, is rebuilding with guide Shivam after her previous guide Umar Saifi was banned for a doping violation. Debutant Tejalben Damor took bronze in 25.23 seconds, drawing confidence from the medal despite her family's financial struggles.

In the men's combined F51/52/53 discus, Pranav Soorma won gold with an Asian-record 11.66m, while fellow F51 athlete Ram Ratan Singh secured silver with 10.35m. The seated F51 classification involves significant movement limitations in the trunk, legs and hands. Placings in combined classes use the Raza points system, which enables fair comparisons between athletes with different levels of impairment.

Devender Kumar completed another Indian gold in the men's F44/64 discus, throwing 49.71m. Rakesh won silver and Pardeep Kumar bronze, giving India all three medals. F44 athletes compete without a prosthesis, while F64 athletes use one.

India's other silver came through Preeti Pal in the women's 200m T35 and Pradeep Kumar in the men's javelin F53/54, where his personal-best 27.45m earned second place. Ayush Verma added bronze in the same event.

Bronze medals also went to Praveen Sharma in the men's shot put F11 and Hokato Hotozhe Sema in the men's shot put F56/57 events.

Nishad Kumar | Men's High Jump T47 | Gold

Pix: PCI

Simran | Women's 200m T12 | Gold
Tejalben Damor | Women's 200m T12 | Bronze

Deepthi Jeevanji | Women's 400m T20 | Gold

Devender Kumar | Men's Discus F43/F44/F62/F64 | Gold

Pranav Soorma | Men's Discus F51/52/53 | Gold

Manish Narwal's fight beyond the firing line

Silver lining with 10m air pistol SH1 after bout with depression while Shrishti soars in fifth-to-podium flight

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For Manish Narwal, every medal carries the weight of a battle fought long before he takes aim. Born with nerve damage that limits movement in his right hand and shoulder, the Ballabhgarh shooter had to abandon his childhood dream of becoming a footballer when his disability restricted him to the field game at the local level. His father, Dilbagh Singh, then introduced him to shooting, opening a new chapter in a sporting journey that has since brought Paralympic gold and silver.

The left-handed shooter's path, however, has not been without heartbreak. A disappointing seventh-place finish in his favourite 10m air pistol event at the Tokyo Paralympics, followed by the deaths of his elder brother and grandfather, pushed him into depression and left him contemplating quitting the sport.

On Tuesday, the Haryana shooter won the silver in the men's 10m air pistol SH1 final at the Asian Para Games in Nagoya with 233.7 points. South Korea's Jo Jeongdu took gold with a Games-record 241.3. The medal also secured Narwal a quota place for the 2028 Los Angeles Paralympics.

If Narwal's story is one of fighting back from adversity, Shrishti Arora's continental debut was a lesson in refusing to surrender. Born without the palm of her right hand, the Ajmer shooter has risen rapidly through the para-shooting ranks since competing in her first National Championship in 2023.

MANISH

The 30-year-old from Rajasthan announced her arrival on the Asian stage with bronze in the women's 10m air pistol SH1 final, shooting 214.7. What made the achievement particularly striking was her transformation from a fifth-place qualifier position into a podium finisher. With composure under pressure, Shrishti turned a challenging starting position into a medal-winning finish, showcasing the determination that has marked her rapid rise. Another Indian, Sumedha Pathak, finished eighth.

Together, Narwal and Shrishti added two medals to India's growing shooting haul here. Their achievements followed Monday's air rifle SH1 double, Mona Agarwal Avani Lekhara took gold and silver respectively.

India's sportspersons shine across disciplines

TIMES NEWS NETWORK

India's medal charge gathered momentum beyond the track and shooting range on Tuesday, with history-making table tennis performances, a powerlifting silver, twin swimming bronze and a strong badminton show adding depth to the country's campaign at the Asian Para Games in Nagoya.

India ended the second day sixth in the standings with 35 medals — nine gold, 11 silver and 15 bronze. Para athletics supplied the day's biggest gold rush, while shooting also brought success; other disciplines kept the haul growing.

In badminton, World champion Pramod Bhagat and Paralympic gold medallist Kumar Nitesh both secured places in the men's singles SL3 semifinals, guaranteeing the nation a medal in the event. Bhagat, chasing a fifth consecutive Para Asiad podium, beat Japan's Daisuke Fujihara 21-12, 21-10 and will meet Korea's Lee Seunghu. Nitesh swept past compatriot Vikram Kumar 21-8, 21-8 and faces Indonesia's Al Muh Imran in the last four.

Para archery delivered a boost, with defending champion Sheetal Devi and debutant Swati Chaudhary reaching their finals. Sheetal, who matched the world record and achieved an Asian record in qualifying, defeated Japan's Shinohara Aya 145-137 to set a gold-medal contest against Singapore's Alim Nur Syahidah. Swati beat South Korea's Eunhee Lee 6-2 and will face China's Mengkan. India's women's compound and recurve doubles pairs also advanced to gold medal matches.

At the table tennis arena, India collected five bronze medals, improving on the two won at Hangzhou 2022. Ravi Baby Sahana and Prachi Pandey made history as the country's first Asian Para Games medallists in the standing category. Bhavina Patel and Sonalben Patel added bronze, as did Jehan Madan in men's Class 1.

Ashok Kumar Malik lifted 192kg to win silver in men's 65kg powerlifting, upgrading his bronze from the previous edition. Swimmers Himanshu Nandal and Niranjan Mukundan claimed bronze in the men's 400m freestyle S11 and 200m individual medley SM7, respectively.

MEDALS TALLY

	Country	G	S	B	T
1	CHN	70	44	35	149
2	UZB	17	21	18	56
3	JPN	16	20	27	63
4	KOR	12	9	13	34
5	IRI	10	12	16	38
6	IND	9	11	15	35

Visually-impaired gold winner Soumya has eye on LA Games

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Bengaluru: Teenager Soumya can't properly see the glittering gold on the medal that she's won at the Asian Para Games in Aichi-Nagoya. But her grit and hard work helped India shine on the international stage as she won the 1500m race in the T12 category on Monday.

The youngster, who hails from Chamarajanagara, three hours south of Bengaluru, can see only up to 30-40m but with the help of guide runner Bharat, she scorched the track to take the top spot clocking a personal best time of 5:12.39s. She pipped teammate Radha Venkatesh who won silver, to give India a 1-2 finish.

Soumya did not have the best of facilities till Olympic Gold Quest came forward to support her last month. "She worked hard to win the gold and she did it with a PB time.

Her previous best was 5:14," Vikram G, Soumya's coach at the Indian Athletic Academy (IAA) in Bengaluru's Jaya Nagar told **TOI**.

"I've been dreaming about winning this gold medal for the last two years. I'm really happy to win it. Vikram sir's support helped me win. Thanks to the support and motivation from Vikram sir, I could win," the continental champion said.

SOUMYA

Vikram, a former athlete, said he began training Soumya after spotting her at the Deepa Academy for the Differently Abled in Bengaluru. "She lost her parents at a young age. When I met her at the Deepa academy, I urged her to do well in sports, as it would help her finding direction in life. That's how she joined IAA and from then on, we took care of her boarding and lodging."

"She is only 18 and in another two years, she can come down to a 4:30 level which could win her a medal at the Los Angeles Paralympics," Vikram added.

Harman back at her best, India sweep series

BCCI

91 Harmanpreet Kaur's knock is the second highest by India's No. 4 or lower order batter in Women's T20Is behind the 103 by Harmanpreet herself vs NZ Women in T20 World Cup in Providence on November 9, 2018.
—**Stats:** Rajesh Kumar

Opener Shafali Makes Entertaining 37-Ball-69 As Hosts Win Third And Final T20I Vs Zimbabwe By 92 Runs

Raipur: Former captain Harmanpreet Kaur struggled to keep her emotions in check after a sizzling 91 not out off 41 balls, setting up India's commanding 92-run win over Zimbabwe in the third and final T20I here on Tuesday.

Shafali Verma made an entertaining 69 off 37 balls before Harmanpreet returned to her destructive best to power India 216 for seven. On expected lines, Zimbabwe could not get anywhere near the massive target and ended at 124 for seven in 20 overs, with India taking the series 3-0.

The two teams will now head to Vadodara for a 3-match ODI series starting on Oct 23.

The game marked the return to form for Harmanpreet, who was struggling for runs of late and stepped down as captain ahead of the Zimbabwe series.

When in full swing, Harmanpreet enables India to maintain a high-scoring tempo in the middle overs. And that is what happened on Tuesday as she went hammer and tongs following Shafali's fireworks at the top of the order.

Even though it came against a lower-ranked team, the knock would provide Harmanpreet much-needed confidence ahead of the important assignments, including the inaugural six-team ICC Women's Champions Trophy in the shortest format at home early next year.

Not many strike the ball as well as Harmanpreet does and that is what she exhibited in her statement innings.

Captain Smriti Mandhana opted to bat with an aim to give more batters time in the middle. For that very purpose, she made way for Anushka Sharma (28 off 20) to open the batting alongside Shafali, who scored a second consecutive half-century to lead India's charge.

Harmanpreet had not found her groove on the slow pitches of the Women's T20 Asia Cup and did not get a lot of batting time in the team's triumphant Asian Games campaign.

"Feels great that I got some time in the middle. Just wanted to enjoy myself and bat as long as possible," said Harmanpreet before breaking down in the middle of the interview during the innings break.

Brief scores: India Women's 216/7 (Shafali 69, Harmanpreet 91*; Beloved Biza 3/50) beat Zimbabwe 124/7 (Sharne 60; Nandani 3/18) by 92 runs. PTI

Gritty Himachal delay Mumbai's charge

PTI

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RANJI TROPHY

After capitulating inside 40 overs in their first innings for 140 against Mumbai on Day One, Himachal's batters finally discovered some grit and gumption on Day Three of their Elite Group D Ranji Trophy match against Mumbai in Bilaspur, Himachal Pradesh.

Opener Innesh Mahajan (37, 91b, 5x4), skipper Pukhraj Mann (34*, 94b, 5x4) and 'keeper-bat Vaibhav Kalta (14*, 70b, 3x4) all did well to stonewall Mumbai, delay the visitors' charge towards an innings win. At stumps, Himachal were 144/3 in 56 overs, still trailing by 244 runs.

Earlier, Mumbai 'keeper-bat Akash Anand slammed his a century (117*, 239b, 14x4), while Sarfaraz Khan made 154 (228b, 19x4) as Mumbai declared at 528/8

.

Sai Kishore hat-trick helps TN beat Uttarakhand by innings

At Chepauk, Tamil Nadu captain and left-arm spinner Sai Kishore took a hat-trick as his team crushed Uttarakhand by an innings and 66 runs inside three days. In the 43rd over, Sai Kishore castled Lakshya Raichandani on the fourth ball, had Saurabh Rawat caught in the slips off the fifth, and then had Aditya Rawat caught behind as TN shot out Uttarakhand for 113.

Vidarbha beat J&K by three wickets in thriller

In Srinagar, Vidarbha overcame Jammu & Kashmir by three wickets in a low-scoring thriller. Set a target of 79 to win in the final innings, Vidarbha collapsed to 26/6 and then 55 /7 before Harsh Dubey (22*) and Nachiket Bhute (13*) took them home.

Hingrajia ton defies Delhi

A brave ton by middle-order batter Manan Hingrajia (108*, 274b, 12x4, 1x6), a half-century by Joymeet Patel (72, 119b, 9x4) and a useful contribution by skipper Chintan Gaja (41*, 105b, 3x4) helped Gujarat, who resumed at 98/2, reply strongly to Delhi's 648 /6. At stumps on Day 3, Gujarat were 363/5, still trailing by 285 runs. Hingrajia added 124 in 285 balls for the fifth wicket with Joymeet, and then put on 86 in 178 balls in an unbeaten partnership for the sixth wicket with Gaja to leave Delhi's bowlers frustrated.

J&K players celebrate a Vidarbha wicket. The team, however, lost the match

BRIEF SCORES: ROUND 2, DAY 3

GROUP A: In Vadodara: Bihar 166 & 251 (M Mahrour 138, B Bhatt 6/53, M Pithiya 3/40) lost to Baroda 416 & 4/0. Pts Baroda 7, Bihar 0. **In Puducherry:** Puducherry 177 & 198/1 vs MP 302/5 (R Patidar 122, C Rathore 78; S Trivedi 4/44); **In Srinagar:** J & K 260 & 123 (N Bhute 5/48) lost to Vidarbha 305 & 81/7 (S Kumar 4/30). Pts Vidarbha 6, J & K 0; **In Kanpur:** UP 202 & 197 (A Juyal 74, Y Kasvankar 5/69) beat Goa 164 & 167 (S Prabhudessai 72, K Tyagi 5/37). Pts UP 6, Goa 0

GROUP B: In Mullanpur: Punjab 456 vs Chhattisgarh 206 (A Khare 91, H Brar 7/56) & 123/3 (A Pandey 59*); **In Alur:** Karnataka 342 & 99/2 vs Saurashtra 349 (S Gajjar 79, H Desai 77; V Kaverappa 4/57); **In Guwahati:** Assam 334 beat Tripura 62 & 307 (M Murasingh 161, S Sarkar 59, M Thakur 5/101). Pts Assam 6, Tripura 0; **In Vijayawada:** Hyderabad 275 & 306/7 decl (K Himateja 123, T Thyagarajan 53*; K Saiteja 4/40) vs Andhra 184 (S Rasheed 61, T Thyagarajan 5/63)

GROUP C: In New Delhi: Bengal 184 & 146 beat Services 122 & 148 (P Pramanik 4/48, S Ahmed 3/44) Pts Bengal 6, Services 0; **In New Delhi:** Delhi 648/6 decl vs Gujarat 363/5 (M Hingrajia 108*, J Patel 72; H Shokeen 3/94); **In Pune:** Jharkhand 169 & 130/1 (S Mohan 74) vs Maharashtra 527/5 decl (A Bawne 169*, D Patil 148, R Gaikwad 101*) **In T'puram:** Kerala 404 vs Odisha 225 (G Choudhary 50, V Chandran 4/40, A Sarvate 3/56) & 102/4 (G Choudhary 53)

GROUP D: In Bilaspur: Himachal 140 & 144/3 vs Mumbai 528/8 decl (M Khan 57, S Khan 154, A Anand 117; J Rana 4/108); **In Chennai:** TN 313 beat Uttarakhand 134 & 113 (R Sai Kishore 6/34, A Ram 4/33). Pts Tamil Nadu 7, Uttarakhand 0; **In Jaipur:** Rajasthan 497 vs 305/6 (B Merai 73, E Goyal 64, R Singh 53)

Gavaskar's prescription for NZ: Play late to counter swing

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Mumbai: Sunil Gavaskar has advised India's batters to play the ball as late as possible when they face New Zealand in the two-Test series in Wellington and Christchurch, where swing and seam are expected to pose a major challenge.

India struggled on their last Test tour of New Zealand in Feb-March 2020, losing 0-2 after managing totals of 165, 191, 242 and 124. With green pitches likely again, Gavaskar said patience and technique would be vital. "Like in England, you try and play as late as possible. Don't commit yourself too much, because that gives you the chance to cover the movement off the pitch," Gavaskar said.

"When there is movement in the air, you can see it and react. But after pitching, the movement happens very close to the bat. The later you play, the better your chances of scoring runs and defending the good ball. Don't push at the ball. Defend with soft hands, not hard hands."

GAVASKAR

The batting great also questioned the decision to schedule only two Tests, saying every series in the next World Test Championship cycle should have at least three matches.

"Ideally, there should be a minimum of three Tests. Two Tests don't always give you a result. One team could win one match and the other team the next. A third Test gives you a better opportunity to win a series," he said.

He believes India will benefit from having spent an extended period in New Zealand before the Tests, with the team already playing five T20Is and five ODIs on the tour.

"One of the biggest problems in New Zealand is getting your body clock used to the time difference. It takes a really long time for your sleep and waking hours to adjust. The Indian team being there already is going to be a big plus," Gavaskar said.

He warned that early-summer conditions could make batting difficult but said runs would be available once batters settled in.

"There will be a fair bit of grass, cooler weather and the possibility of rain. The ball will move in the air and after pitching, so it won't be easy. But once you settle down, these can be some of the best pitches to bat on. I'm hoping our batters get going," he said.

Gavaskar also backed India's pace attack to challenge New Zealand. "With Jasprit Bumrah leading the attack and Mohammed Siraj around, we have the capability of surprising the New Zealand batting unit. We've got a good team. As with everything, you need a little bit of luck," he said.

(Tune-In: Watch India tour of New Zealand live and exclusive on Sony Sports Network and Sony LIV starting Oct 22, 2026)

SA IN COMMAND IN 2ND TEST AFTER SKIPPER BAVUMA'S MASTERCLASS

Temba Bavuma hit a career-best 179 and Kagiso Rabada took an early wicket as South Africa dominated the third day of the second Test against Australia at St George's Park on Tuesday. South Africa declared their first innings on 425 for nine.

Australia were three for one at the close after Rabada had Nic Maddinson caught at third slip for a duck with the fourth ball of the Australian innings.

Bavuma shared century partnerships with Marco Jansen (85) and Simon Harmer (82) as they posted a total which seemed improbable after they were 97 for five overnight. It was Bavuma's third day at the crease after battling through bowler-friendly conditions on the first two rain-shortened days.

He batted for more than nine hours, faced 334 balls and hit 18 fours and a six.

Brief scores: South Africa 425/9 dec (Bavuma 179, Jansen 85; Harmer 82, Boland 5-81, Starc 3-89) vs Australia 3/1. REUTERS

GALLERY

Minhas stars as Pak crush Eng

Rawalpindi: Allrounder Arafat Minhas struck a maiden half-century and grabbed a career-best six wickets to anchor Pakistan's convincing 87-run win over England in the tri-series in Rawalpindi on Tuesday.
Brief scores: Pak 302/9 (H Nawaz 79, A Minhas 59, S Baker 3-65) **beat Eng 215 in 38.4 overs** (T Banton 57, A Minhas 6-40) by 87 runs.

Aussie Treloar to officiate two Ranji matches: Australian umpire Ben Treloar will officiate in two Ranji Trophy matches, while India's Parashar Joshi will travel Down Under to stand in two Sheffield Shield matches and one One Day Cup fixture as part of an exchange programme.

Asmita, Tanvi Sharma in pre-quarters: Asmita Chaliha and Tanvi Sharma won their respective women's singles contests but the women's doubles pair of Treesa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand lost in the round of 32 of the French Open badminton tournament.

Aman in quarterfinals of World U-19 boxing: India's Aman Dev produced another clinical show to defeat Pavle Popovic of Serbia to qualify for the quarterfinals of the men's 50kg category in the World Boxing U-19 Championships.

Siddikur Rahman leads: Bangladesh's Siddikur Rahman fired a three-under 69 to emerge as the first-round leader in the final stage of the PGTI Qualifying School in Ahmedabad. Four golfers were tied for second place. AGENCIES

ACTION TODAY

CRICKET: Ranji Trophy 4th day: Pun vs C'ttisgarh, Kar vs Sau, Ker vs Odisha 9:30 am (JioStar); SA vs Aus, 2nd Test, 4th day 1:30 pm (Fancode); ODI tri-series: Afg vs Ban 5.00 pm (Sony);
FOOTBALL: CL: 10.15 pm & 12.30 am Wednesday (Sony); TENNIS: ATP Almaty, Lyon & Brussels all 3.30 pm (Fancode)

Diksha eyes one final stand

Looks To Finish Well At DLF G&CC As Injury Cuts Short Her Season

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Getty Images

AIMING FOR THE RIGHT SWING: Diksha Dagar

Gurugram: Diksha Dagar was quietly watching her heroes swinging in the rain at the DGC driving range last week. Her favourite Justin Rose was at it, as well as Tommy Fleetwood and Shane Lowry. What caught her eye was smooth operator Rory McIlroy, whom she had met at the Paris Olympics on the putting greens of Le Golf National. She was amazed. "Rory has got a soft finish. On TV, he looks aggressive. He swings hard, but it's not like that in reality. His swing is so smooth, yet so powerful," Diksha said, her eyes lit up as she relived the moment.

Almost a fortnight earlier, she was also in the spotlight, on the Asian Games podium, with a team silver medal around her neck. Individually, she felt she could have done better.

Little did others know she had been struggling with a knee injury for almost five months. This persistent problem will ensure that the $500,000 Hero Women's Indian Open will be the final episode of her current season. "I was not able to swing to my potential, with the weight transfer and twisting body position. I didn't want to give up because it was my dream. I had this belief that I would recover after the first round. Sometimes prayers can be powerful."

The mind too, as she tries to get into the 'blinkers' mode at DLF. The daily grind doesn't seem to bother her, despite the painful reminders.

"Golf is an addiction. Even if your day is not going well, there is hope that if you give it a go, it can change quickly. So, the motivation is always there. I wonder what I would be doing if I didn't play this game."

The two-time winner on the LET knows the Majors and the Olympics are never a step too far. "When I was playing in Paris, I realised it is not tough to win if you don't look at the other players. At the Women's Open, the top athletes were there. First day, I played two-under, and I was tied-eighth. The winning score was five-under. If I had continued in the same vein, I could have been easily in the top-10."

At its core, it can be a simple game. "Just play to your strengths, and I'm very good at the short game."

But it can be complicated too. "I thrive in windy conditions, and on the second day there was no wind, Made a 74, missed the cut. In the Scottish Open where I finished top-20, the wind was very strong so it was different."

Her dreams packed for next year's journey, there is no wind to chase on the intimidating grounds that Gary Player created. The No. 18 on the LET Order of Merit, who missed cuts in her last three Tour events, headed straight to the putting greens. No trip to the range, she's skipping the hard yards till Thursday's opening round.

Diksha desperately needs a break, a lucky one will do too.

Tsitsipas' journey of letting go of a coach to rediscover a dad

Greek Star Cuts Ties With His Father-Coach, Says It Has Helped Him Regain His Bite

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Getty Images

Tsitsipas

Almaty: Stefanos Tsitsipas folded his 6ft 4in frame into a sofa in a busy corridor at the Almaty Open. The 28-year-old, once ranked as high as No. 3 in the world and now at No. 39, acknowledged that his road back began with letting go. Letting go of the pressure, the tension and the expectations that have weighed on him. And, most importantly, allowing his father to be a father again, rather than having to be a coach as well.

Tsitsipas, who finished in the top-10 for five consecutive years, from 2019 to 2023, believes he is playing better tennis now than he was a few years ago, when he reached two Grand Slam finals, at Roland Garros in 2021 and the Australian Open in 2023.

The dip in form began with his body, a back problem that had been troubling him for some time, compounded by a strained coaching relationship with his father, Apostolos. The combination took its toll on his confidence, and by June his ranking had plummeted to No. 88. Just before Wimbledon, Tsitsipas told Greek media that he was ending his professional relationship with his father for good.

"I love my father, and I love him as a father," he said in Almaty. "I want to keep the professional part out of my relationship with my father. My relationship with him has improved now that he's not my coach. It was very difficult for me to separate the coach and the father. I had reached a point where I could not avoid being triggered." That separation appears to have given Tsitsipas something he had been missing, room to breathe. The weight of expectation and the tension of a relationship complicated by professional demands had produced disturbing scenes at tennis tournaments around the world, a father in his fifties hurling instructions at his son, sometimes leading to heated exchanges between the two.

"Eliminating the pressure factor does help," he said.

"Before, I felt pressured a lot of the time. There were a lot of things piled up within me, and certain people triggered me in a negative way. Removing some of those triggers, and having people around me who keep me calm and help me be more forgiving (on myself) when things don't work out, allows me to experiment more." For Tsitsipas, that freedom is essential for growth. "When you feel judged, you tend to go for the safe options. You need a team that isn't going to judge you for what you do, but will analyse it and support you, because it's all part of the process."

Bayern face Arsenal examination

German Club Will Miss In-Form Olise In CL Clash

Getty Images

RETURN IN STYLE: Maddison scored for Tottenham on his return after a 17-month injury lay-off

FOOTBALL WRAP

Champions League hopefuls Bayern Munich are set for an early test of their title credentials when they host English champions Arsenal on Wednesday without in-form winger Michael Olise. The London-born Olise, who started in Arsenal's junior system, is suspended after picking up two yellow cards inside a minute in Bayern's 3-3 draw with Viking last week. After seeing a first yellow for a foul, a clearly frustrated Olise responded to some verbal provocation from Viking captain Zlatko Tripic by throwing the ball at his head to be sent off for the first time in his career.

After being thrust into Ballon d'Or contention due to last season's stellar showing, the former Crystal Palace winger has continued his excellent form this campaign. Olise has nine goals and five assists from 10 games in all competitions for Bayern.

With Jamal Musiala struggling with injury and illness and both Serge Gnabry and Lennart Karl well off their best form, Olise and the ever-reliable Harry Kane have shouldered Bayern's attacking burden so far this season.

Mourinho warns no 'untouchable' stars at Real

Real Madrid coach Jose Mourinho on Tuesday warned Brazilian winger Vinicius Junior and the team's other stars that no one is "untouchable". Vinicius has struggled for form this season and is serving a four-match ban in La Liga for hair-pulling, but is available as Madrid host RB Leipzig in the Champions League on Wednesday. "Only the club badge is untouchable," Mourinho told reporters when asked if Vinicius's place in the team was in danger given Diomande's form.

"I don't like the concept of untouchable players. What makes a player untouchable is not his status, the armband, his years at the club, how much was paid for him, what makes him untouchable is his performance on the pitch."

Maddison sparkles as Spurs end winless run in PL

James Maddison made a sensational return to Tottenham's starting line-up on Monday as Roberto De Zerbi's men beat Coventry 3-1 to claim their first Premier League win of the season. Maddison marked his first start in 17 months with a spectacular early goal.

Jack Rudoni levelled early in the second half but the home side were back in front just before the hour mark when Omar Marmoush lashed home his first goal for the club and substitute Ben Davies made the points safe in added time. AGENCIES

EFI admn slaps defamation notice on rider Chheda

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New Delhi: In a bizarre turn of events, Lt Col Sandeep Dewan, member (administration) of the ad-hoc committee governing the Equestrian Federation of India (EFI), has served a defamation notice on Hangzhou Asian Games gold medallist Hriday Chheda, demanding Rs 25 lakh in damages and an unconditional apology over allegations concerning the handling of the Indian dressage team ahead and during the recently-concluded Aichi-Nagoya Games.

After being served the notice, Chheda expressed anguish over the way he had been treated and wrote an email to IOA president PT Usha. "The irony is appalling: an athlete who faced harassment and attempt to prevent his participation, is now facing legal threats from the very person whose conduct he questioned," Chheda wrote.

The development raises questions over the priorities of an administrator appointed to restore order in the federation. Instead of addressing an athlete's grievances, the administrator is now seeking damages from one of India's leading riders for raising concerns about his conduct.

Khushi makes her mark with 3 titles

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New Delhi: There was a time when losing a tennis match left **Khushi Kadian** in tears and questioning her future in the sport. At 13, the Rohtak girl is learning to turn setbacks into stepping stones. Her stunning triple crown at the Fenesta Open National tennis meet earlier this week offered the latest evidence of that transformation.

"There were so many times when I wanted to give up tennis. But I told myself that I had worked so hard and had to do something," she told **TOI**.

Across a gruelling week, Khushi won 15 consecutive matches to sweep the girls' under-14 singles, under-16 singles and under-16 doubles titles, partnering Sanmitha Harini.

The triumph was especially significant after a disappointing outing in Thailand, where she lost to China's Li Xiaoke in the quarterfinals of the girls' singles at the GSPDP Asian 14U Junior Championships. "I really wanted to win the Nationals this time, and I am happy about it," she said, crediting her parents and coaches for their unwavering support.

A fan of Elena Rybakina, she hopes to progress to junior Grand Slams before pursuing her bigger ambition. "I really want to do well at the Australian Open at one point of my career," she said. "You just have to be patient, work hard and give your best, whether you win or lose."

Once prone to tears after early-round defeats, Khushi now speaks of staying present, breathing between points and playing one point at a time.

TENNIS NATLS

Police lens on Lawrence aide Randeep Malik in Tiger case

Lawrence And Anmol May Be Quizzed In Jail

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Maharashtra minister Ashish Shelar meets actor Tiger Shroff Tuesday

New Delhi: Security agencies probing the attack on actor Tiger Shroff are investigating the role of Lawrence Bishnoi's top-tier US-based operative Randeep Malik, notwithstanding gangster Anil Pandit claiming responsibility for it on social media. Malik is considered very close to both Lawrence and his brother Anmol, who are also likely to be questioned in their respective jails in Gujarat and Delhi soon, sources have said.

Pandit and Shroff's shooter Rehan both reported to Malik and were considered "his men" till a few months ago, a source said. Rehan had been earlier tasked by Malik and Pandit with a shooting incident in Sonipat as well.

"Rehan was shown the same 'American dream' that Malik had shown Pandit in the past," a source said. As Pandit had been sent to California through the "Dunkey" route months after the Siddhu Moose Wala murder, he was cited as a success story to young recruits.

Pandit used to handle "Dabba calls" for Malik till last year. In underworld parlance, "Dabba calls" refer to Voice over IP (VoIP) calls routed through speakers using multiple connected phones at different locations so that the real caller's identity and physical location remain concealed.

Once settled, Pandit began managing secret communication set-ups for Malik, who personally trained Pandit.

Till a few months ago, screenshots used to appear in both their names. "However, Pandit was given an independent role in the gang recently and attached with the faction groomed by Anmol Bishnoi. Malik was placed in the senior tier which deals with planning and target selection," said another source.

This is perhaps why the screenshot in Tiger Shroff case bore the names of Malik and Anmol — the latter is currently lodged in Tihar jail.

Two women among four held in Delhi

New Delhi: Delhi Police Special Cell has arrested four people, including two women, in connection with the firing on Tiger Shroff. This could be probably the first time that involvement of women in Lawrence gang has come to light.

The accused have been identified as Kunal (21) and Sumit (19), both residents of Sonipat district in Haryana, and Radha (23) and Babita (23), who hail from UP. They were caught on Oct 20 as part of an operation to dismantle the alleged weapon supply module linked to the incident. The four accused were produced before the court by the special cell.

Maharashtra Police's CID moved an application seeking permission for custodial interrogation and formal arrest. The court allowed the application, following which the four accused were formally arrested by Mumbai police team. TNN

On return from Paris, Mann detained at Delhi airport for 3 hrs, fined ₹50,000, claims AAP

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Chandigarh: Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) has claimed that Punjab chief minister **Bhagwant Mann** was detained for three hours at Delhi airport late on Oct 19 and challaned Rs 50,000 on his return from a food trade fair in Paris.

AAP state media in-charge Baltej Pannu said the incident reflects the BJP-led Centre's deliberate attempt to "humiliate" Mann and "undermine Punjab's dignity".

Pannu alleged, "When the CM returned from Paris and arrived at Delhi airport, he was deliberately detained. Excuses were made that his luggage was 'still arriving' or was 'still being checked'. These were outright lies. After three hours, when Mann-ji was allowed to leave and was about to depart after placing his luggage in the vehicle, officials came running after him and said that they were under 'tremendous pressure from above'. Then they issued an absurd challan of Rs 50,000. This is a direct attack on Punjab's identity and dignity."

Pannu did not specify why the fine was imposed but alleged that the entire episode was "carried out under orders from above".

This controversy is a continuation of the AAP govt-vs-Centre tussle over Mann's France visit. After Centre denied political clearance to Mann for the Paris trip, the Punjab govt moved the Punjab & Haryana high court, which set aside Centre's decision, observing that it "had not explained what that political angle/viewpoint is".

Pannu said that while approving Mann's France visit, the HC had directed that the Punjab CM be accorded due protocol, but such was the "ill intent" of Centre that even the consul general in Paris did not come to meet him.

"Has any chief minister ever been detained at an airport for three hours in this manner? Has any chief minister ever been disrespected by being issued a challan of Rs 50,000?.." Pannu said.

He added that there had been four instances when Centre denied political clearances to Mann to travel abroad. "The Modi govt fears that if the CM travels abroad, he will bring investment and funds from there and put Punjab on the path of progress," he said.

SAD general secretary Bikram Singh Majithia posted on X: "According to sources, they (Mann and his wife) were questioned for hours over allegedly carrying more luggage or money than permitted..."

Why AI Can't Replace A Guru

GURUDEVSHRI RAKESHJI, founder of Shrimad Rajchandra Mission Dharampur, recently celebrated his 60th birthday. In a conversation with **HEMALI CHHAPIA**, Gurudevshri explains that AI can interpret scripture and mimic empathy, but the inward journey requires guidance from an enlightened master

■ We increasingly live in a world where artificial intelligence can answer philosophical questions, explain scriptures, and even simulate empathetic conversation. What can a living guru offer that an algorithm never can?
Why do we need a sports coach when all the information is available? You need a mentor who charts a customised path for you. AI can't point out your subtle flaws. AI can offer philosophical information, but an algorithm cannot guide the inner journey. It can help with outer exposure, not inner exploration; for that, you need an enlightened master.

■ What are young people searching for today that their families, schools and conventional institutions are failing to give them?
Direction, understanding, love, security, and inner blossoming are crucial needs for everyone, especially young people. Worldly training has led to constant comparison and competition instead of care and cooperation. It pushes one to search for happiness externally, even though true bliss exists within. A master draws attention to that lost direction, bestows right understanding, loves one unconditionally, encourages one to tread that path, stands by the disciple during difficult times, and ensures every seeker blooms in her own way. He thus fills in crucial gaps that these institutions may have missed.

■ People often turn to spirituality after suffering. Can human beings discover the same depth without first being broken?
Of course they can, and they should. Spirituality should not be a spare wheel pressed into service during tough times; it should be the driving wheel that steers life's course. People are ignorant of life's fundamentals. They fail to ask themselves pivotal questions that can bring an awakening. Shrimad Rajchandraji, at 16 years of age, inquired, 'Who am I?' 'Where did i come from?' 'What is my true nature?' 'In what bondages am i entangled?' 'Should i retain or give them up?' which are potent enough to shake one out of metaphysical torpor, if pondered upon sincerely.

■ Many people inherit religion rather than discover it. Would you rather see a young person question religion, even reject it, than practise it unquestioningly?
Practising something without conviction does not bear the desired result. When an action is backed by clear understanding, it carries a different force. Questioning religion may not necessarily mean blasphemy. If a young mind is wishing to explore religion with an open mind, she is welcome to do so. Religion is a science, and when one approaches it systematically, the resultant discovery is bound to inspire her to pursue it with passion and reap its rich bounty of inner joy.

■ What is the hardest human emotion to transcend?
Ego is the hardest to work on. Man is generally keen to become free from ignorance and ready to reduce attachment; with a little introspection, he even finds that emotions such as anger and jealousy harm him, but he zealously guards his ego. The false sense of identity that he has created is most precious to him. Once he overcomes ego, his other shortcomings begin to wilt. To free him from the ego, he needs the Divine. A guru can help dissolve the ego and awaken man to his true Self, which is blissful.

■ Thousands of people come to a spiritual teacher with their anxieties. Where does the spiritual teacher go with his own burdens?
Wouldn't 'spiritual teacher' and 'burden' be an oxymoron? A spiritual master has transcended feelings that excite or dishearten. He has deep wisdom and profound empathy to help someone work through unhealthy feelings. In doing so, he is not affected by negative emotions himself. ■

VARIETY
KPOP DEMON HUNTER STAR EJAE GETS MARRIED TO BEAU
P6

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OF INDIA

SHOWBIZ
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P7

Journeys & Experiences
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Four journeys to bring in the New Year, together

New Year journeys · 26 Dec '26 – 02 Jan '27

GO WILDER
Let yourselves be surprised again
Jawai • Jaisalmer

The Desert Kingdom
Jawai - Jaisalmer | 28 Dec '26 – 02 Jan '27
Limited Seats Remain

GO CLOSER
Keep discovering together
Sikkim • Darjeeling

The Frontier Mountains
Sikkim - Darjeeling | 26 Dec '26 – 02 Jan '27

GO DEEPER
See what lies beneath
Sri Lanka • Mirissa

The Blue Expanse
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GO HIGHER
Rise above the everyday
Srinagar • Pahalgam

The High Country
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The Desert Kingdom

Jawai • Jaisalmer

28 Dec '26 - 02 Jan '27

Welcome the New Year
Dinner beneath the desert sky, with Manganiar music

Jaisalmer

Kuldhara & Manganiar
Explore desert ruins & music in a haveli courtyard

Enter the Living Fort
Walk through Jaisalmer before the crowds arrive

Track the Leopards
Explore Jawai's granite hills with an experienced naturalist

Meet the Rabari
Experience pastoral life in Jawai's leopard country

Jawai

The Frontier Mountains

Sikkim • Darjeeling

26 Dec '26 - 02 Jan '27

Yumthang / Yumesamdong
Reach Zero Point Drive to 15,300 ft for high-altitude wilderness near the border

Walk Through Lachung
Wander through homes, orchards and riverside paths

An Evening With Hishey Lachungpa
Discover Dzomsa and its place in Lachung life

North Sikkim

Picnic in Domang Valley
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Delhi Times

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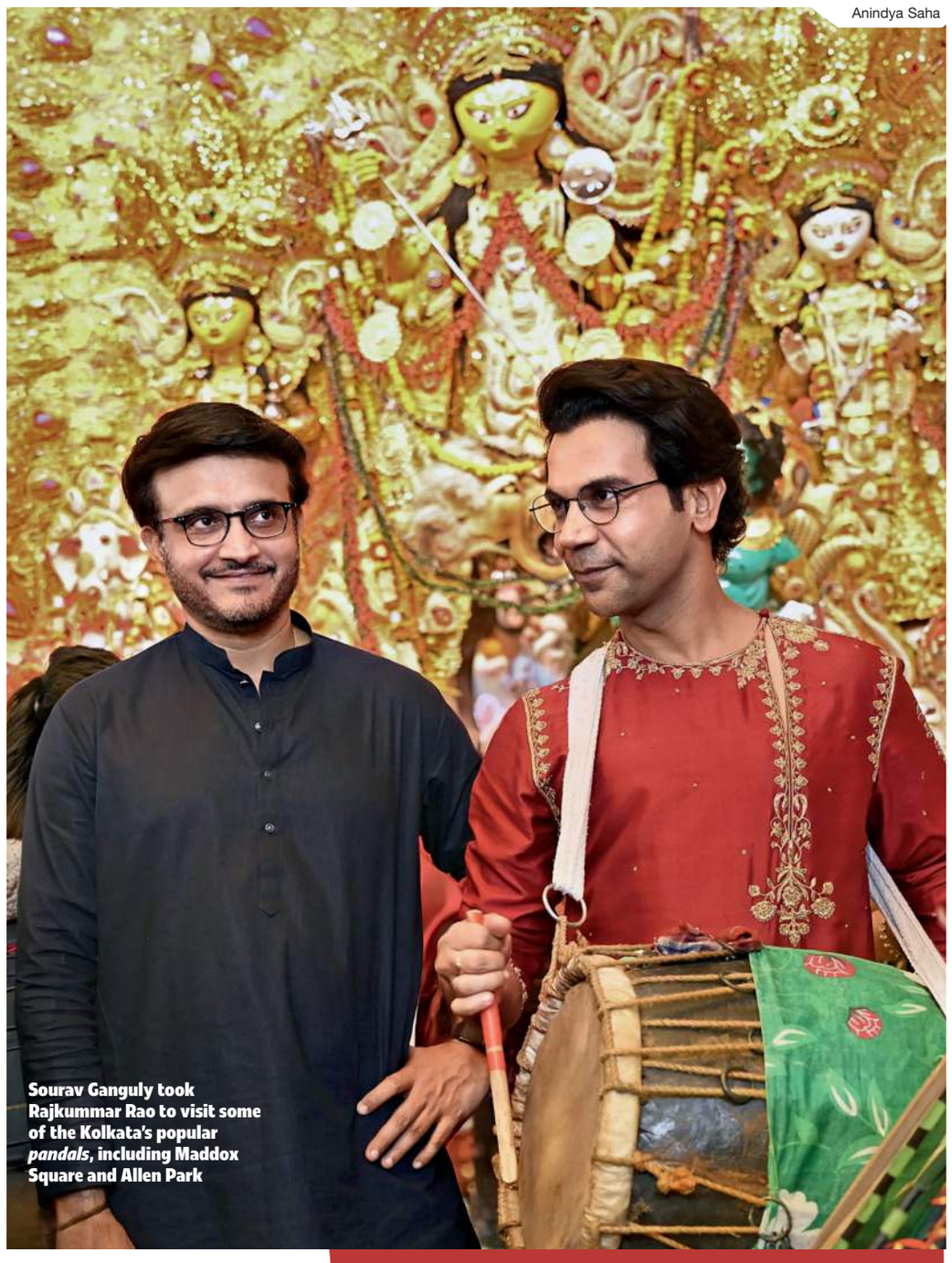
I am Kolkata's jamai now: Rajkummar Rao

Anindya Saha



Sourav Ganguly took Rajkummar Rao to visit some of the Kolkata's popular *pandals*, including Maddox Square and Allen Park

Sourav Ganguly takes Rajkummar Rao *pandal* hopping in Kolkata

Renuka Vyavahare

Sourav Ganguly and Rajkummar Rao, who will portray the former India cricket captain in the upcoming biopic *Dada: The Sourav Ganguly Story,* made their first joint appearance in Ganguly's hometown of Kolkata. The festivities began at the cricketer's residence before he took the actor *pandal* hopping during the Durga Puja celebrations on Maha Ashtami on Monday.

CONTINUED ON 2

> A few years ago, Patralekhaa took me to Kolkata during Durga Puja. It's always fascinating to be here during the festival
> –Rajkummar Rao

Since I was a kid, I used to fast for all nine days during Navratri in Gurgaon: Rajkummar Rao

Reminiscing about his childhood, Sourav told us, "Whenever I think of Durga Puja, I'm transported back to my childhood, when the festival meant pure joy, family and unforgettable memories. The excitement would begin days in advance, with my father or grandfather taking all of us cousins shopping for *pujo* clothes. We would get matching outfits in the same colours and patterns, and wearing them together was always a special feeling."

He added, "Some of my fondest memories are of spending nights at our *pujo pandals* with my cousins, staying up late, laughing and chatting before waking up early to offer prayers at the *thakur ghor*. I still remember my grandfather giving each of us ₹10 for *pandal* hopping. Back then, it felt like a fortune! Looking back, I realise that the real magic of *pujo* lies in these little moments."

Recalling his association with the festival, Rajkummar said, "Since I was a kid, I used to fast for all nine days during Navratri in Gurgaon. When I came to Mumbai, I was introduced to Durga Puja and garba nights. Then, a few years ago, Patralekhaa took me to Kolkata during Durga Puja. Since then, I've been coming to Kolkata, and it's always fascinating to be here, especially during the festival. The whole city lights up, and the colours and food are all so good."

Pic: Tejas Shashank Kudtarkar; Location courtesy: The Tanjore Tiffin Room, Versova

VIJAY VARMA

'As an artiste, my job is to investigate those discarded as bad people'

Vijay Varma on the age-old theme of good triumphing over evil and the power of complex storytelling

Onkar Kulkarni

Dussehra is a celebration of the triumph of good over evil, a theme that resonates as much in our epics as it does on screen. This year, Vijay Varma celebrated the festival exclusively with us, bringing a touch of tradition to the occasion as he arrived dressed in traditional attire. In a conversation with us, he recounted childhood memories of Dussehra, reflected on the timeless significance of the festival, and shared his thoughts on what it takes to be the new-age leading man.

CONTINUED ON 2

> Great drama lies in conflict, and conflict cannot exist only in white; it has to have shades of grey. My understanding of grey helps me understand both white and black. I don't see white and black as complete in themselves

Buzzstop

KARAN AUJLA AND BURNA BOY SET TO HEADLINE ROLLING LOUD INDIA 2026

Hip-hop heavyweights **Burna Boy**, Metro Boomin, and Skepta will make their long-awaited Indian debuts at Rolling Loud India 2026. Taking place on December 12 and 13, the two-day festival features a stacked roster anchored by returning headliner **Karan Aujla**, alongside Big Sean, Seedhe Maut, and Dhanda Nyoliwala. The two-day festival boasts a curated roster of international powerhouses and India's finest home-grown artists.

Burna Boy

Karan Aujla

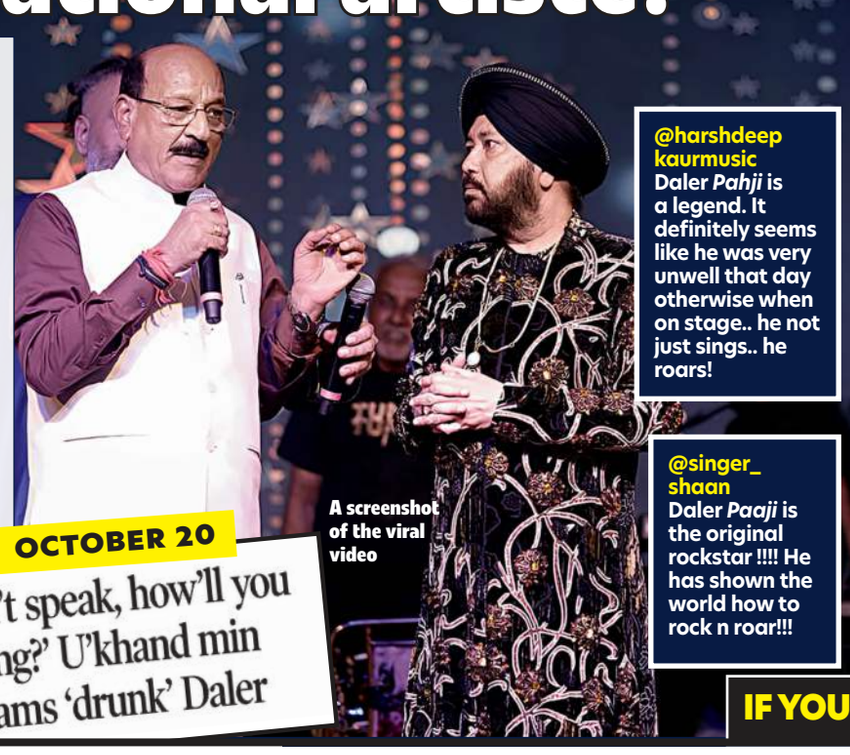
Restored Pakeezah closes BFI London Film Festival with a sold-out show

A still from *Pakeezah* (1972)

Pakeezah made a sold-out debut at the BFI London Film Festival this Sunday, drawing an audience of nearly 500 people. Chosen as the closing gala at the BFI IMAX - the UK's largest screen - tickets for the worldwide restorations vanished within an hour of release. Tajdar Amrohi (son of director Kamal Amrohi) said, "My *choti ammi*, Meena Kumari, was in a coma before she passed away. Like her, the negative of *Pakeezah* was also in a coma, and Shivendra Singh Dungarpur has brought it back to life."

P7

'Would anyone dare to behave like that with an international artiste?'



A screenshot of the viral video

What happened

Daler Mehndi was interrupted mid-performance at an annual Tourism and Development Fair in Tehri, by Forest Minister of Uttarakhand Subodh Uniyal on Monday. According to a viral video from the incident, the minister interrupted the artiste, accusing him of being intoxicated during a Navratri celebration.

Since the incident artistes have come out in support of Mehndi pointing that the 59-year-old has been unwell for the past two years with Mika questioning, "Would anyone dare to behave like that with an international artiste?"

@harshdeep kaurmusic
Daler *Pahji* is a legend. It definitely seems like he was very unwell that day otherwise when on stage.. he not just sings.. he roars!

@singer_ shaan
Daler *Paaji* is the original rockstar !!!! He has shown the world how to rock n roar!!!

OCTOBER 20

'Can't speak, how'll you sing?' U'khand min slams 'drunk' Daler

WHY INDIA NEEDS TO SEE THE HUMAN SIDE OF A STAR, DALER

By Invitation

DR PALASH SEN
Musician, founder of Euphoria

"It is time we look at our cultural gems with empathy, respect rather than quick, cynical judgment"

To the world, Daler Mehndi is a legend, a cultural pioneer, and the undisputed King of Bhangra who brought infectious joy and timeless music to millions across the globe. But beyond the glittering robes and towering stage presence lies a reality that the new age internet culture far too often ignores: Daler *paaji* is, above all else, a human being.

Of late, social media feeds have been inundated with harsh trolling, ruthless judgment, and widespread mockery directed at Daler *paaji* following a recent performance. Seeing a national icon subjected to such relentless hostility is not just disheartening – it reveals a troubling flaw in how we treat the artists who have defined our cultural landscape for decades. The stars, who have defined an entire era of Indian music. Before cricketers or even actors could dream of filling up stadiums or sky-rocketing TRPs, there was one man, one name that sold out faster than any FMCG product – Daler Mehndi.

Behind screens and usernames, it is easy for armchair activists to forget the human behind the icon. The internet sees fleeting clips, reactionary memes, and sensationalised headlines; I see a man who has poured his entire life, sweat, and soul into spreading happiness, elevating Indian culture, and serving society through both his art and extensive philanthropy.

What many fail to realise is that even legends face bad days, personal struggles, and ill health. The pressure on an artist of his stature is immense: when health fails or circumstances go awry, the choice is often between cancelling a show and disappointing thousands of eager fans, or pushing through the pain to honour a commitment. Daler *paaji* chose to show up. He stood on that stage and gave everything he had, despite the physical toll it took. To twist that dedication into fodder for online content wars is a disservice to his decades of contribution to Indian music and pop culture.

It is equally imperative to dispel the baseless rumors and misattributions circulating online. For the record, Daler *paaji* does not consume alcohol – never has, and never will. Attributing a difficult moment to false narratives and unresearched generalisation only deepens the injustice.

People may mock, criticise, or judge, but no amount of digital noise can erase a monumental legacy, a lifetime of kindness, or the unshakeable dignity with which Daler *paaji* carries himself. He has always taught those around him to face adversity with love, faith, and patience.

Behind every famous face is a fallible, vulnerable individual. It is time we look at our cultural gems with empathy and respect rather than quick, cynical judgment. Circumstances are temporary, but true legacy is forever. And Daler *paaji* is forever.

IF YOU EVER SEE DALER DRINKING ALCOHOL, I'LL QUIT SINGING: MIKA SINGH P4

I made Rajkummar try Kolkata's puchka and biryani: Sourav Ganguly

CONTINUED FROM 1

Rajkummar spoke about his special bond with Kolkata and its people. "My relationship with Kolkata and Bengalis is very special. I've always had friends from Bengal since my school days. My class teacher, who also paid my school fees at one point, was a Bengali and one of my favourite teachers. Then I met Patralekhaa, a true Bengali girl, and the rest is history," he smiled.

Anindya Saha

'I MADE RAJKUMMAR TRY TRADITIONAL BENGALI SWEETS'

The duo visited some of Kolkata's prominent *pujo pandals*, including Maddox Square and Allen Park, soaking in the city's festive spirit. Ganguly ensured that his guest got a taste of the city's culinary delights, insisting that Rajkummar try the signature *puchka* and *biryani*. "I also made Rajkummar have the traditional Bengali sweets," he said.

Having portrayed two legendary figures associated with Bengal in biopics – Subhash Chandra Bose and now Sourav Ganguly – Rajkummar feels a strong connection with the state. "I truly feel at home in Kolkata. And, as they say here, I am Kolkata's *jamai*!" he shared.

> I still remember my grandfather giving each of us (him and his brother) ₹10 for *pandal* hopping. Back then, it felt like a fortune! Looking back, I realise that the real magic of Durga Puja and the festival lay in these little moments
> – Sourav Ganguly

I've been a part of Ramleela during my FTII days: Vijay

Tejas Shashank Kudtarkar

CONTINUED FROM 1

'I HAVE TWO DISTINCT MEMORIES OF DUSSEHRA'

Sharing his memories from Hyderabad and Rajasthan, Vijay says, "I have two distinct memories of Dussehra, each rooted in a different place. One is from Hyderabad, where I was born and raised. We would go to a *mela* held on a massive ground near the Old City, where they would burn the effigy of Ravana. It used to be incredibly crowded, and I remember sitting on my father's shoulders to get a better view of the ceremony. That image has stayed with me. My second memory is from Rajasthan, where I lived with my grandmother for a few years. The *Ramleela* performances there were beautiful."

'MY UNDERSTANDING OF GREY HELPS ME UNDERSTAND BOTH WHITE AND BLACK'

Reflecting on Dussehra's age-old theme of good triumphing over evil, the actor believes that human nature cannot always be separated as black and white. He says, "I find humanity in everything. You may disagree with a lot of things about people, and some people may be terribly wrong, but as an artiste, my job is to investigate those who are seemingly discarded as bad people. If there is no representation of different kinds of personalities, our collective understanding of them remains limited."

The actor, who headlined the series *Matka King* this year, one of the highlights of his career, adds, "Great drama lies in conflict, and conflict cannot exist only in white; it has to have shades of grey. My understanding of grey helps me understand both white and black. I don't see white and black as complete in themselves. Any flaw in a character becomes an opportunity for me to understand him. I cannot understand a flawless person. My job is to shed light on these complexities and portray them truthfully so that the story works."

'I FEEL LIKE I'M THE FACE OF A NEW KIND OF BOLLYWOOD'

From playing Moeen, the drug peddler in *Gully Boy*, Hamza, the abusive husband in *Darlings*, to Anand Swarnakar, the serial killer hiding behind the facade of an ordinary family man in *Dahaad*, the characters he portrays are flawed, morally complex and far removed from the traditional leading man. Does he believe he is part of a new generation redefining what it means to be a hero?

He explains, "I feel like I'm the face of a new kind of Bollywood, because the traditional kind of films that used to be made are not being made now. In fact, they are not making those films even with younger stars. Where is *Jaane Tu... Ya Jaane Na*? Where is a film like that? Where are the films that Shahid Kapoor starred in during his earlier days? That switch has happened. I am just fortunate to be in this place where stories that I like are being made. There are actors who are very good at bringing people to the theatres, but I think I am an actor that will make sure that people will not leave the theatre. An actor's job is to capture them and give them an immersive experience where they don't even want to look at their phones."

> **'I have portrayed my own versions of Ravana'**
> Talking about being a part of *Ramleela*, he shares, "I have been part of a *Ramleela* during my time at FTII. Jaideep Ahlawat played Ravana, another friend played Ram, Sunny Hinduja was Hanuman, and I played Jatayu. Later, I even played Sita in one of the short films we made as students. I have never played Ravana on screen, but I have portrayed my own versions of the character in different ways."

FROM BRIDAL BLING TO GARBA GLAM

AI-generated pic for representational purposes

A newly-wed bride's trousseau deserves an encore this festive season. For Navratri, bring out that embroidered *lehenga*, pairing its ornate skirt with a contrasting mirror-work blouse for a fresh, dance-ready look. A rich silk sari from the wedding wardrobe can be restyled with a contemporary blouse, while a heavily embellished *dupatta* can transform a simple *kurta* set into festive finery.

Know how to reuse your bridal trousseau for festive dressing

Let the jewellery shine, too: swap bridal polki sets for oxidised silver *jhumkas*, layer bangles, or style a statement choker with understated earrings. The secret? Mix, match and re-wear. Celebrate tradition, create new memories, and let every trousseau treasure have its moment.

Delhi Times PRESENTS Wedding Times

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TIMES interact
Connecting People, Connecting Needs.

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Saatchi & Saatchi

'Can criticise his singing, but don't accuse him of drinking'

CONTINUED FROM 1

Daler Mehndi does not drink alcohol; he has been unwell for two years: Mika Singh

Standing firmly by the veteran singer, Mika Singh has hit back at claims that Daler Mehndi consumes alcohol. In a video shared on Instagram, Mika says, "*Kya zindagi mein aap logon ne kabhi unke haath mein sharaab ka* glass *dekha hai? Ya unki* birthday party *mein kabhi sharaab peete dekha hai?... Nahi dekha. Jab aapne dekha hi nahi, toh aapne seedha bol diya ki unse khada nahi hua ja raha.*"

Mika says Daler has been unwell and is still recovering from a major operation, but continues to honour his professional commitments despite his health. "*Hum log kayi baar kisi ke kehne pe haan kar dete hain. Bhale hi hum logon ko* 104 *bukhar ho,* doesn't matter. *Agar maine haan kar di hai, toh mujhe* show *karna hi hai,*" he says, adding that Daler may have agreed to perform despite being unwell.

While acknowledging that the minister may have had a point about Daler struggling to sing, Mika says, "*Maan liya*, sir, *aap sahi keh rahe hain ki agar unse gaana nahi gaya ja raha tha, toh unhe nahi gaana chahiye tha. Lekin yeh mat boliye ki woh sharaab pee ke gaana gaa rahe hain,*" Mika says, urging people not to make allegations without proof.

Condemning the way Daler was treated on stage, Mika questions whether an international act would face similar treatment. "Would anyone dare to behave like that with an international band like Coldplay?" he asks.

TNN

@thedalermehndiofficial

Mika Singh and Daler Mehndi at Mika's 50th birthday bash

@kapilsharma
@thedalermehndiofficial *paji* went through some serious surgery which people don't know. All we need is to be little kinder towards other. We don't know what someone is going through. Thank you @mikasingh *paji* for the clarification. May god bless Daler *paji*. We love you Daler *paji* (sic)

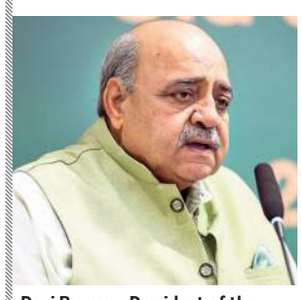
@chandanprabhakar
I personally know Daler *Paji* very well, and I have never seen him consume alcohol. He has a heart of gold, and even in the video, he didn't look physically well. People should not spread unverified claims or make assumptions about an artist without knowing the facts. Daler *Paji* is a gem of a person and deserves our love and respect (sic)

Hindu College is in our blood: Alumni celebrate old pals, lifelong college ties

Sara Siddiqui

Pics: Ajay Kumar Gautam

(L-R) Dr Kavita Sharma, former principal and alumna (batch of 1969), Sunita Trivedi, retired government official (batch of 1977) and Deepak Kumar, IAS officer (batch of 1987)



Ravi Burman, President of the OSA (batch of 1975)

Ajay Verma, senior advocate (batch of 1982)

Muktesh Pardeshi, former Ambassador of India to the Republic of Turkiye (batch of 1987)

Childlike laughter filled the hall at India Habitat Centre as alumni of Hindu College reconnected at the Old Students' Association (OSA) Annual Alumni Awards. "Isn't this your hostel roommate?" and "Look, I brought your batchmate with me!" rang through Silver Oak as old friends, classmates and roommates introduced one another, rekindling bonds and revisiting memories after years apart.

'WHEREVER WE MEET, A WARM CONVERSATION BEGINS'

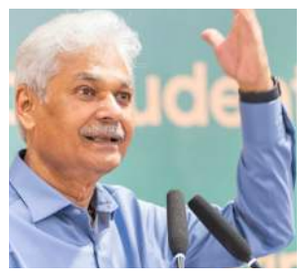
Sharing the pride of being a Hinduite, Dr Kavita Sharma, former principal and alumna, batch of 1969, noted, "In honouring all of you, we honour ourselves, because we are all very proud of the college... It is said that we can come out of Hindu College, but you can't take Hindu College out of us." She also spoke about the famous Hindu-St Stephen's rivalry, which was prominent on the sports field and in debate competitions, and said, "It was blasphemy to not attend the cricket match when the two colleges faced each other. Once a teacher asked me why I was in class and asked me to go to the cricket field!"

Talking about the Alumni Awards, which are hosted by the Hindu College OSA every year to honour the achievements of alumni in their respective fields, Ajay Verma, senior advocate, batch of 1982, shared, "These functions are a recognition of not only the awardees, but also the institution, the stakeholders, and particularly teachers. It's a celebration for all of us. Personally, Hindu is in my blood. I've been associated with the college since day one since my father was teaching there and then became principal."

> Wherever we go, if we find out the other person is a Hinduite, and we may not even have met that person but immediately a very warm conversation begins – Dr Kavita Sharma

'A VERY UNIQUE OCCASION'

Ravi Burman, President of the OSA, batch of 1975, said, "It is a very unique occasion because we have with us Dr Kavita Sharma, who was instrumental in starting these awards in the centenary year of the college in 1999. And it has been continuing since then. It has become a major event of ours that we look forward to every year."



Yashovardhan Azad, former Secretary (Security), Government of India (batch of 1973)

> It's a beautiful feeling to come for any alumni event – Yashovardhan Azad

'No award beats recognition from friends'

Deepak Kumar, IAS officer, batch of 1987, who received the award for excellence in public service, addressed the gathering on behalf of the awardees. "*Apno ke beech sammanit hone ka alag maza hai. Apne doston se, jo* one of the biggest critics *hote hain, unse milne wala samman - isse bada* award *koi nahi ho sakta*," he said.

He shared that after joining the hostel, his grades significantly declined. "What is also great about the Hindu hostel is that *kuchh saal aap dekhte hain ki kaunse* seniors exams qualify *karte ja rahe hain*, and your confidence builds that *agar aise nalayak ka ho gaya, toh aapka bhi* clear *ho jayega*," he added, drawing laughter.

'Every meet brings a flood of memories'

Yashovardhan Azad, from the batch of 1973 and former Secretary (Security), Government of India, also shared a message for current students, and said, "I would tell the students that you must be known for your professionalism. You should be known for an area, for some *hunar*... So I tell them, whichever work you are doing, be the best."

For Azad, the alumni meet was also an opportunity to revisit the memories that made college life special. "It's a beautiful feeling to come for any alumni event. Every alumni meet brings to your mind a flood of memories - how you used to cut classes, how you would go for those cricket matches, or debates. This is a fascinating place for recounting those old incidents," he shared.

LEISURE

SUDOKU CHALLENGE

Level: Medium

2			8				3	
			4		3			6
	8		1			2		
7	5		2					3
				1				
4					6		1	9
		4			1		9	
9			6		7			
	6				2			1

HOW TO PLAY

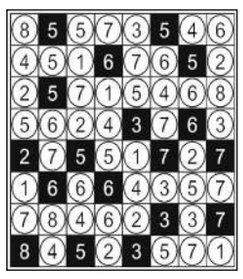
Fill in the grid so that every horizontal row, every vertical column and every 3x3 box contains the digits 1-9, without repeating the numbers in the same row, column or box.You can't change the digits already given in the grid. Every puzzle has one solution.

TIMES HITORI

HOW TO PLAY

1. A number may appear just once in each row or column. Eliminate repeat numbers by darkening cells. (see example)
2. Darkened cells must never be adjacent in a row or column.
3. Unmarked cells must create a single continuous area, undivided by darkened cells.
4. Every time you darken a cell, you can automatically circle its vertical and horizontal neighbours, which means they cannot be eliminated.
5. Any cell "sandwiched" between neighbours of the same value can be circled. (e.g. 6 [4] 6)
6. A "triple" is a special case of sandwich. Circle the centre cells, and darken the ends. (e.g. [6] [6] [6])

1	3	2	9	2	6	7	3
1	8	2	5	2	9	4	6
9	9	1	6	9	3	7	5
3	5	3	7	6	2	1	8
1	2	6	8	2	7	2	3
9	4	2	1	7	8	5	6
6	6	7	3	6	1	7	4
2	7	8	2	9	4	3	1

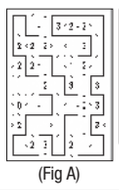


Example

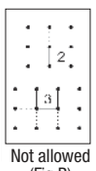
LOOP THE LOOP

RULES

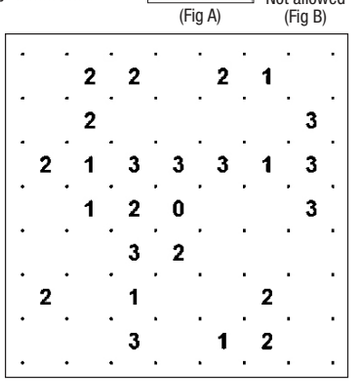
- Connect adjacent dots with vertical or horizontal lines, creating a single loop (Fig A).
- Crossovers or branches are not allowed (As shown by dotted lines in Fig B).
- Numbers in the puzzle indicate the number of lines that should surround it, while empty cells may be surrounded by any number of lines.
- You can't draw lines around zeroes.
- Each puzzle has just one unique solution.



(Fig A)



Not allowed (Fig B)

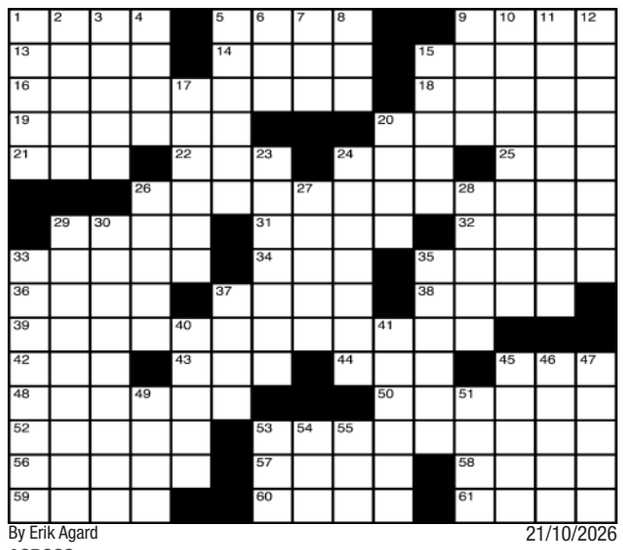


HOW TO BEGIN:

Example (Fig A) - Begin with the zero next to 3. Since no lines can be drawn around zero, mark crosses around it, as shown. Now there is a cross in one space around 3. So we know the three lines of 3 can only be drawn in the remaining three spaces. Next, these lines can only be extended in one direction each. Continue, using the same logic.

Hints: Keep eliminating possibilities by marking crosses in spaces between dots where a line isn't possible, i.e., if you have already completed required lines or where a line extension may create a branch or cause a deadend **(Fig B)**.

THE DAILY CROSSWORD



By Erik Agard — 21/10/2026

ACROSS

1 Succeed in a class
5 With 47-Down, tropical shade providers
9 Content warning letters
13 Two-tone apex predator
14 Inventor's jumping-off point
15 Underwater detector
16 "I like it!"
18 Location
19 Out like a light
20 Vintner's harvest
21 Top stripe of a pride flag
22 Lousy grade
24 "Gosh!"
25 Channel with music videos and "Reba" reruns
26 Bucket list item, perhaps
29 Statistical average
31 Jokes
32 Cunning plan
33 "A Change Is __ Come"
34 Victor Wembanyama's org.
35 Features of 4c hair
36 A single time
37 Plant anchor
38 CPR pros
39 Not rigid
42 Seasonal vaccine target
43 Some undergrad degs.
44 Fleeting snooze
45 Pvt. trainer
48 Chicken __ bleu
50 Throw trash away, but not in a trash can
52 An additional time
53 Distance shot in basketball, or what 16-, 26-, and 39-Across are altogether?
56 Sport with scrums
57 Component of steel
58 Lack of difficulty
59 Simple tops
60 Domestic four-leggers
61 "Their __ Were Watching God"

DOWN

1 Big name in seltzer water
2 Came up
3 Give a talking-to
4 "For goodness' __!"
5 Animal enclosure with a namesake cipher
6 "And now, without further __ ... "
7 Sign before Virgo
8 Ticked off
9 Mardi Gras city, familiarly
10 Signals called by a quarterback before each play
11 Protections against respiratory illnesses
12 Competes on a mat
15 Shopping jag
17 Arizona city near the Seven Sacred Pools
20 Precious stones
23 Creamy Christmas concoctions
24 Huge unit of mass
26 Pool divisions
27 Like a dirty word
28 Dirty
29 Actor's audition selection
30 Spur on
33 Transport on the way to sink a putt
35 "You hang on to that"
37 "Sinners" director Coogler
40 Dark wood
41 Makeover sites
45 Wander off
46 V-formation flyers
47 See 5-Across
49 "I call it!"
51 Old-school "you"
53 Guff
54 Metallic resource
55 Duped

Tuesday's Puzzle Solved

P	A	N	S	Y			B	T	S		P	E	T	E
O	R	A	T	E			E	S	Q		E	T	A	L
E	M	P	A	T	H		S	O	U	S	C	H	E	F
T	S	A	R		E	A	T	S	A	T		O	B	I
			Q	U	A	D	S		R	A	T	S	O	N
	C	H	U	R	R	O		T	E	R	I			
P	L	I	A	N	T		F	A	S	T	P	A	S	S
J	I	L	L		S	O	U	T	H		T	R	U	E
S	O	L	I	S	T	E	N		O	B	O	I	S	T
			T	H	O	R		C	O	U	P	E	S	
T	I	D	Y	U	P		M	U	T	T	S			
A	W	E		S	P	R	I	T	E		H	A	C	K
P	I	N	W	H	E	E	L		R	E	A	L	L	Y
E	L	S	A		R	N	A			S	P	O	O	L
S	L	E	D		S	O	N			L	E	T	G	O

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SCRAMBLE

Rearrange the letters in the four word jumbles, one letter to each square/circle, to make four ordinary words

BQUIS

EINLT

CCHRNU

NOSUGH

HOW TO PLAY

Now arrange the letters in the circles to form the answer to the riddle or to fill in the missing word as indicated

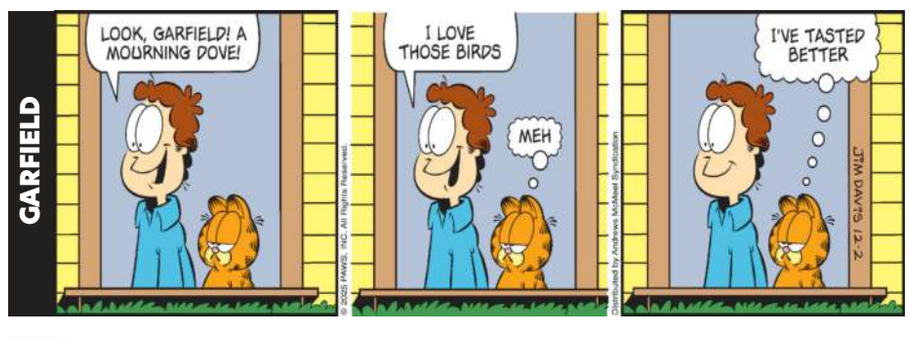
This ___ linked me through the ages to that past consciousness. - Richard Jefferies (8)

EVENTS

MUSIC
India Habitat Centre: *Aarambh*, a series featuring young classical performers of music and dance. 7pm, Oct 22. The Theatre, IHC

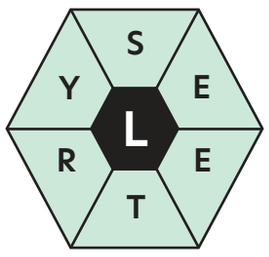
DANCE
India Habitat Centre: *Vedanta Lahiri*, a dance presentation highlighting Upanishadic philosophy. Today, 7pm. Stein Auditorium, IHC

Email us at tims.delhitimes@timesofindia.com



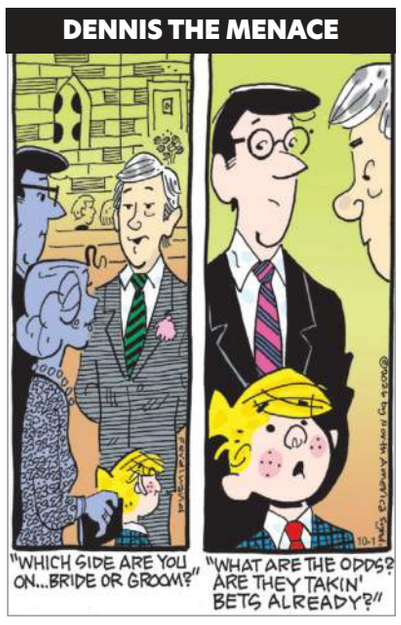
SPELLATHON

Today's Ratings:
10-average | 11-good | 13-outstanding



How many words of four or more letters can you make from the letters shown in today's puzzle? In making a word, a letter can be used as many times as it appears in the puzzle. Each word must contain the central letter. There should be at least one seven letter word. Plurals, foreign words and proper names are not allowed. British English Dictionary is used as reference.

DENNIS THE MENACE



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9822042295 or anupamvkapil@gmail.com.

See what the stars have in store for you - according to your moon sign.

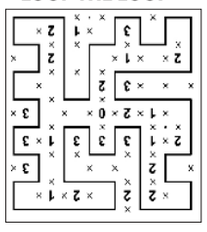
ARIES: You may find yourself questioning the intentions of people who offer advice or assistance. Giving someone the benefit of the doubt could open the door to a useful association or prevent an unnecessary misunderstanding.
TAURUS: This is a good time to acknowledge your own needs instead of automatically placing everyone else's interests ahead of yours. Maintain your boundaries respectfully.
GEMINI: You may find yourself entrusted with greater authority or given an opportunity to influence an important decision. Enjoy the confidence others place in you, but do not assume that your position makes your judgement infallible.
CANCER: Your hopes for the future may become clearer when you take time to listen to your inner feelings. Instead of concentrating only on what you wish to achieve, consider what would genuinely bring you peace of mind.
LEO: An opportunity to make a difference could arise sooner than you expect, requiring you to respond with confidence. Someone may seek your assistance, and your willingness to act generously could strengthen a relationship.
VIRGO: You may receive plenty of encouragement from people who agree with your opinions, but genuine progress sometimes depends on hearing what others are reluctant to say.
LIBRA: Your desire to excel may encourage you to take on several challenges at once. Be selective about your commitments and recognise when you need to pause.
SCORPIO: A period of reflection may lead you towards an intriguing idea or a fresh understanding of a subject that fascinates you. Explain your ideas clearly and avoid assuming that others see the same connections you do.
SAGITTARIUS: Information coming from other people may not provide the complete picture, so avoid making important decisions solely on the strength of someone else's advice.
CAPRICORN: Your enthusiasm for a new idea may be considerable, but it is important to assess whether your expectations are realistic. Optimism can inspire progress, provided it is accompanied by a realistic understanding of possible obstacles.
AQUARIUS: Someone close to you may appear unusually quiet, withdrawn or unwilling to discuss what is bothering them. Giving them the freedom to process their feelings can be more helpful than repeatedly asking questions.
PISCES: Developments in your professional environment may bring opportunities to advance, provided you recognise them and respond promptly. However, competition or differences of opinion may also arise, so avoid treating every disagreement as a threat.

SOLUTIONS TO GAMES/PUZZLES

TIMES SUDOKU

2	1	4	8	9	7	6	3	5
5	7	3	4	6	3	9	2	8
6	8	9	1	5	2	7	4	3
3	5	1	2	4	6	8	9	7
4	9	2	7	3	8	5	1	6
7	6	8	5	1	9	4	2	3
8	3	5	6	2	4	1	7	9
9	4	6	3	7	1	2	5	8
1	2	7	9	8	5	3	6	4

LOOP THE LOOP



TIMES HITORI

2	7	8	9	■	6	4	3	1
6	■	1	■	3	■	7	■	4
9	4	■	1	7	8	■	5	6
■	2	6	■	8	■	9	■	3
3	■	7	6	2	1	■	8	■
■	9	■	3	■	■	1	■	5
1	8	■	5	2	9	■	6	4
■	3	2	■	6	7	5	■	■

SPELLATHON

else, leer, leery, lest, lyre, reel, rely, sleet, slyer, steel, steely, style, TERSELY

SCRAMBLE

Answer: This sunlight linked me through the ages to that past consciousness. - Richard Jefferies

Words: Squib, inlet/intel, crunch, shogun

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fast now. fayda now. kanjak now.

amazon now

A feast of Cantonese flavours

WHAT'S HOT
IF IT'S HAPPENING, IT'S HERE.

A culinary showcase at Shangri-La Eros New Delhi

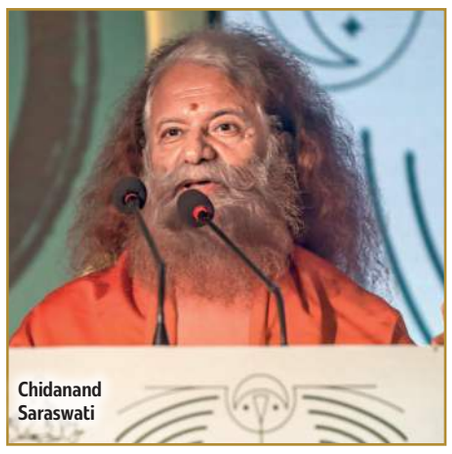
Delhi gets a taste of contemporary Cantonese cuisine as Malaysia-born Master Chef Raymond Wong brings Hakkasan Mumbai's signature dishes to Shang Palace at Shangri-La Eros New Delhi for a three-day culinary pop-up. Diners can enjoy a selection of signature creations, from Hakkasan's signature peking duck with pancakes and crab dumplings to stir-fried tiger prawns and vegetarian specialities, showcasing bold flavours and refined culinary techniques. The brand's management team says, "Set menus and à la carte selections available."

Contact: +918800804541; **Website:** shangpalace.slnd@shangri-la.com; **Dates:** October 23 to 25 (lunch and dinner)

Master Chef Raymond Wong

Celebrating the people shaping India's wellness journey

Yogita Khatri



Chidanand Saraswati

Jai Madaan

People from India's diverse wellness and healing ecosystem came together at The TOI Healing India Forum 2026 to recognise the work of practitioners, professionals and institutions that are contributing to holistic wellbeing and conscious living.

The forum was a platform to discuss healing, self-awareness, mindfulness and responsible approaches to wellbeing, and highlighted the growing connection between ancient Indian knowledge and modern wellness practices. The forum was a confluence of a plethora of practices and specialisations, with recognition in 35 categories across eight disciplines. These included Energy & Frequency Healing, Consciousness & Soul Work, Mind & Subconscious Therapies, Group & Collective Healing, Body-Based & Traditional Therapies, Creative & Sensory Healing, Yoga Excellence Awards and Wellness Visionaries Awards.

The categories covered practices ranging from sound healing, reiki, *chakra* balancing and meditation to Ayurveda-based therapeutic healing, naturopathy, art therapy and yoga. The forum also recognised the work of wellness professionals, authors and content creators contributing to the wider conversation around holistic health. A total of 32 winners were recognised at the Healing India Forum.

For the complete list of winners and other details, visit: https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/toi/healing-india-forum

Key honours

AYURVEDIC-BASED THERAPEUTIC HEALING: Dr Ramkumar, Vaidyagrama Ayurveda Healing Village (Coimbatore - South India)

HEALER OF THE YEAR: Amanvir Kaur, founder and Owner, Infinite Wellness

MINDFULNESS & MEDITATION THERAPY: Paayal Lal, founder, Eka By Paayal

MOST INNOVATIVE YOGA INITIATIVE: Anand Mehrotra from Sattva Yoga Academy

SOUL COACHING / SPIRITUAL MENTORSHIP: Divya Chhabra, founder, Palmistry Care

The jury at a glance

Sonakshi Arora Bhutani, Spiritual Psychologist & Trauma, Informed Facilitator; Janvi Gaur, Vedic Astrologer & Spiritual Healer; Jai Madaan, Spiritual Mentor & Astrologer; Dr Manjari Chandra, Functional Nutritionist; Prasad Sanyal, Group Business Head, Timesofindia.com, Indiatimes & WhatsHot; and Dr Somit Kumar, Ayurvedic physician.

@daniellefrankel

From songwriting partners to life partners: Ejae marries Sam Kim

Ejae and Sam Kim

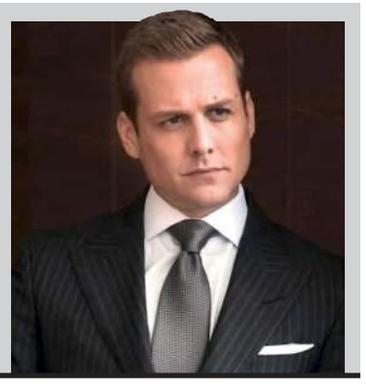
K Pop Demon Hunters star **Ejae** has married her longtime fiancé, music producer Sam Kim, in Seoul, South Korea, *Vogue* reported. The ceremony took place recently at Stage 28 in Seoul, a venue associated with childhood memories for the singer, 34, whose real name is Kim Eun-jae. "My grandparents lived in the house at the venue when I was a little girl," she told the publication, recalling walks in the surrounding hills with her grandfather.

Ejae wore a custom Danielle Frankel gown, describing her vision as "ethereal, modern, chic, and timeless with a twist".

The couple met in 2017 during a songwriting session and got engaged in autumn 2023. Kim also contributed vocals to *What It Sounds Like*, a climactic song from the animated film. Earlier, the *Golden* singer credited her fiancé for keeping her grounded amid international fame, saying, "I don't think I could have gone through this without him."

Did You Know?

Shirt collars were once detachable



In the 19th and early 20th centuries, some shirts had detachable collars and cuffs, which could be washed separately and replaced when worn or stained, reducing the need to launder the entire shirt as frequently. This was particularly practical when laundry was labour-intensive and changing a shirt every day was not always feasible.

Tara Sutaria sports a regal *kundan-polki* set with emerald accents and delicate pearl drops

Experts suggest checking the gold hallmark and certification. Padmini says, "In *polki* and *kundan*, the quality of the gemstones and the neatness of the setting are very important"

Go for Kareena Kapoor Khan's bold folk-luxe look with oxidised silver *jhumkas*, a chunky *hasli*, stacked engraved *kadas* and a statement ring

Heritage jewellery finds favour with Gen Z shoppers

Yashaswi Kochar

While oxidised silver has been a go-to for younger shoppers for years, statement heritage jewellery is now finding its way back into wardrobes. *Kundan, polki, jadau* and regional silver jewellery are being styled not just with *lehengas* and saris, but also with denim and shirts, dresses, suits and contemporary Indian wear. Padmini Chipper, a jeweller from Rajasthan, says, "This festive season, we are seeing a lot of interest in minimalist *polki* and *kundan* necklaces, *jhumkas, chandbalis*, bangles, bracelets and rings. Customers are especially looking for pieces that look festive but are not too heavy. They want jewellery they can wear with a sari or *lehenga* but also style differently for other occasions. There is definitely a shift towards versatile pieces."

'Younger generation is mixing traditional with contemporary'

Young customers love traditional jewellery but want it in lighter, more contemporary forms. "Today, customers are mixing *polki* and *kundan* with modern outfits and pairing statement traditional earrings with simple clothes. They are also experimenting more with layering and mixing pieces. Basically, they want heritage in a way that fits their lifestyle," says Rajasthan-based jeweller Padmini Chipper.

The idea is to blend cultural influences in ways that resonate with customers, allowing them to retain their Indian identity while expressing who they are today.

Neel Soni, owner of a jewellery studio, says, "For our Indian clients in Europe, we create Indo-Victorian jewellery that combines Indian motifs and *jadau* with Art Nouveau, Art Deco, and Edwardian and Victorian influences." For clients in the Middle East, the studio blends Ghalamzhani, a Persian art form, with earcuffs, an iconic tribal jewellery piece from Gujarat traditionally worn by tribal women, especially during festivals. "For clients in the USA and Canada, we combine traditional designs with modern colour palettes and nature-inspired motifs to create minimal looks," he adds.

Read between the lines of craftsmanship

Imperfection in clothes or jewellery suggests authenticity. Jeweller Vaishali Shrimal says, "The first thing to look at is the craftsmanship. Traditionally crafted jewellery generally has visible evidence of handwork, with small variations, detailed textures and an individuality that is difficult to reproduce through completely mechanised production." Neel Soni, owner of a jewellery studio, adds, "In handcrafted pieces, each artisan can work on the same design, but results can be visibly different."

When buying Kutchi silver jewellery, consider purity, weight, craftsmanship, finishing and the seller's reputation rather than price alone. Vaishali advises looking for "the characteristic geometric patterns, floral and nature-inspired elements, dots, lines, textured surfaces and traditional ornamental detailing found in Kutch's regional jewellery traditions." Experts also recommend checking gold hallmarks and certification.

"For care, silver should be stored in a dry, preferably airtight or anti-tarnish pouch, and kept away from perfumes, chemicals and excessive moisture. Tarnishing is a natural characteristic of silver and does not necessarily indicate poor quality – Vaishali Shrimal, a jeweller

If heavy jewellery is not your thing, opt for Alia Bhatt's subtle folk-boho look with petite oxidised-silver *jhumkas* featuring geometric detailing

@shaleenanathani

The big bling theory

The power of statement accessories

This festive season, let one killer accessory steal the show. Take a cue from Bollywood and let your jewellery do the talking!

Give the choker its close-up

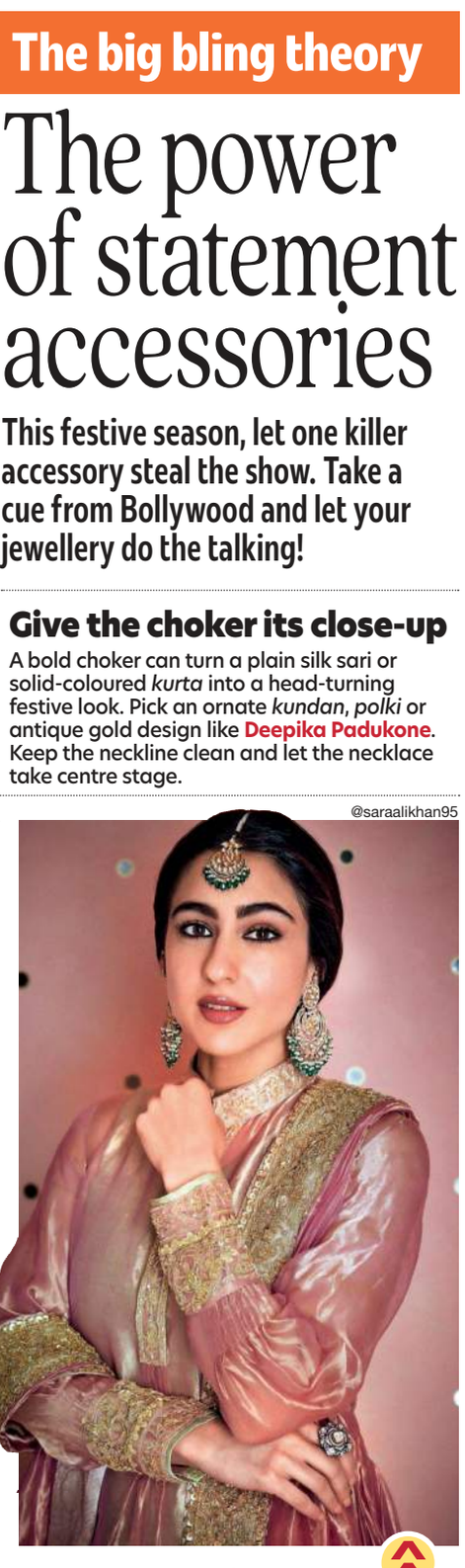
A bold choker can turn a plain silk sari or solid-coloured *kurta* into a head-turning festive look. Pick an ornate *kundan*, *polki* or antique gold design like **Deepika Padukone**. Keep the neckline clean and let the necklace take centre stage.

Go big on the earrings

Oversized *jhumkas* or sculptural gold earrings can do all the heavy lifting. Pair them with a simple sari and a sleeveless blouse like **Kiara Advani** or a fuss-free *kurta* set. Tie your hair into a sleek bun to give those earrings their moment.

@kiaraaliaadvani

@saraalikhan95

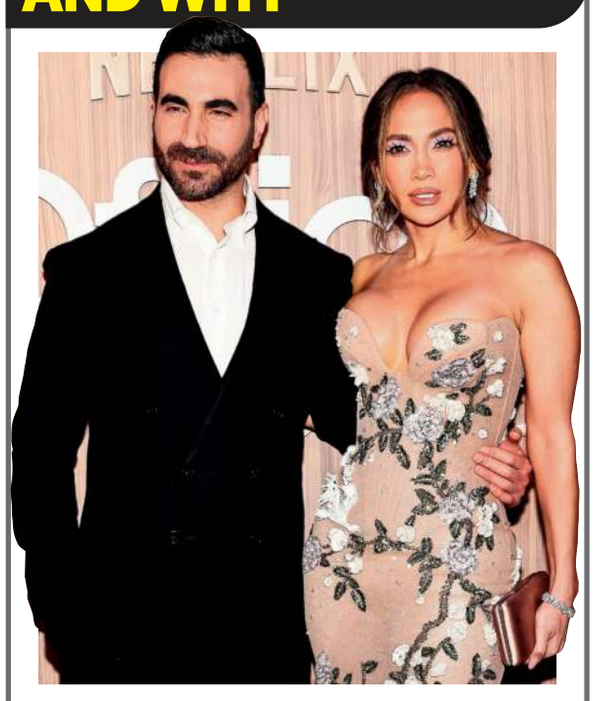


Add a pop of colour

Think emerald green, ruby red, turquoise blue or multicoloured *meenakari*. Let one colourful necklace or a pair of vibrant earrings brighten a neutral outfit like **Sara Ali Khan** is letting her green jewellery shine.

UP TO DATE

WHAT'S #TRENDING AND WHY



Jennifer Lopez, Brett Goldstein spark real-life romance buzz

Jennifer Lopez and Brett Goldstein are reportedly taking their on-screen chemistry from *Office Romance* off-screen. According to *Page Six*, a source confirmed that the actors, who star together in the recent rom-com, are seeing each other. The speculation gained momentum after the duo was spotted arriving at and leaving a talent manager's party in Los Angeles on October 16, reportedly in the same car while entering separately. The pair had previously denied dating rumours, despite repeated speculation about their chemistry. Lopez had also filed her divorce from Ben Affleck in August 2024, finalising in January 2025.

Meena Kumari as Sahibjaan in *Pakeezah*

'It is a miracle to see Pakeezah return on the big screen at BFI'

Niharika Lal

Pakeezah drew a full house at the BFI IMAX, the UK's largest screen, where the restored classic was chosen as the closing gala from restorations submitted from around the world. The screening sold out within an hour, with not a single empty seat in the house.

Director Kamal Amrohi's obsession with perfection meant that the film took fifteen years to make (1956–1972). Surmounting a switch to colour, a studio fire, casting delays, and mounting budget overruns, it finally premiered on February 4, 1972.

The screening was introduced by Film Heritage Foundation Director Shivendra Singh Dungarpur, along with Tajdar Amrohi and Rukhsar Amrohi, the son and daughter of the filmmaker, in a conversation moderated by Arike Oke, Executive Director of Knowledge and Collections at the British Film Institute (BFI).

Speaking at the screening, Dungarpur said, "It's almost a miracle to see *Pakeezah* back on the big screen. We worked on the restoration for two years, and it was very challenging, but I was determined that we should do our best to bring Kamal Amrohi's vision back to life."

(L-R) Rukhsar Amrohi, Tajdar Amrohi, and Shivendra Singh Dungarpur

I feel like my father is here right now, blessing us: Tajdar Amrohi

Tajdar and Rukhsar Amrohi were overwhelmed with emotion while presenting the film at the BFI IMAX.

Tajdar said, "My *Choti Ammi*, Meena Kumari, was in a coma before she passed away. Like her, the negative of *Pakeezah* was also in a coma, and Shivendra Singh Dungarpur has brought it back to life. I just want to restore you all in my heart so I can look back on this day whenever I want. I feel like my father is here right now, blessing us on this day."

Rukhsar said, "When he made *Pakeezah*, my father created a wonder, like his name Kamal, for which he should be remembered. I am just overwhelmed." Also present was Bilal Amrohi, Kamal Amrohi's grandson, who also worked on the restoration for the film.

International filmmakers, festival chiefs, cinematographers, and cinema experts, who attended the screening of the film, said they were in awe of the film's beauty and its 4K restoration.

Gwyneth returns to TV with a new thriller

Oscar-winning actor Gwyneth Paltrow is set to lead *The Apology*, a thriller drama that has received a two-season straight-to-series order, reported *Deadline*. The project will be directed by Thomas Vinterberg and written by Joe Murtagh. Paltrow will play Evelyn Amspoker, whose son was murdered 18 years earlier in a case that captured national attention. The series marks Paltrow's first major lead role in a television series, following her appearances in *The Politician* and *Glee*. A release date has not yet been announced.

Selena opens up on her struggle with vaping

Selena Gomez has opened up about how her prolonged nicotine vaping habit changed her voice, warning fans that the addictive habit is "just not worth it". In a video shared on her Instagram Stories on October 18, the *Good For You* singer admitted that frequent vaping had altered her voice and acknowledged that the change might be permanent. "Nicotine is so hard to quit," she said. "If you're even trying to vape, it's just not worth it. It's changed my voice. So if you guys don't like listening to my voice, that's totally understandable." Gomez also revealed that she had stopped vaping and wished to maintain it, saying, "I hope I can keep it up. It's really hard."

HOT TAKES

ALL INDIA WOMEN'S CONFERENCE
Presents
Shilpkala Utsav 2026
A Celebration of
AIWC CENTENARY
100 YEARS
An Annual Exhibition of Arts & Craft
created by Women Artisans from across India
22 ❖ 23 ❖ 24
October 2026, 10:30 am to 8:00 pm
at Aga Khan Hall
6, Bhagwan Das Road
New Delhi

MAHILA MANGAL
Diwali Bazaar
Thursday, 22nd October, 2026
10:00 am to 8:00 pm
THE ASHOK HOTEL
Chanakyapuri, New Delhi
RAJKUMARI AGGARWAL
FOUNDER / CHAIRPERSON
Sadhna Gupta
PRESIDENT
ANU JAIN
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Min. Trxn: ₹5,000
Max. Discount: ₹750
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Max. Discount: ₹27,500
Validity: 01 Oct - 30 Nov '26

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Max. Discount: ₹23,000
Validity: 01 Oct - 30 Nov '26

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Up to ₹10,000 Instant Discount
Validity: 01 Oct - 30 Nov '26

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#Offer applicable on both, EMI and Non-EMI transactions. ^Valid on Non-EMI transactions done on Pinelabs EDC Machines only. ^^ Valid on Non-EMI transactions only. *Terms & Conditions apply. Offers are not valid on SBI / Tata Corporate Card, Cashback SBI Card, Paytm SBI Card and Rupay Credit Card transactions done via UPI. Offers are valid on Flipkart SBI Card only on POS transactions. Offer details and dates are subject to change without prior notice. Above offers are valid on EMI transactions (6 months & above tenures only) done through select EMI aggregators (Pinelabs / Innoviti / Benow / Paytm (PPSL) / Ezetap / Razorpay) under 'Brand EMI' option & only if Instant Discount / Cashback is mentioned on charge slip. Customers are requested to retain charge slip for 180 days post program end date. The interest amount chargeable in the 1st EMI will be calculated for the period between EMI booking date and the Payment Due Date (PDD). Interest will be levied for a 30 day period 2nd EMI onwards. Above Offers are valid on one transaction per card per month.

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